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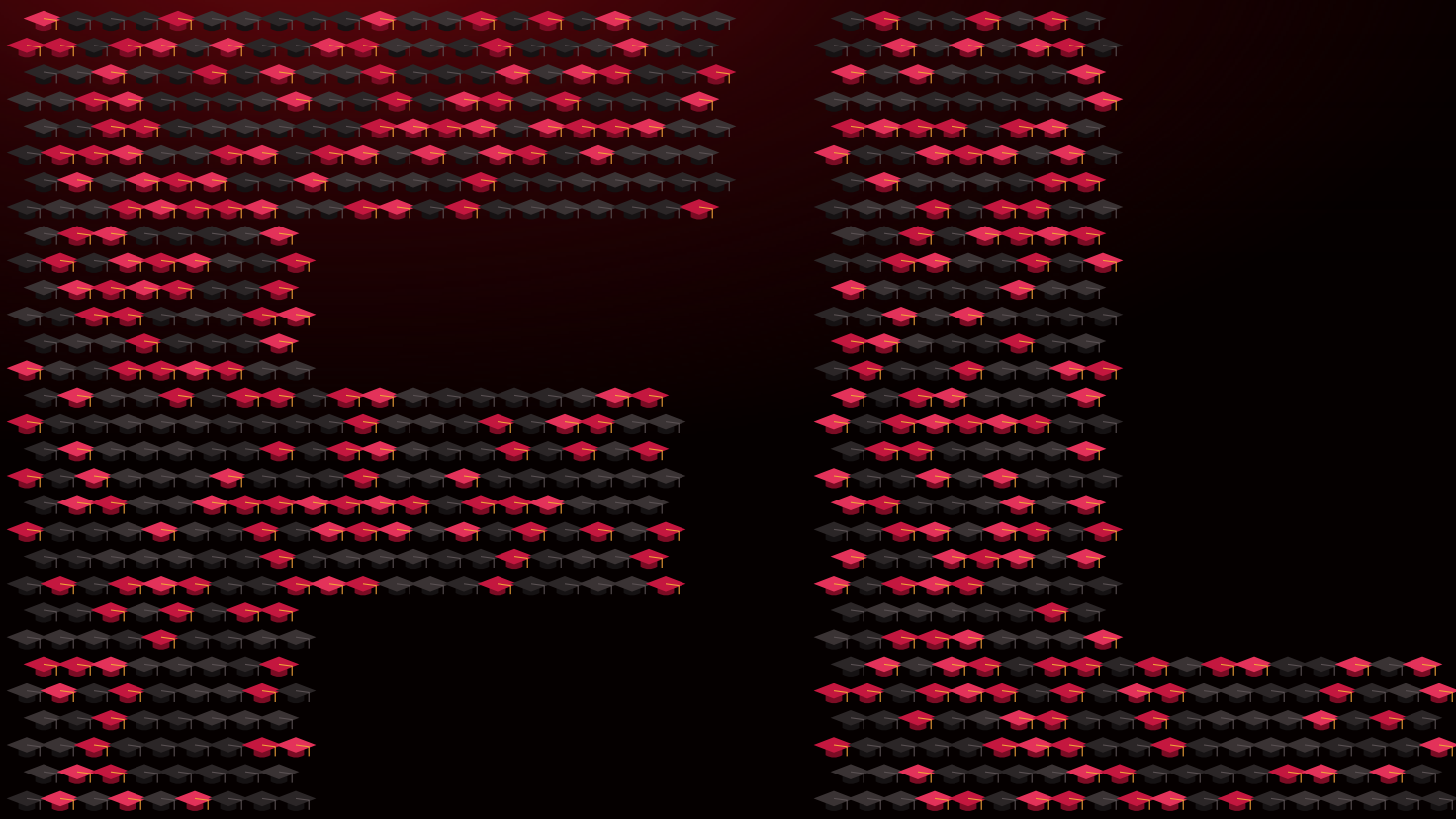
HAI Stanford University Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence

NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Florida Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **40 in every 100**, mark the international share of Florida's STEM master's degrees.



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Stanford University
Human-Centered
Artificial Intelligence

The 2026 Florida Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Florida: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

How to Cite this Profile

Emerson V. Johnston and Amy Zegart, “The 2026 Florida Talent Profile,” Technology Policy Accelerator, Hoover Institution, and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, November 2026.

Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Florida Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Florida's numbers say

1. **International students earn 40% of Florida's STEM master's degrees,** 12.4 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 28th of 51 on dependence. The share is 47% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 5.3% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Florida awarded 3.53K STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 3.0% of the U.S. total and 12th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +84%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in computer & info sciences,** where international students earned 66% of master's degrees (3.32K degrees; U.S. 65%). One STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates is majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Florida ranks 5th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Florida 40%, New York 64%, Illinois 66%, Arizona 41%, Texas 62%.
5. **81% of Florida's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 2.3% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (23.1K) than residents left (22K), a net gain of 1.12K; the top destination for those leaving was Georgia.

40%

of the STEM master's degrees Florida awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

1.05M #4

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · −3.4% since 2015

3.53K #12

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · +84% since 2015

40% #28

International share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · +2.0 pp since 2015

13% #25

International share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · +0.9 pp since 2015

22% #29

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · +5.7 pp since 2015

68% #12

Six-year graduation rate, 2024

U.S. **65%** · +9.7 pp since 2015

$12K #15

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · +34% since 2015

81% #9

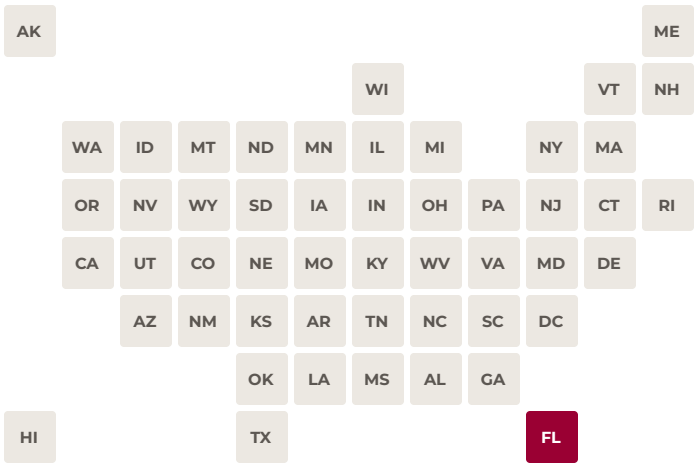
First-time students from in state, 2024

+1.2 pp since 2016

$97.4K #22

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · −5.8% since 2016



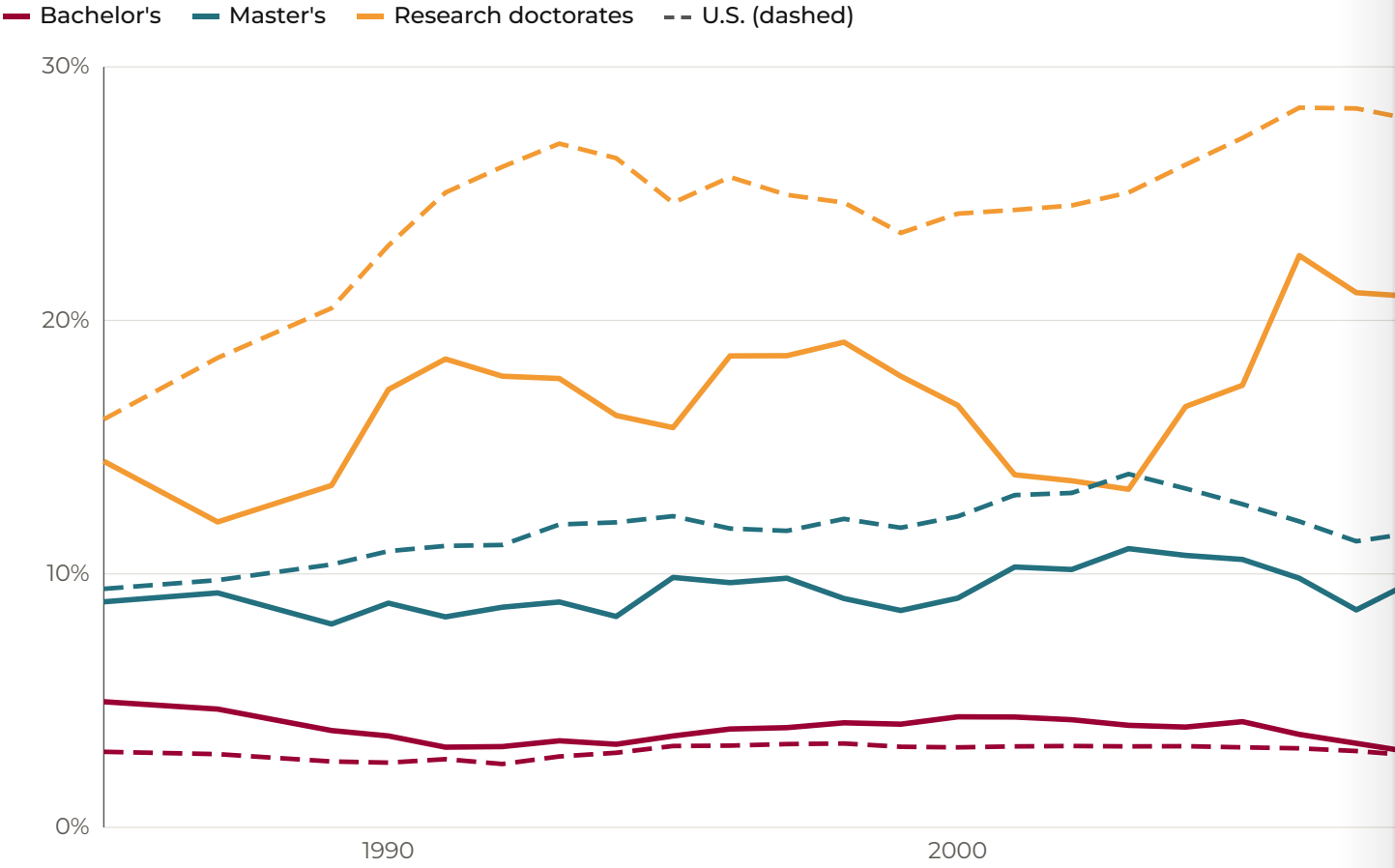
Badges give Florida's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Florida ranks 28th of 51 on the international share of STEM master's, at 40% in 2025 against 52% for the U.S.

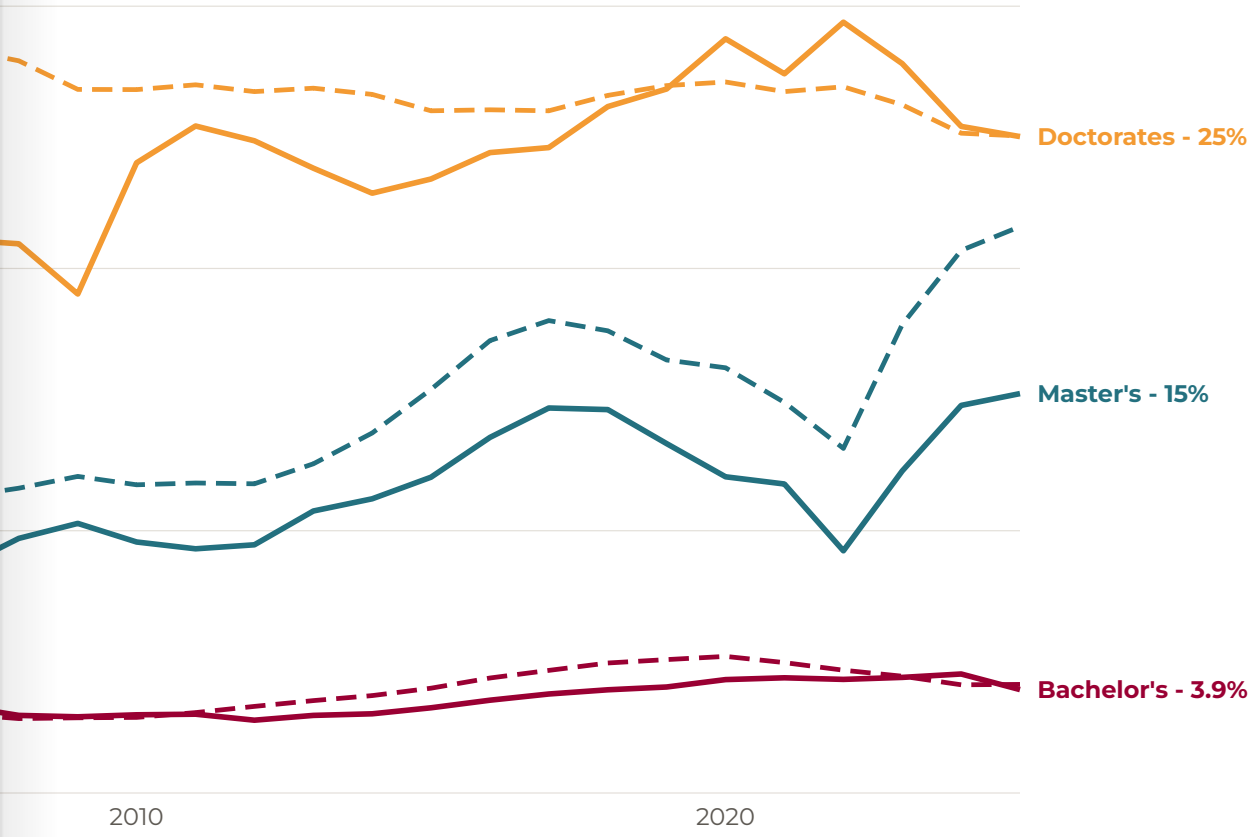
Figure 1 What Share of Florida's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025

International students make up 13% of Florida's graduate enrollment and 4.4% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 3.9% of bachelor's, 15% of master's and 25% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 5.3% of STEM bachelor's, 40% of STEM master's and 47% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 3.0% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 12th of 51.



5.

13%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **25th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

15%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

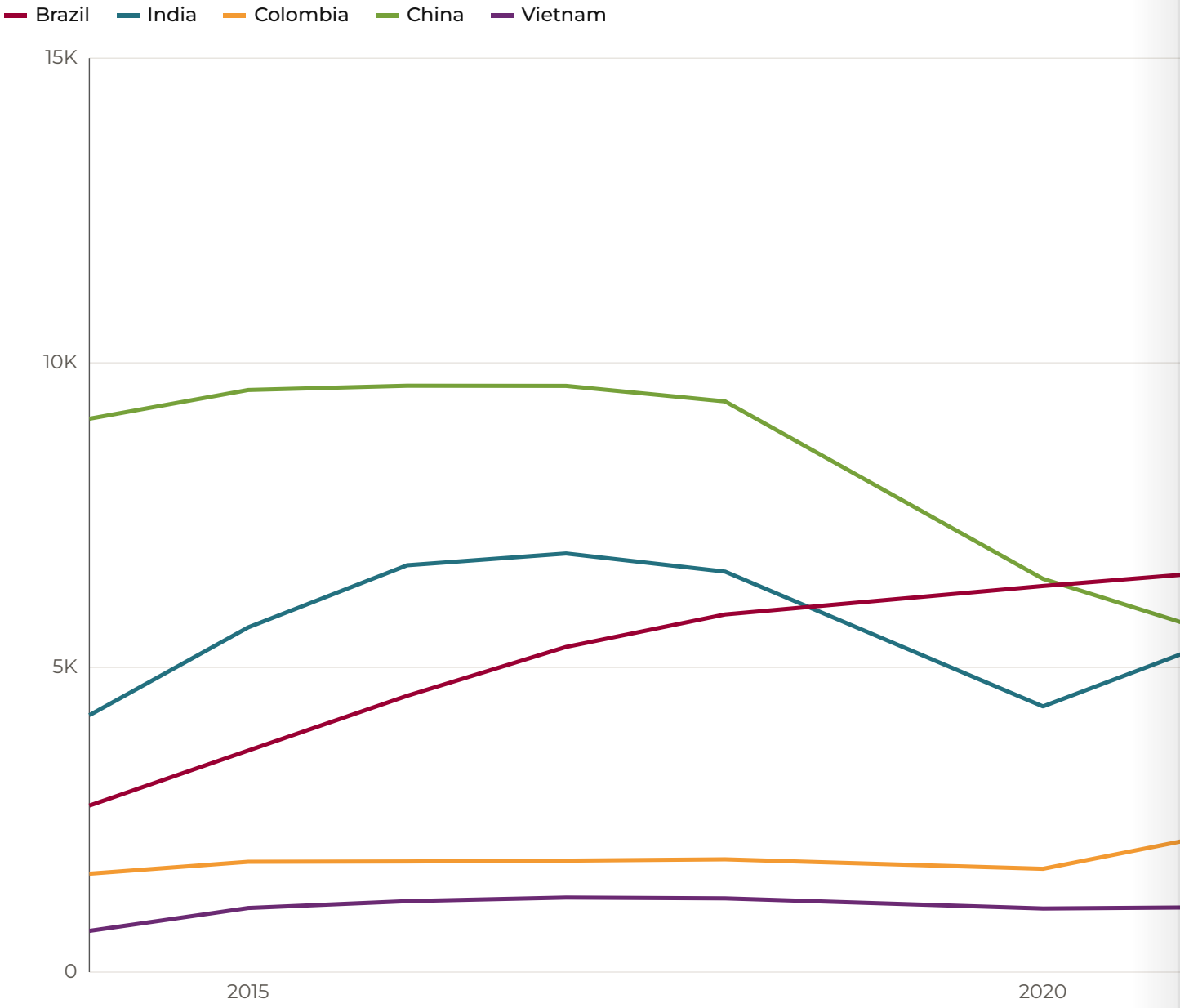
U.S. **22%** · **26th** of 51 · +3.2 pp since 2015

40%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

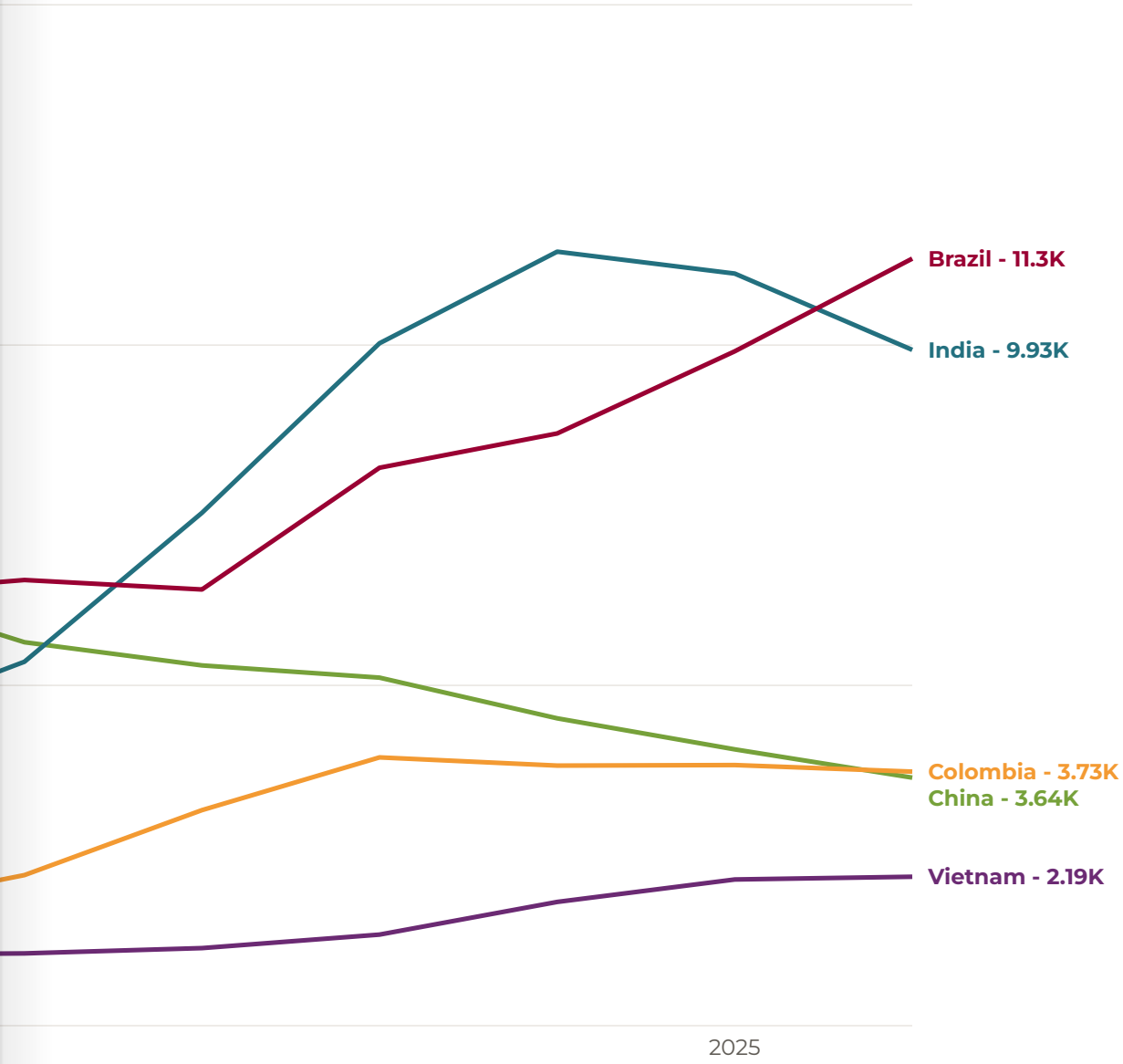
U.S. **52%** · **28th** of 51 · +2.0 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do Florida's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the mor

In October 2026, Florida had 66.5K active international students in SEVIS, 5th of 51. Brazil accounted for 17% of them and India for 15%, against 3.4% and 27% nationally. Students came from 193 countries, but the two largest supplied 32%. The state's total is up 19% since 2015, when it stood at 56K.



nth closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

66.5K

Active international students, October 2026

5th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

17%

From Brazil

U.S. **3.4%**

45%

In STEM fields

U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

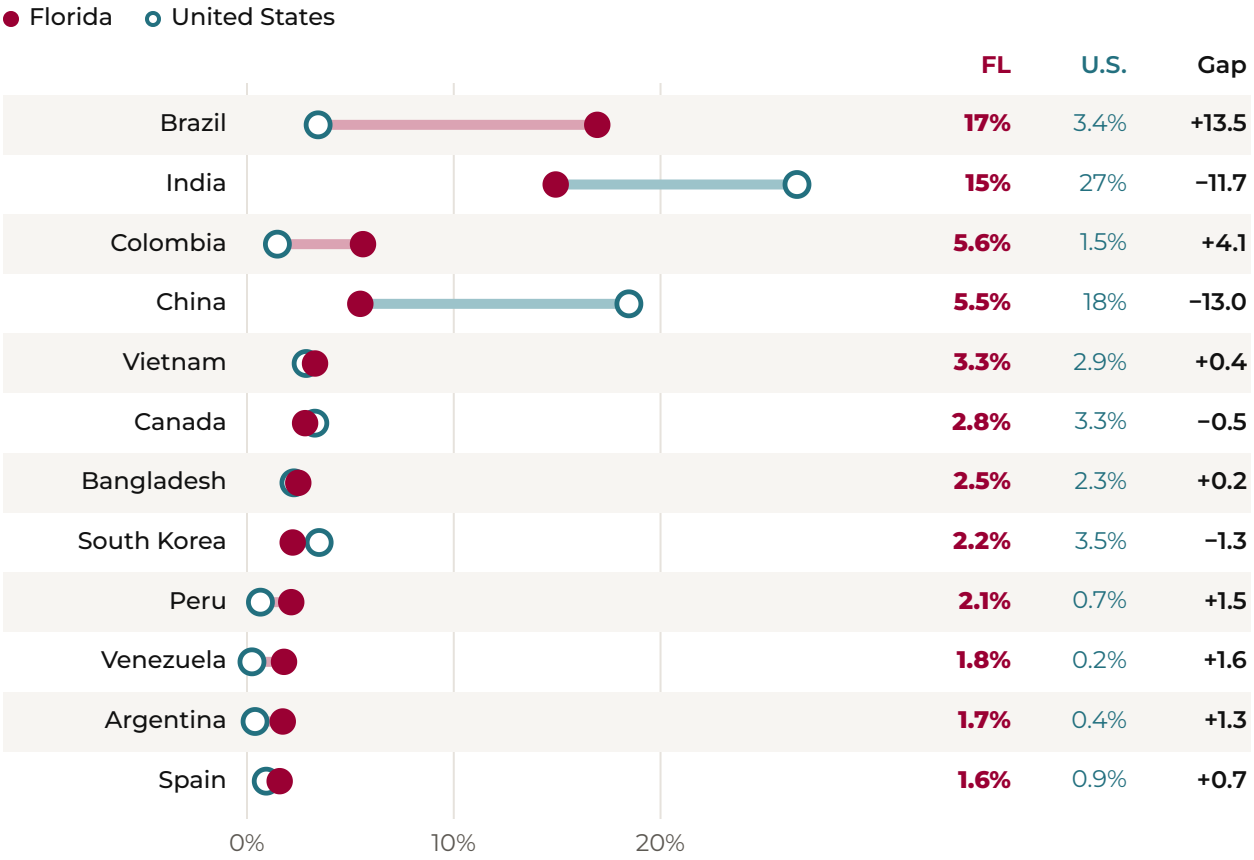
How Does Florida's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, Florida had **66.5K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 5th among the 50 states and DC and **5.6%** of the U.S. total. They came from 193 countries.

Brazil supplied **17%** of them, against 3.4% nationally, and India **15%**, against 27%. Colombia (5.6%), China (5.5%), and Vietnam (3.3%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **32%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 35th among the states, against 27% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is Florida's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

66.5K
Active international students, October 2026
5th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

17%
From Brazil
U.S. **3.4%**

15%
From India
U.S. **27%**

193
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 0.1% from 2025 and up 19% since 2015, when it stood at 56K. Its share of all U.S. international students is up 0.9 points since 2015, to **5.6%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Brazil went from 3.64K to 11.3K, India's from 5.66K to 9.93K, and Colombia's from 1.81K to 3.73K.

Over the same years, the number from China went from 9.55K to 3.64K and Vietnam's from 1.05K to 2.19K. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in Florida, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	56K	66.6K	**66.5K**	+19%	1.19M	5th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	4.7%	5.3%	**5.6%**	+0.9 pp	–	5th
Countries of citizenship represented	200	195	**193**	−3.5%	219	3rd
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	31%	**32%**	+4.7 pp	45%	35th
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Brazil	3.64K	9.91K	**11.3K**	+210%	3.4%	17%
India	5.66K	11K	**9.93K**	+76%	27%	15%
Colombia	1.81K	3.83K	**3.73K**	+106%	1.5%	5.6%
China	9.55K	4.06K	**3.64K**	−62%	18%	5.5%
Vietnam	1.05K	2.15K	**2.19K**	+108%	2.9%	3.3%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply Florida's International STEM Students?

29.9K of Florida's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **45%** of the total against 63% nationally, up 77% since 2015.

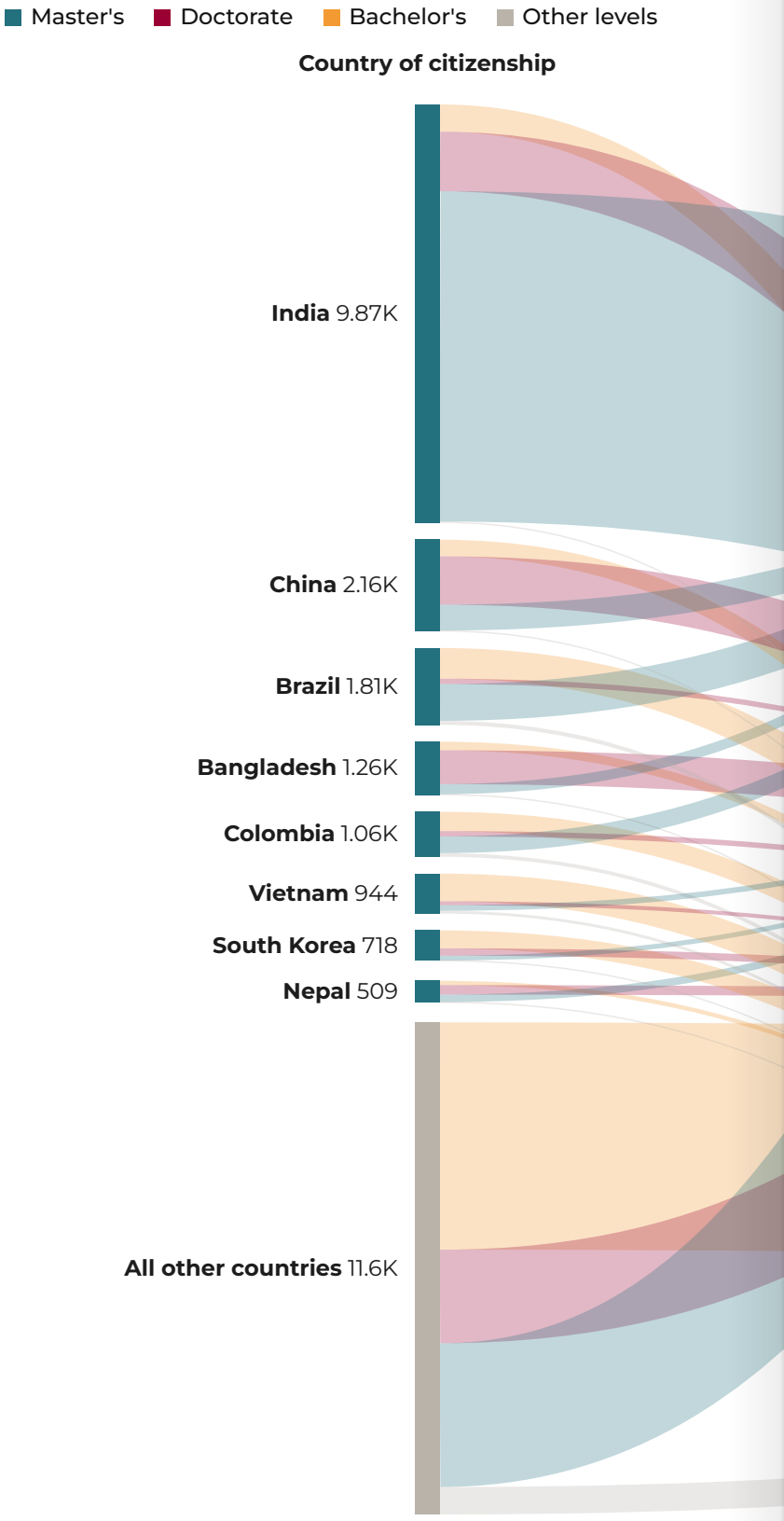
Master's students were the largest group, **13.7K**. India supplied 57% of them and Brazil 6.3%.

STEM doctoral students went from 4.25K in 2015 to **6.29K**, and STEM master's students from 6.3K to 13.7K.

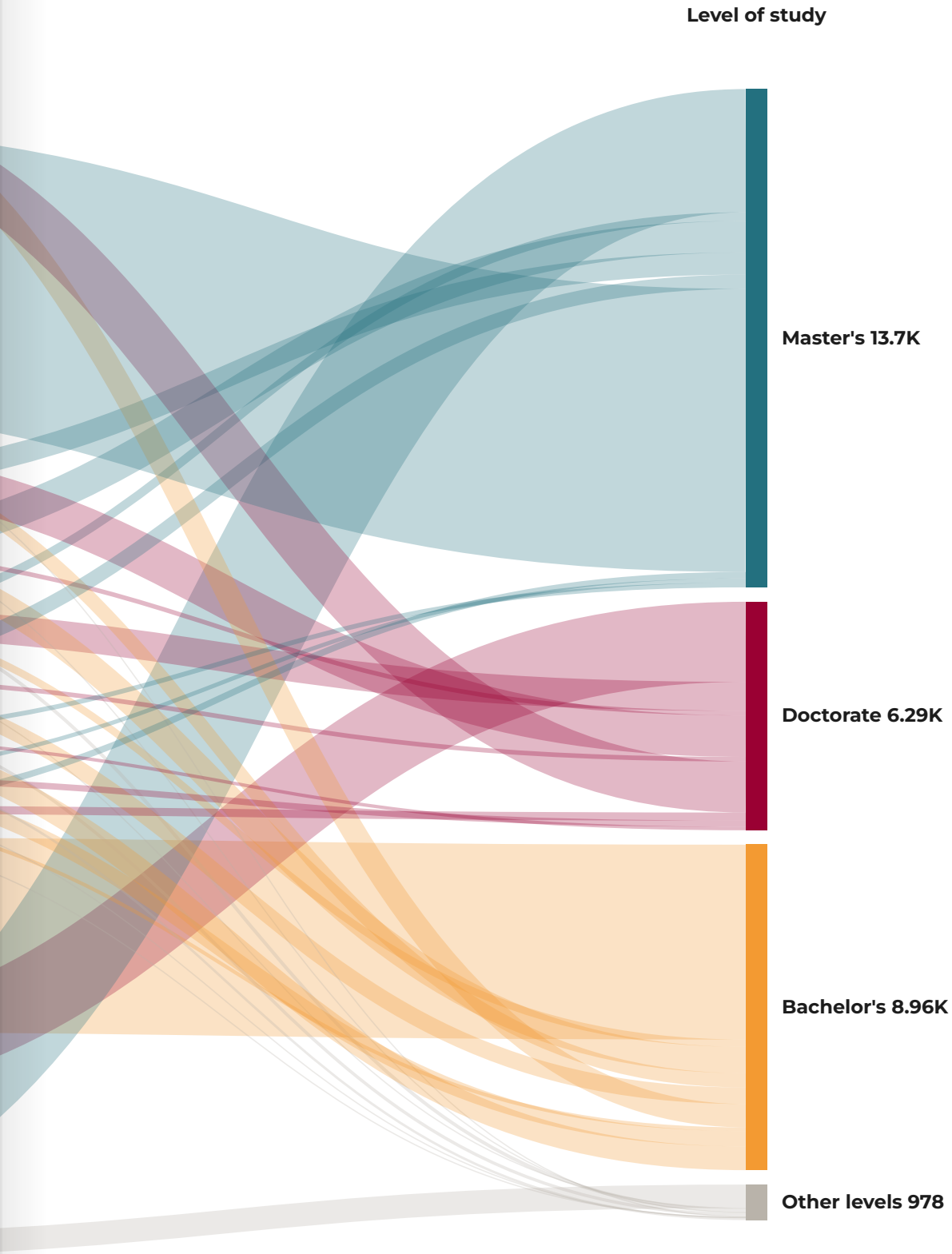
29.9K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **8th** of 51 · +77% since 2015

45%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

13.7K
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **8th** of 51 · 2.18× since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship an
2026.



d level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October

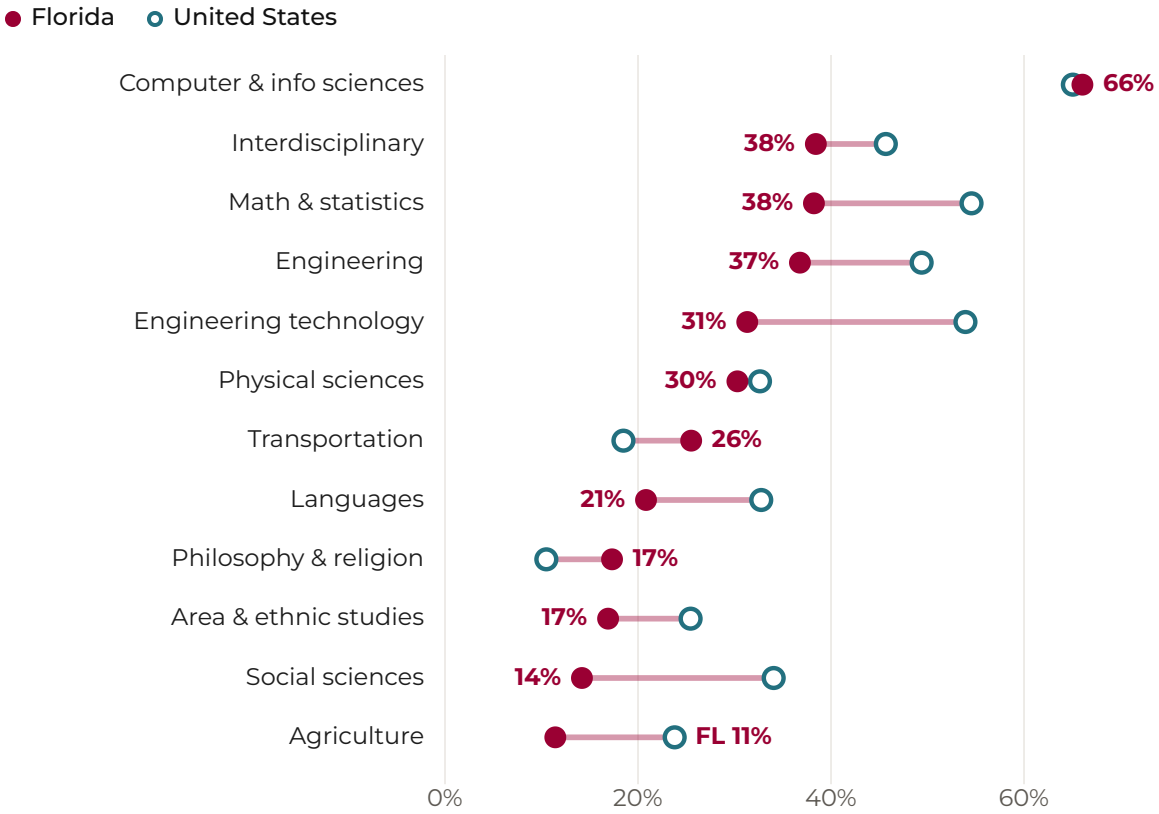
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are Florida's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Florida in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in computer & info sciences (66%, against 65% for the U.S.), interdisciplinary (38%, against 46% for the U.S.), and math & statistics (38%, against 55% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

15%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **26th** of 51

40%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **28th** of 51

66%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **22nd** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Florida first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 66% of the master's degrees in computer & info sciences, against 65% for the U.S.

Fields with an international majority. International students earned more than half of the master's degrees in one STEM field.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	5.4% / 8.6%	**66% / 65%**	57% / 56%
Engineering	8.4% / 7.2%	**37% / 49%**	58% / 55%
Engineering technology	2.6% / 4.5%	**31% / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	8.9% / 17%	**38% / 55%**	73% / 53%
Physical sciences	4.6% / 6.0%	**30% / 33%**	44% / 38%
Biological sciences	3.4% / 3.4%	**9.9% / 23%**	29% / 23%
Natural resources	2.1% / 2.0%	**8.3% / 17%**	15% / 27%
Architecture	4.8% / 7.3%	**11% / 29%**	59% / 55%

International share in Florida / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

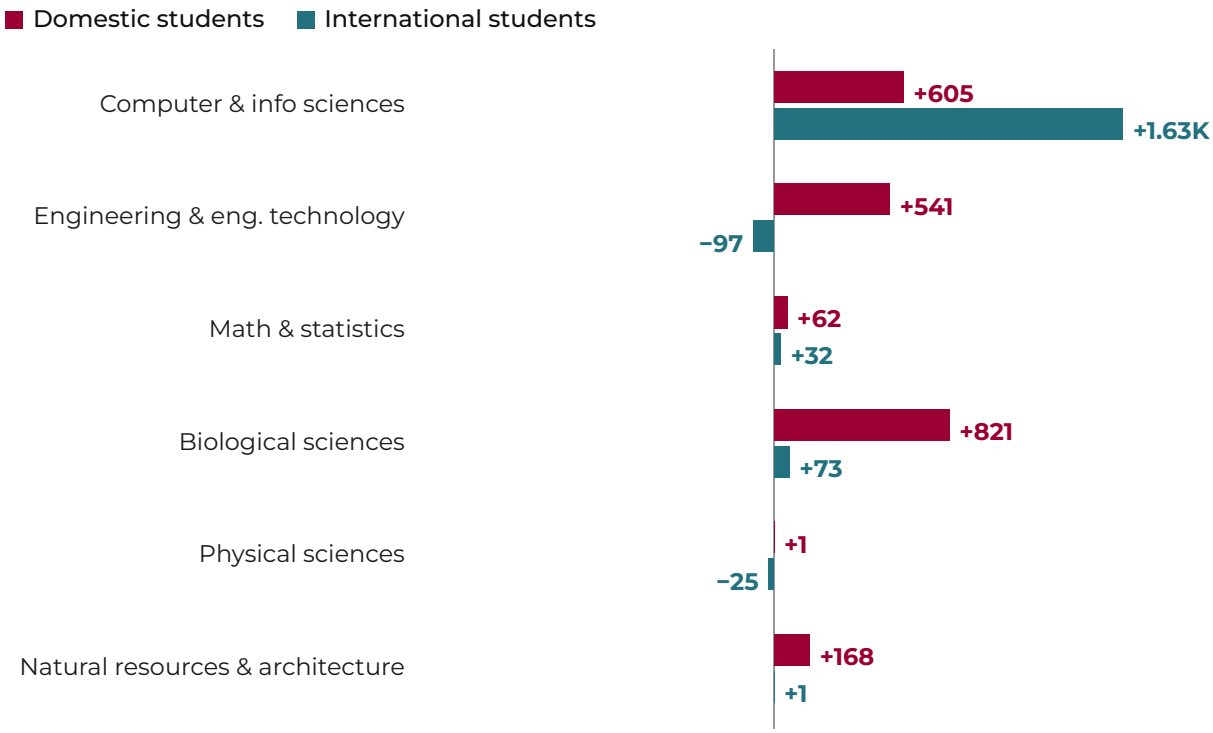
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has Florida's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Florida between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 8.89K in 2025 and 5.08K in 2015, a change of +1.62K for international students and +2.2K for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

3.53K
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **12th** of 51

22%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **22nd** of 51

3.0%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
12th of 51

6.7
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **16th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Florida in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 22% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 22nd among the states, up 0.3 points from 22% in 2024 and up 6.7 points since 2015, when it was 15%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	1.08K	**3.32K**	+207%	2.19K	52%	66%
Engineering & eng. technology	2.06K	**2.51K**	+22%	902	48%	36%
Math & statistics	233	**327**	+40%	125	40%	38%
Biological sciences	937	**1.83K**	+95%	181	12%	9.9%
Physical sciences	222	**198**	−11%	60	38%	30%
Natural resources & architecture	538	**707**	+31%	72	13%	10%

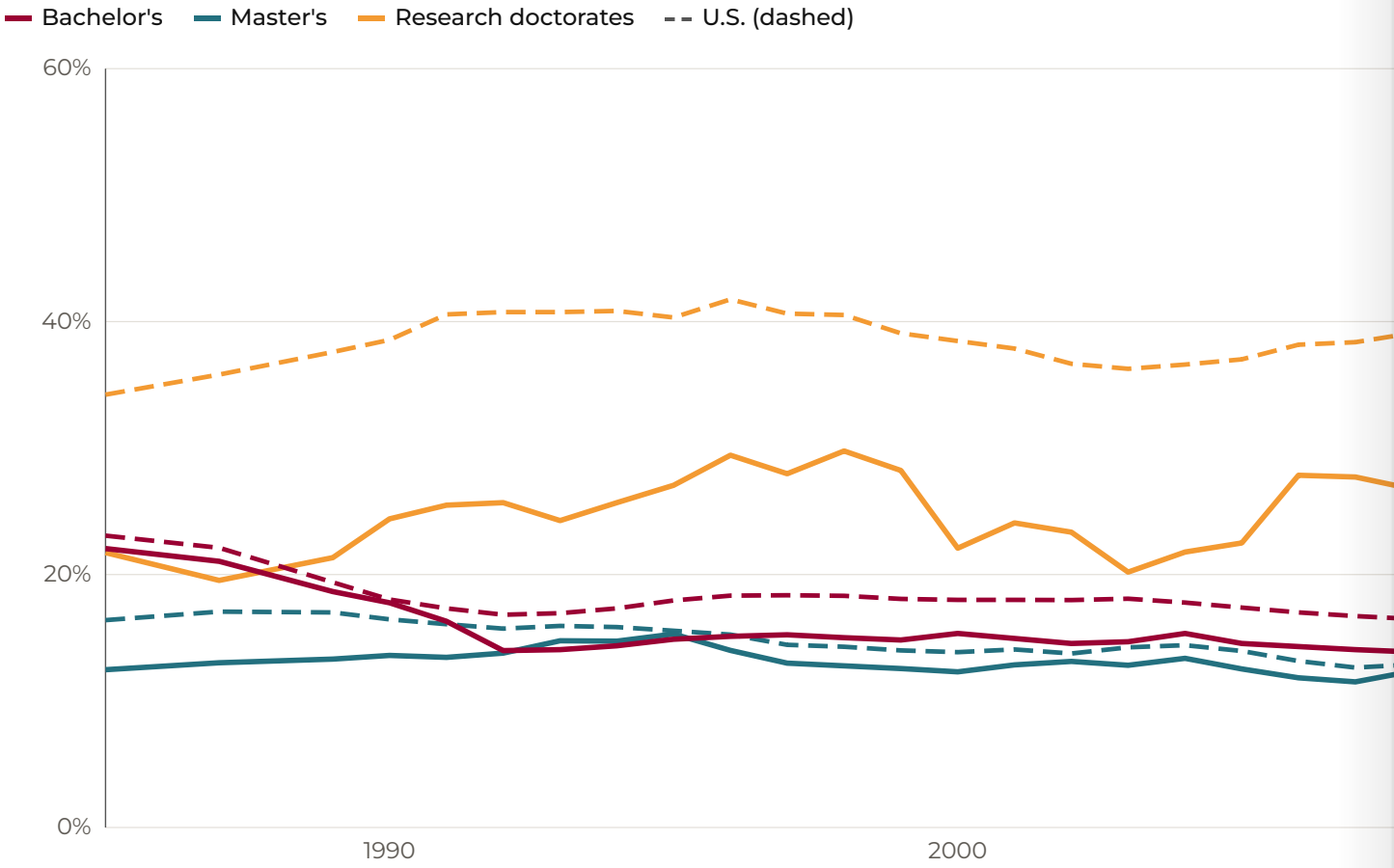
STEM master's degrees awarded in Florida, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Florida ranks 39th of 51 on the STEM share of research doctorates, at 35% in 2025 against 39% for the U.S.

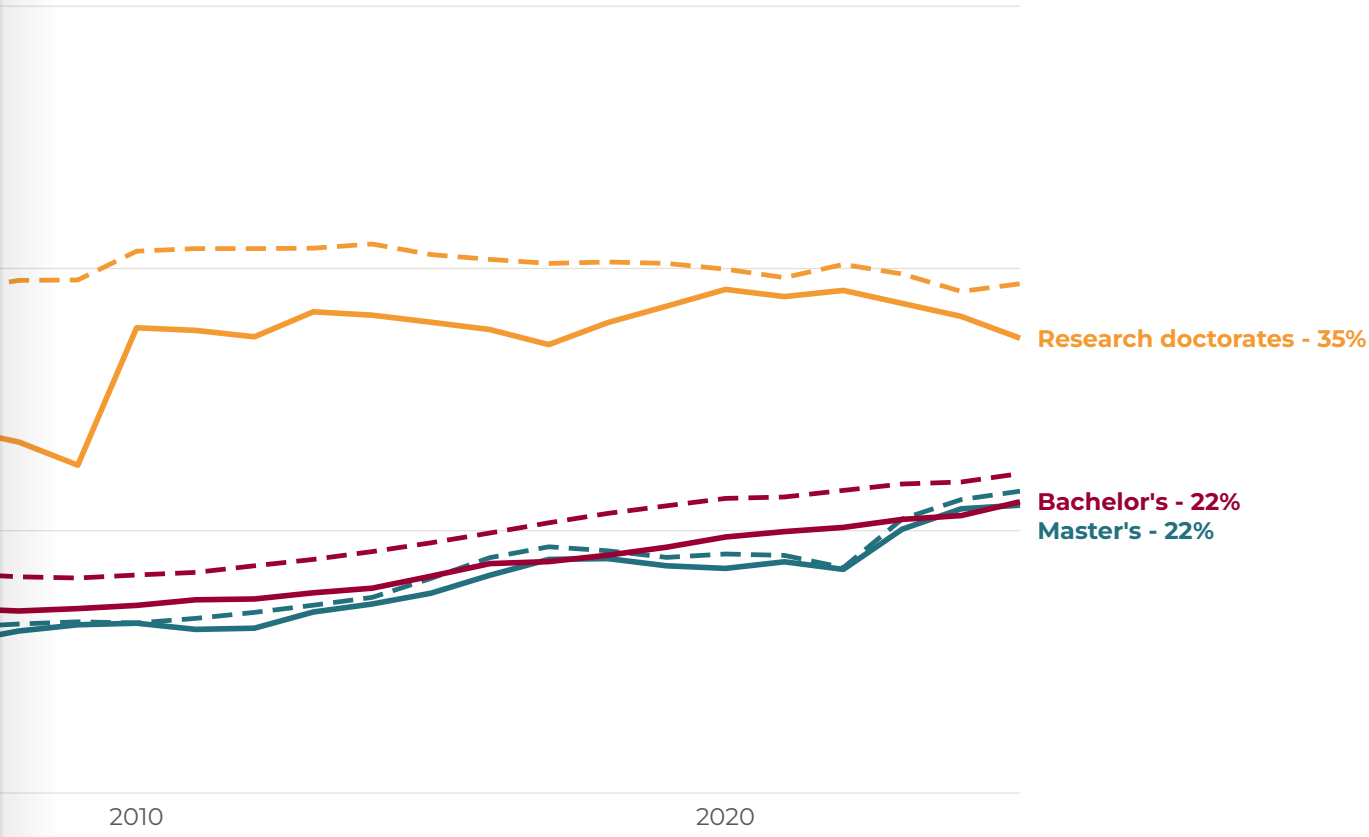
Figure 7 How Much of Florida's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 22% of Florida's bachelor's degrees, 22% of its master's and 35% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 6.7 points since 2015, and the state ranks 22nd of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 29th of 51.



22%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **29th** of 51 · +5.7 pp since 2015

22%

STEM share of master's, 2025

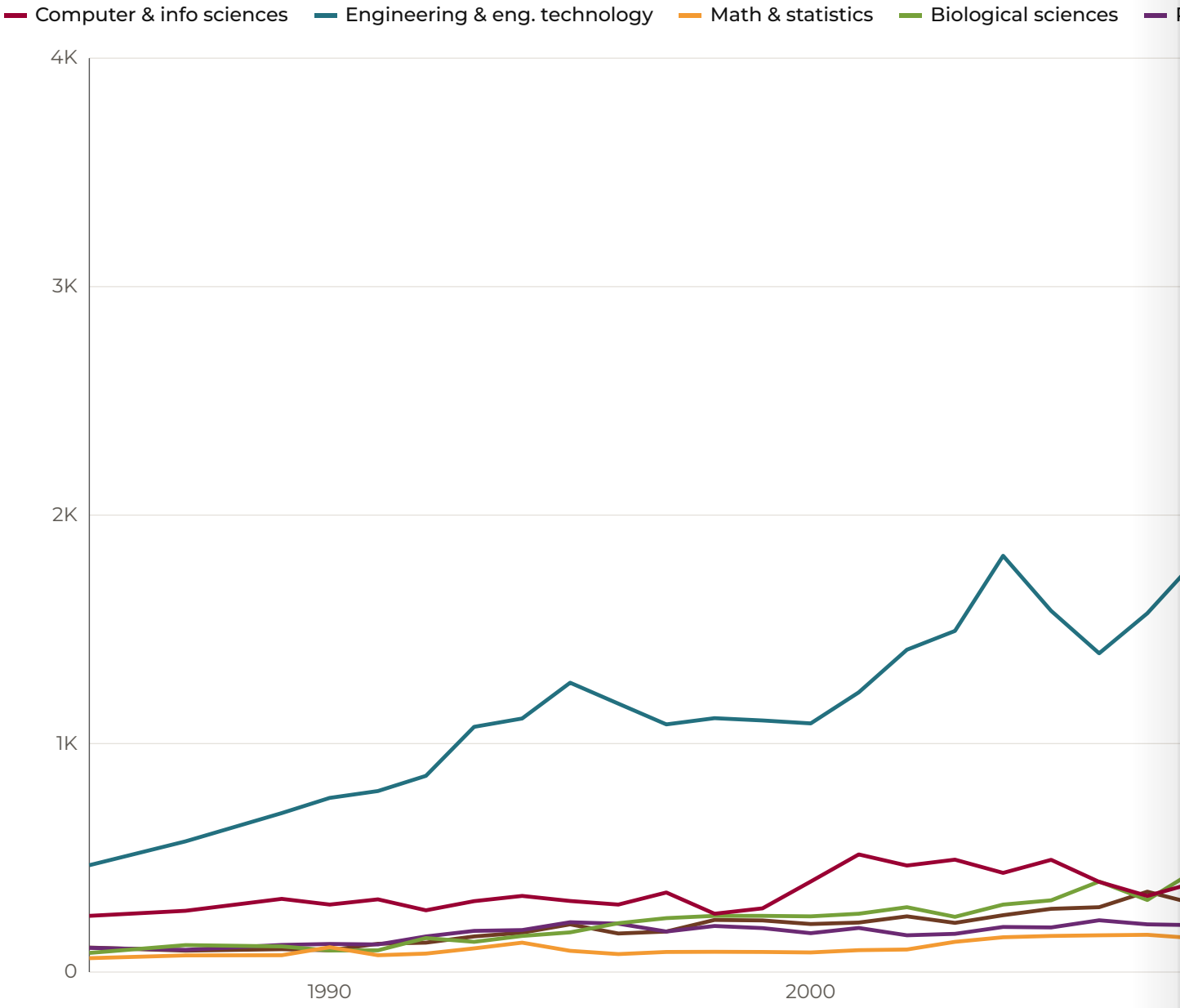
U.S. **23%** · **22nd** of 51 · +6.7 pp since 2015

35%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **39th** of 51 · −1.2 pp since 2015

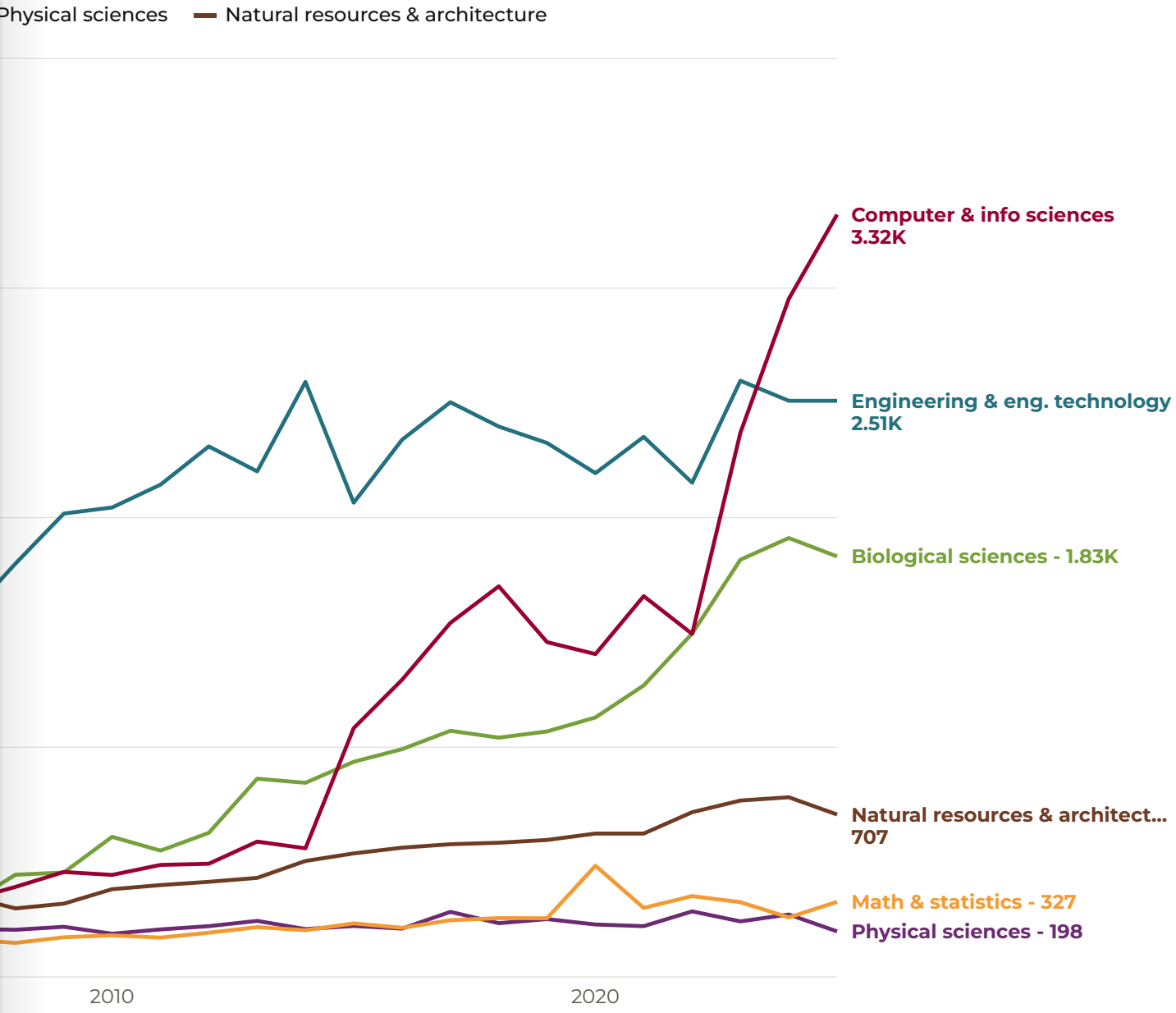
Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Florida's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 3.32K, followed by engineering & eng. technology (2.51K) and biological sciences (1.83K). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 207% since 2015.

International students earned 3.53K of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 3.0% of the national total (12th of 51).



3.53K

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **12th** of 51 · +84% since 2015

3.0%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

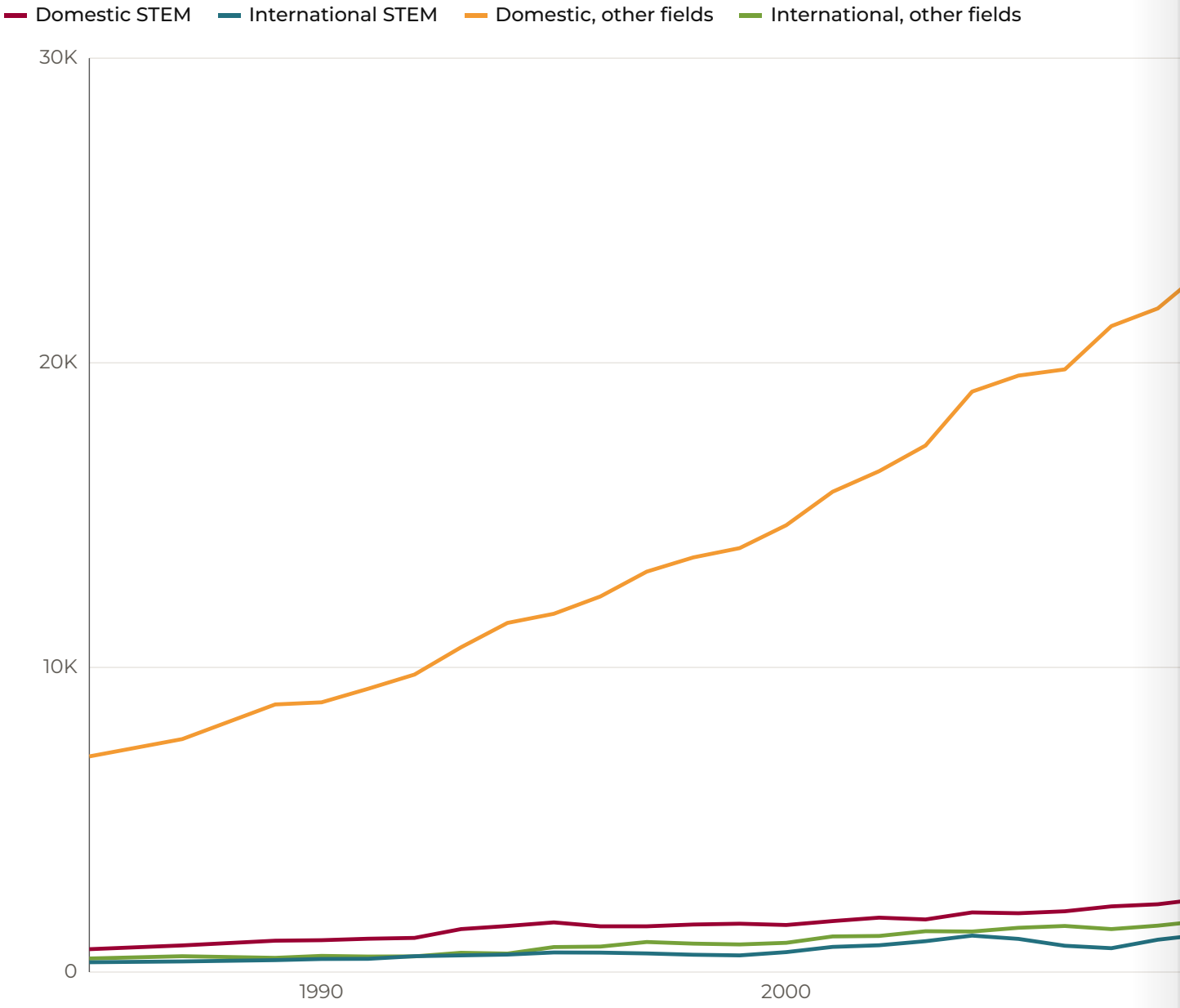
12th of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2015

66%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **22nd** of 47 · +14.3 pp since 2015

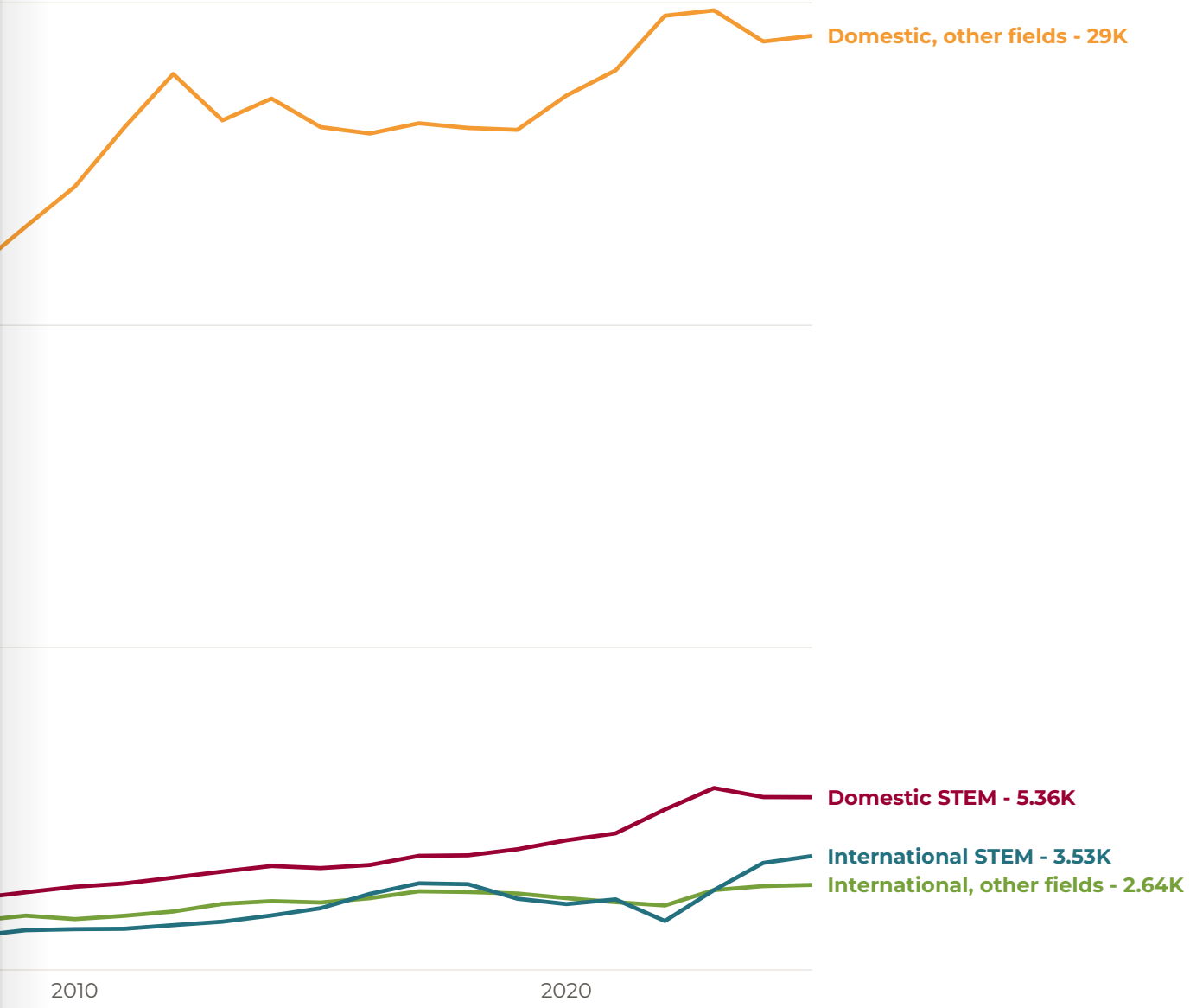
Figure 9 Who Earns Florida's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 1.62K more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 2.2K more to domestic students.

International students earn 40% of Florida's STEM master's but 8.3% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).



15%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **26th** of 51 · +3.2 pp since 2015

40%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **28th** of 51 · +2.0 pp since 2015

6.7

STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025

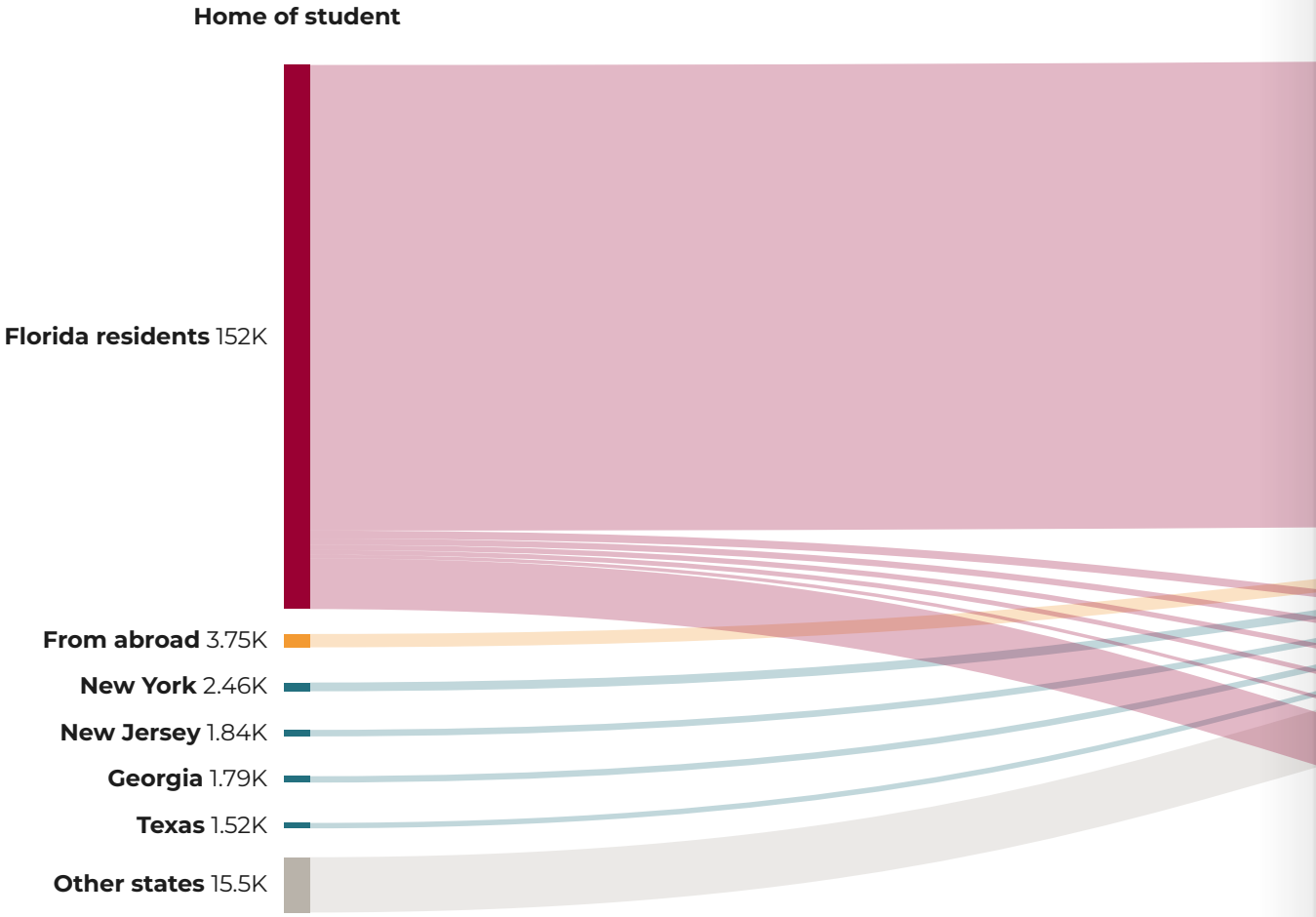
U.S. **6.4** · **16th** of 51 · +2.4 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Florida ranks 9th of 51 on the share of first-time students who are in-state residents, at 81% in 2024.

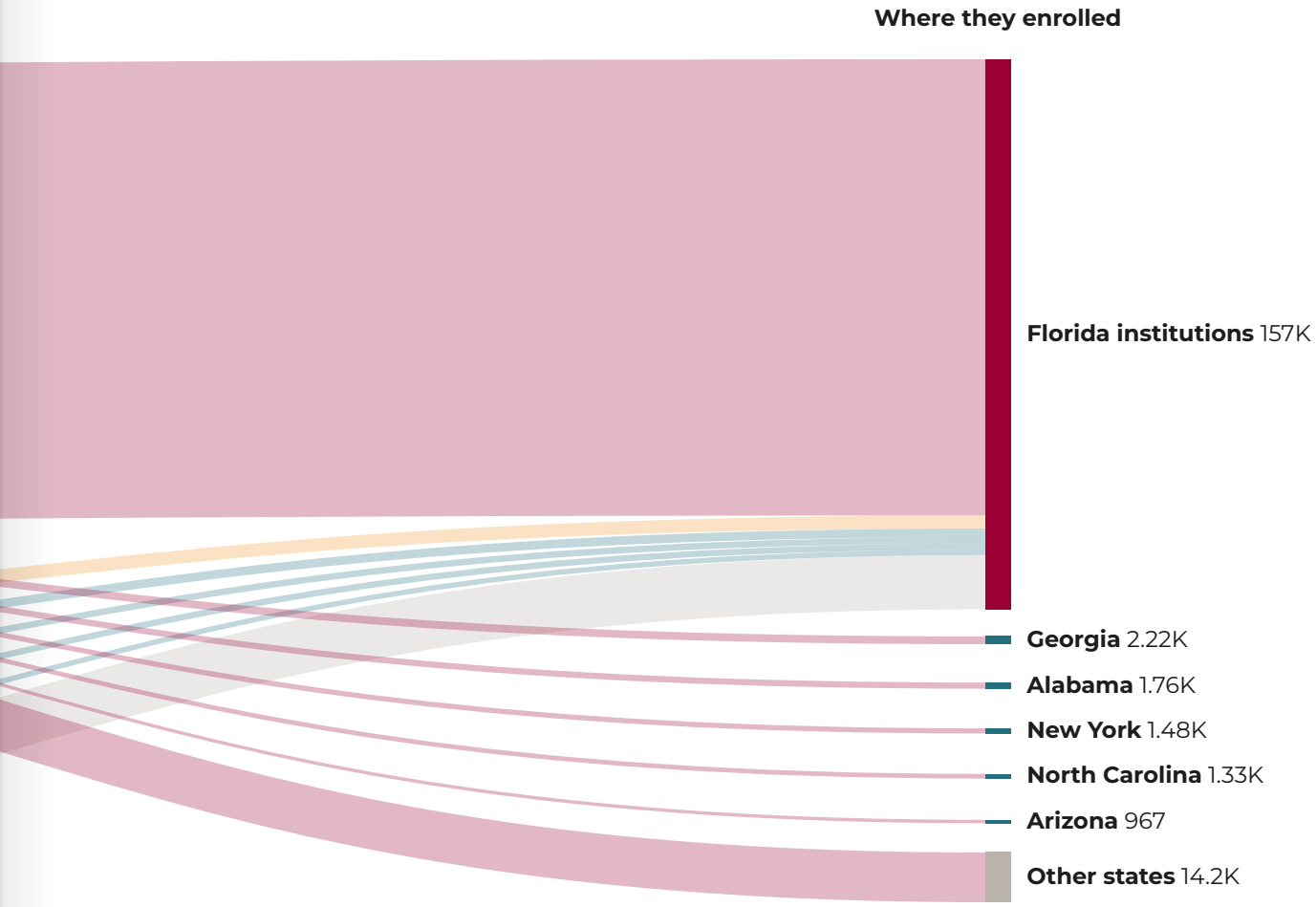
Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest s
Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

131K residents stayed in Florida for college in fall 2024; 23.1K students arrived from other states and 3.75K from abroad, while 22K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 81% of the state's first-time students are residents.



ources and destinations (more when states tie at the printed figure), the rest grouped; ties are ordered by exact count.

81%

First-time students from in state, 2024

9th of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2016

2.3%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

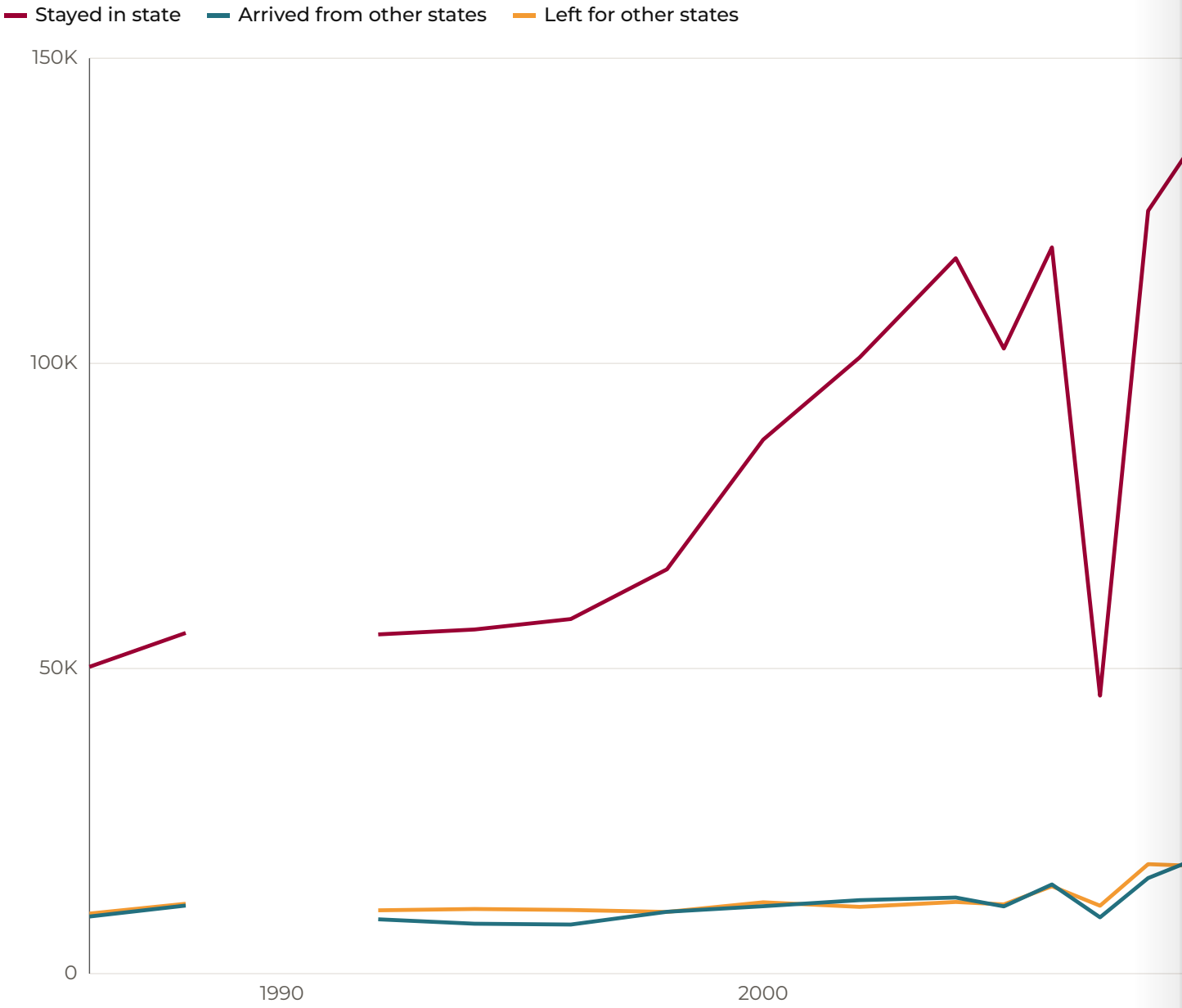
U.S. **3.1%** · **31st** of 51 · −0.2 pp since 2016

+1

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

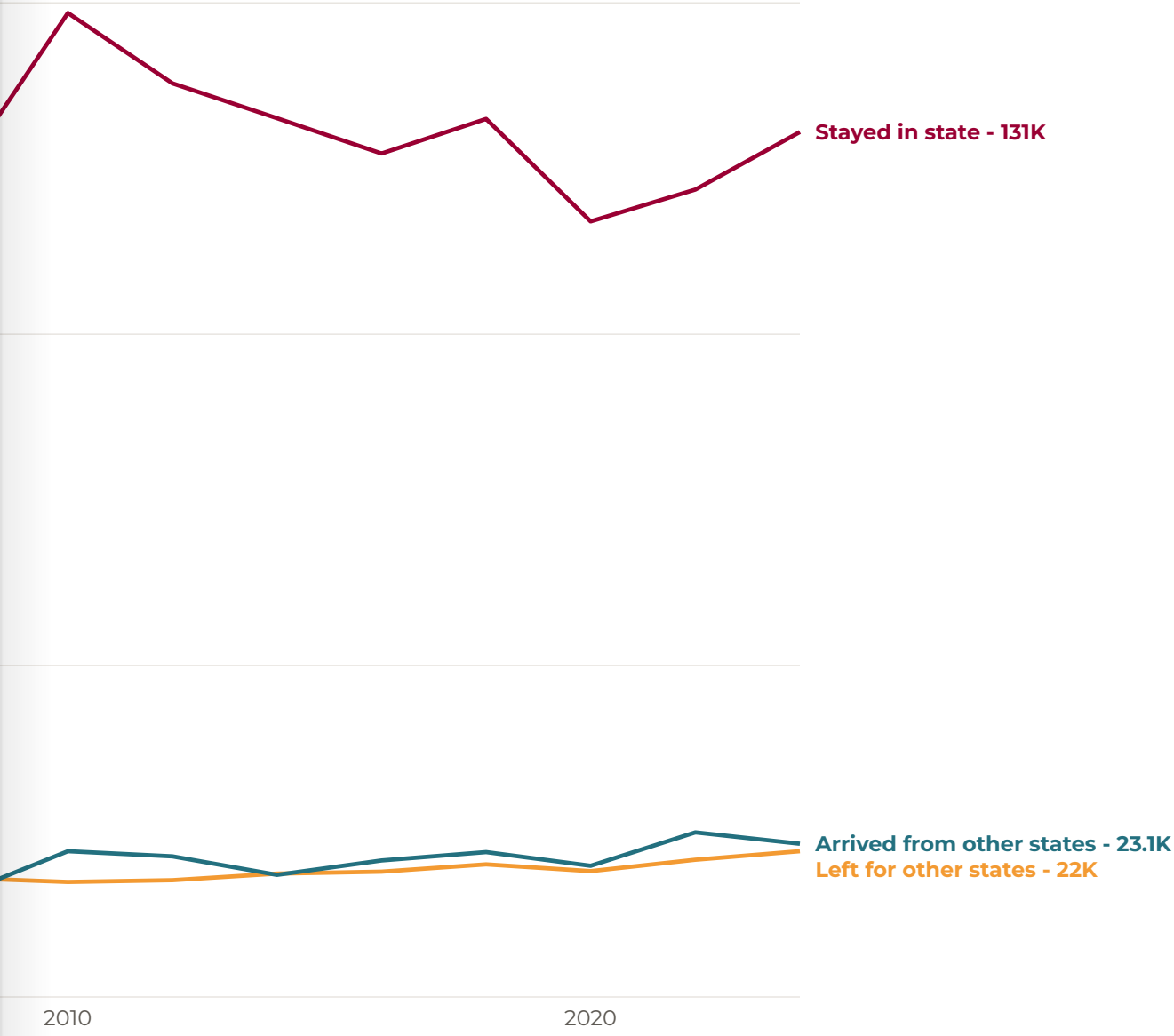
33rd of 51 · −0.4 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is up 3%, arrivals from other states are up 12%, and residents leaving are up 16%.



Net migration was +1 per 100 resident first-time students (33rd of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Georgia (2.22K).

Figure 12

Where Do Florida's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Florida's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

26.9K

First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024

Abroad **3.75K**

2.3%

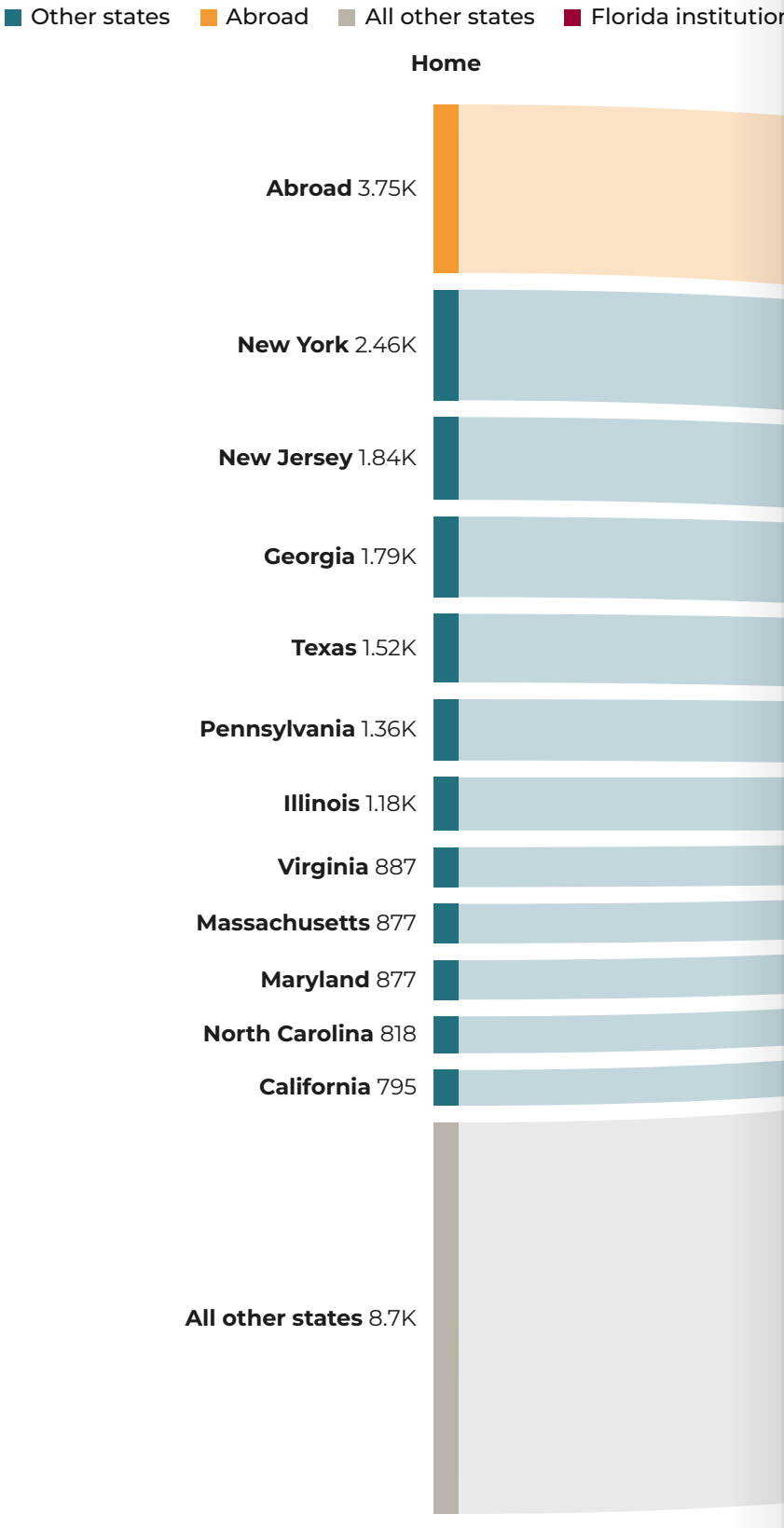
First-time students from abroad, 2024

U.S. **3.1%** · **31st** of 51 · −0.2 pp since 2016

81%

First-time students from in state, 2024

9th of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flo

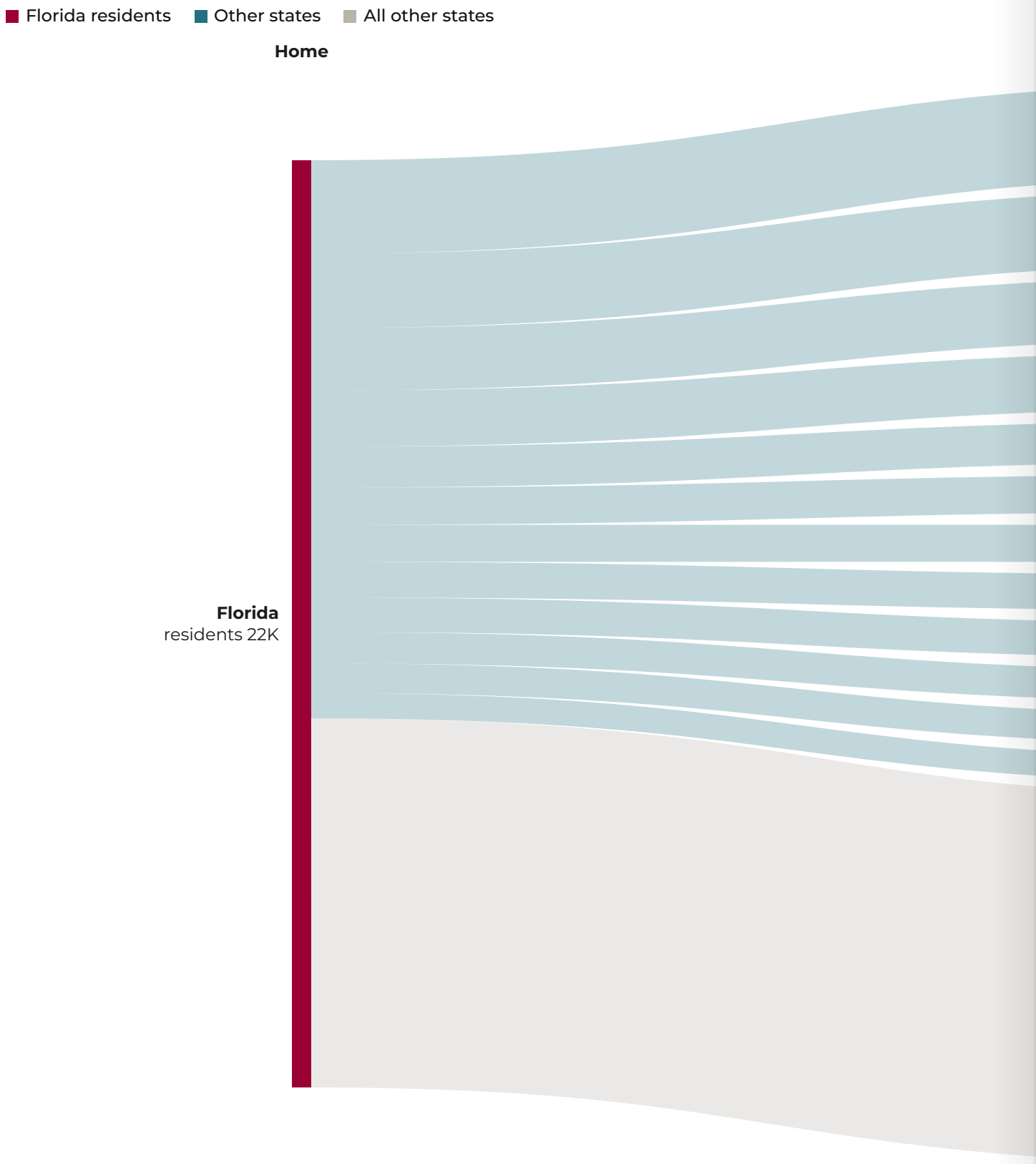
ns

Enrolled in

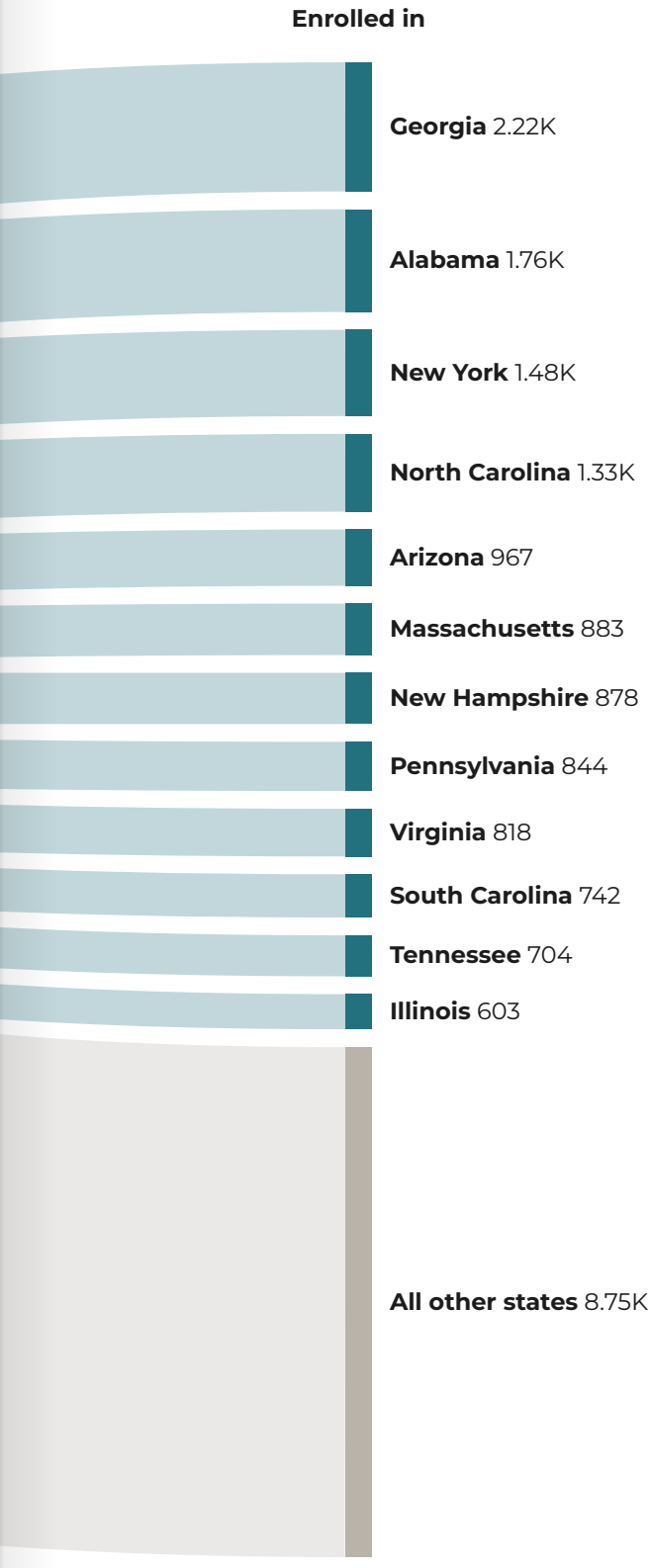


Florida
institutions 26.9K

ws (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ord



ered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do Florida's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where Florida residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 22K in fall 2024, up 6.2% from 20.7K in fall 2022 and up 16% since fall 2016, when it was 18.9K.

22K

Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024

Arrived from other states **23.1K** · **26.9K** with abroad

+1

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

33rd of 51 · −0.4 since 2016

2.22K

Went to Georgia

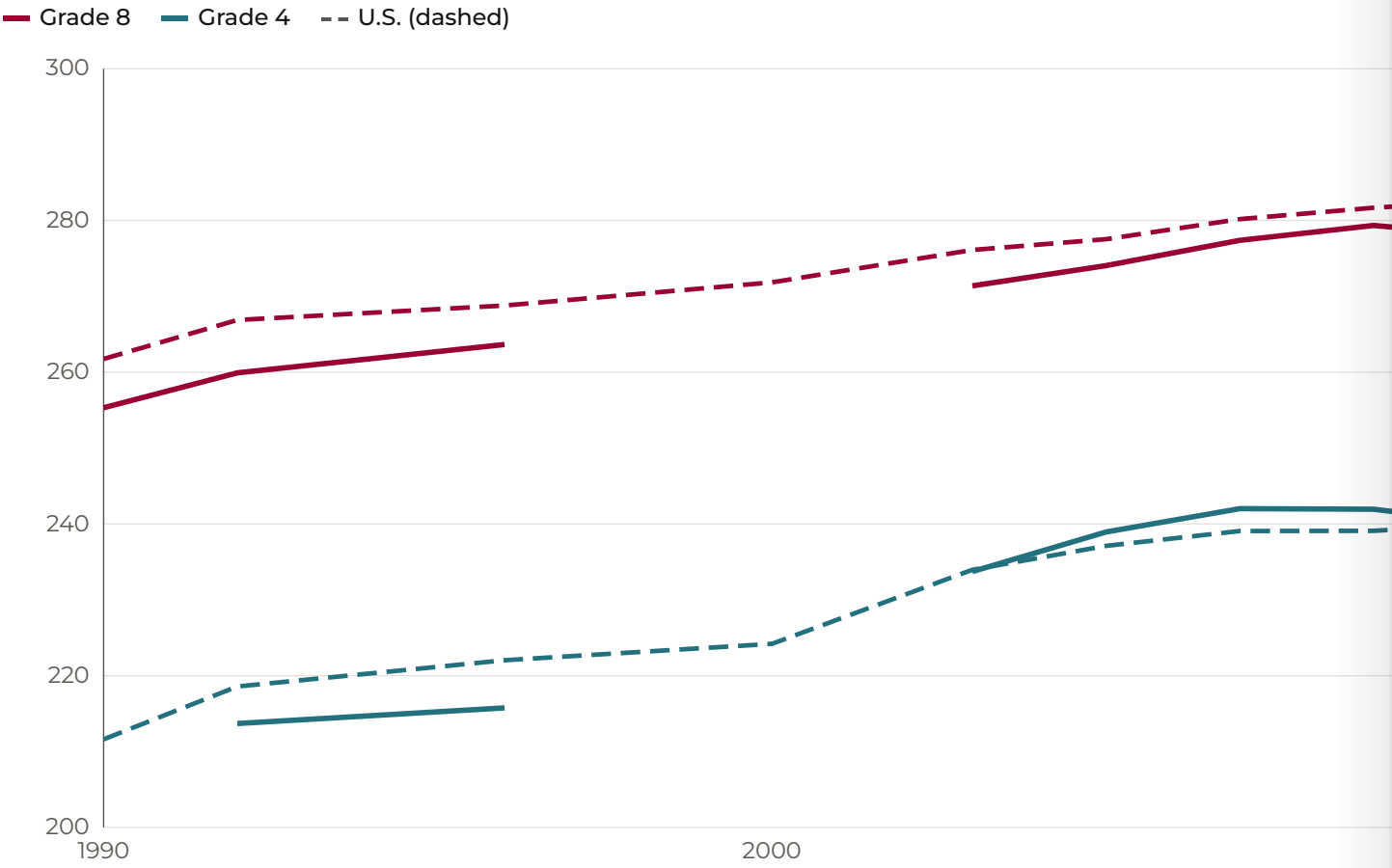
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Florida ranks 43rd of 51 on the average grade 8 reading score, at 253 in 2024 against 257 for the U.S.

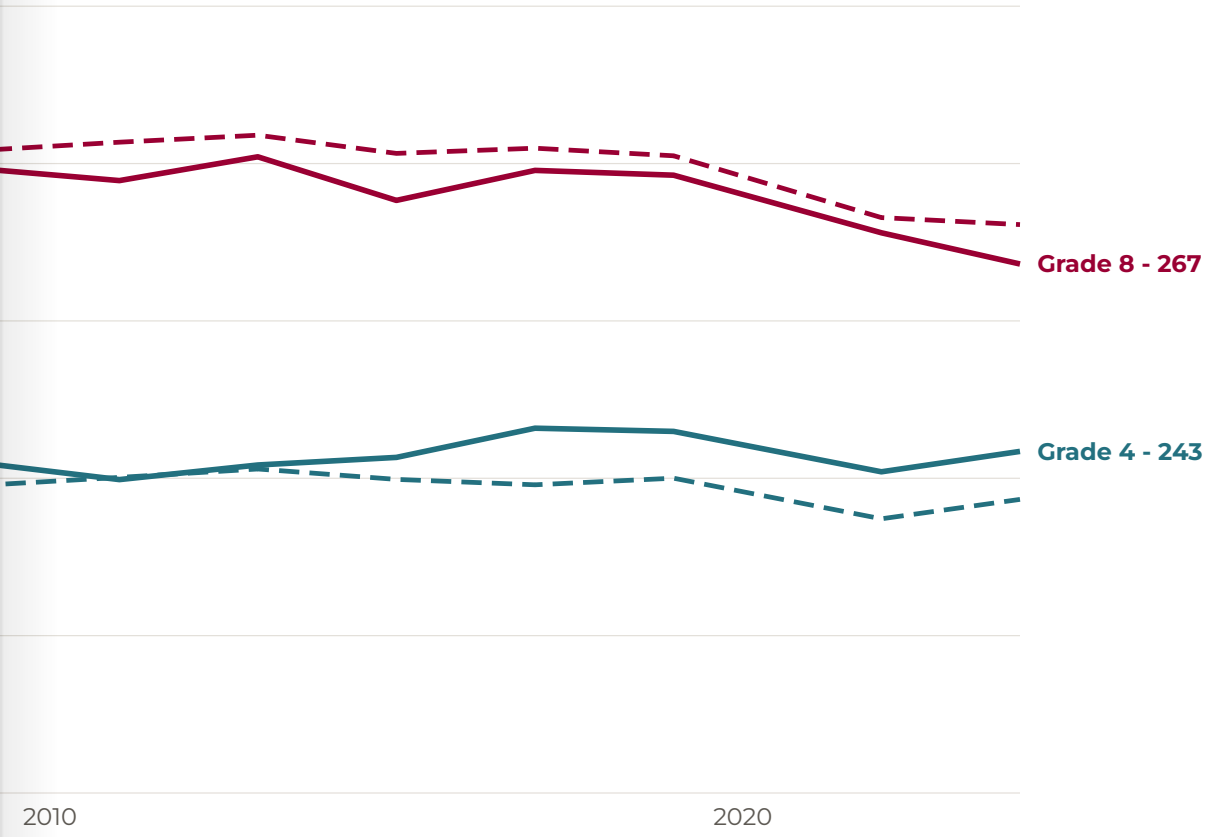
Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Florida's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, N

The talent pipeline starts in school. Florida's eighth graders averaged 267 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 41st of 51 among the states.

21% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.



lational Assessment of Educational Progress.

267

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **41st** of 51 · −8.1 since 2015

21%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **42nd** of 51 · −5.0 pp since 2015

253

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

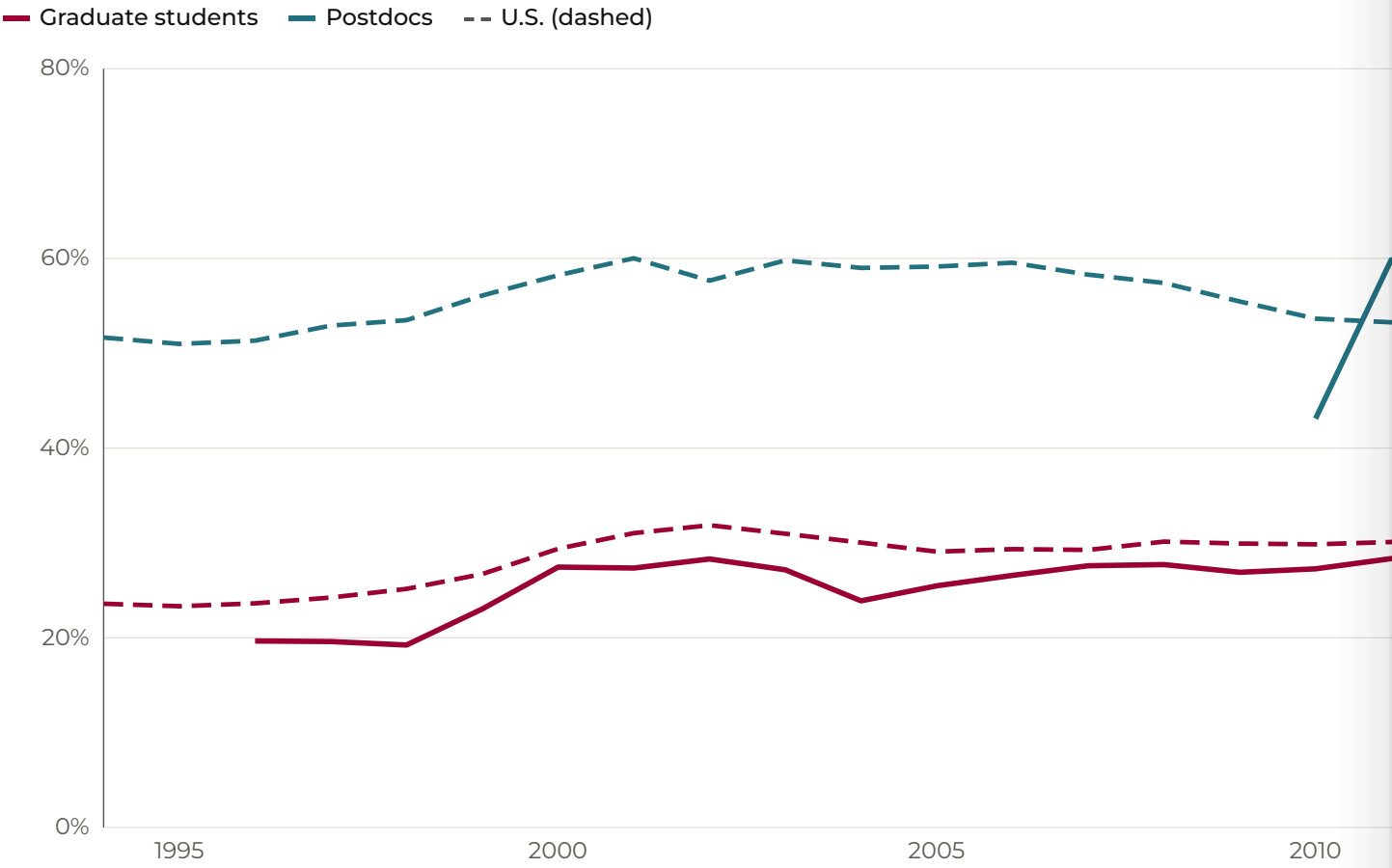
U.S. **257** · **43rd** of 51 · −10.5 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Florida ranks 7th of 51 on research doctorates awarded, at 2.5K in 2025 against 59K for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of Florida's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Tem



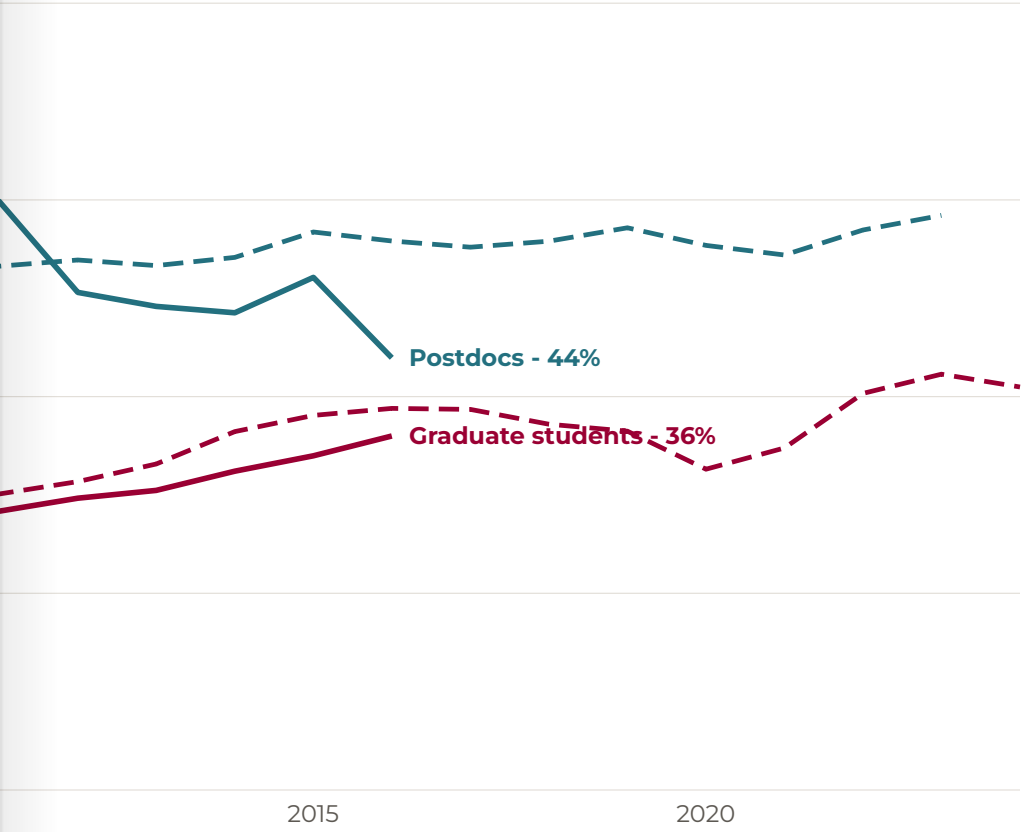
Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's sta
Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 36% of Florida's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 20th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 44% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 2.5K research doctorates in 2025, 4.2% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

porary Visas?



te; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate

36%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **20th** of 51 · +2.0 pp since 2015

44%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **42nd** of 51 · −8.2 pp since 2015

2.5K

Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

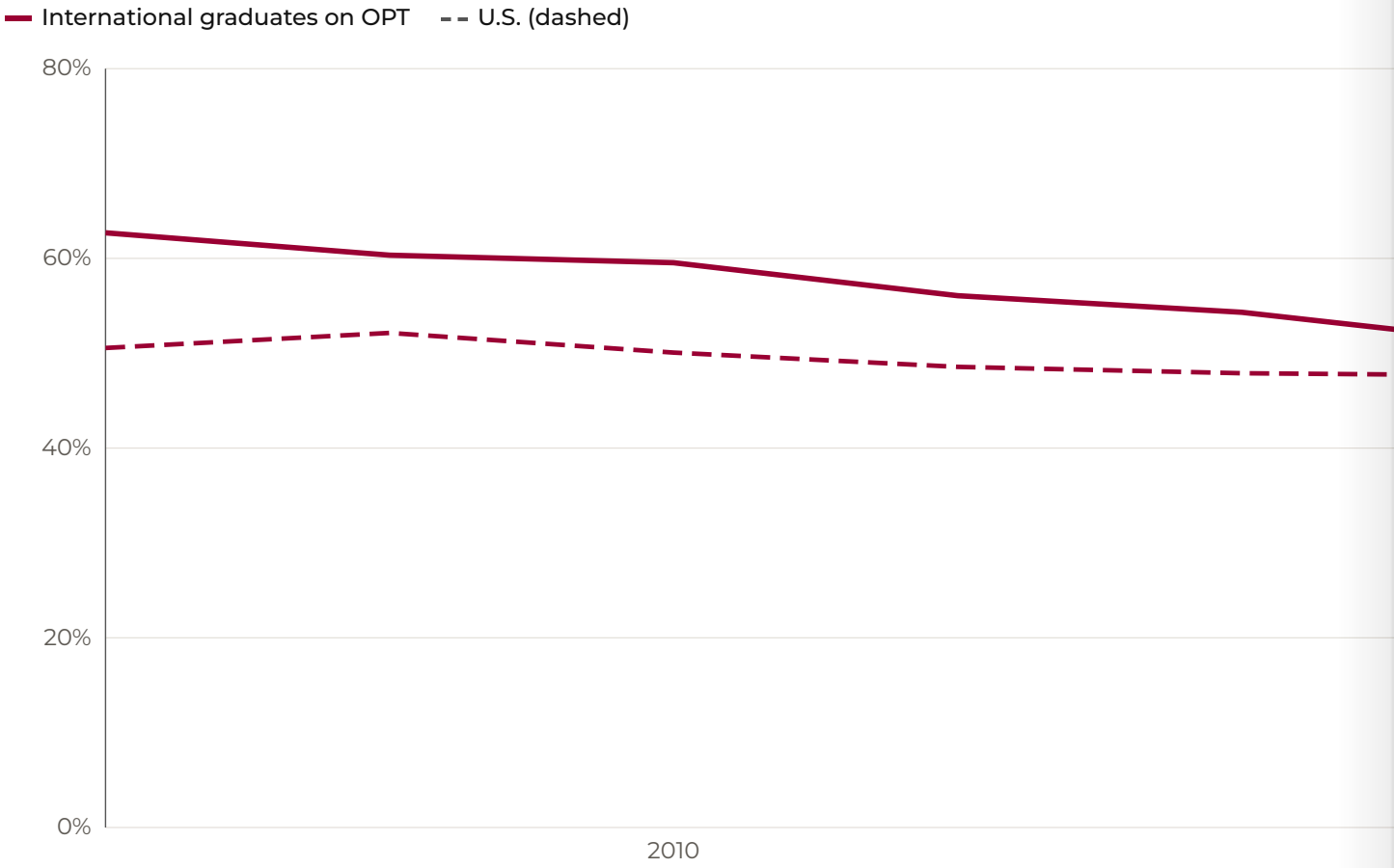
U.S. **59K** · **7th** of 51 · +5.7% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Florida ranks 11th of 51 on the share of international graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied, at 49% in 2016 against 44% for the U.S.

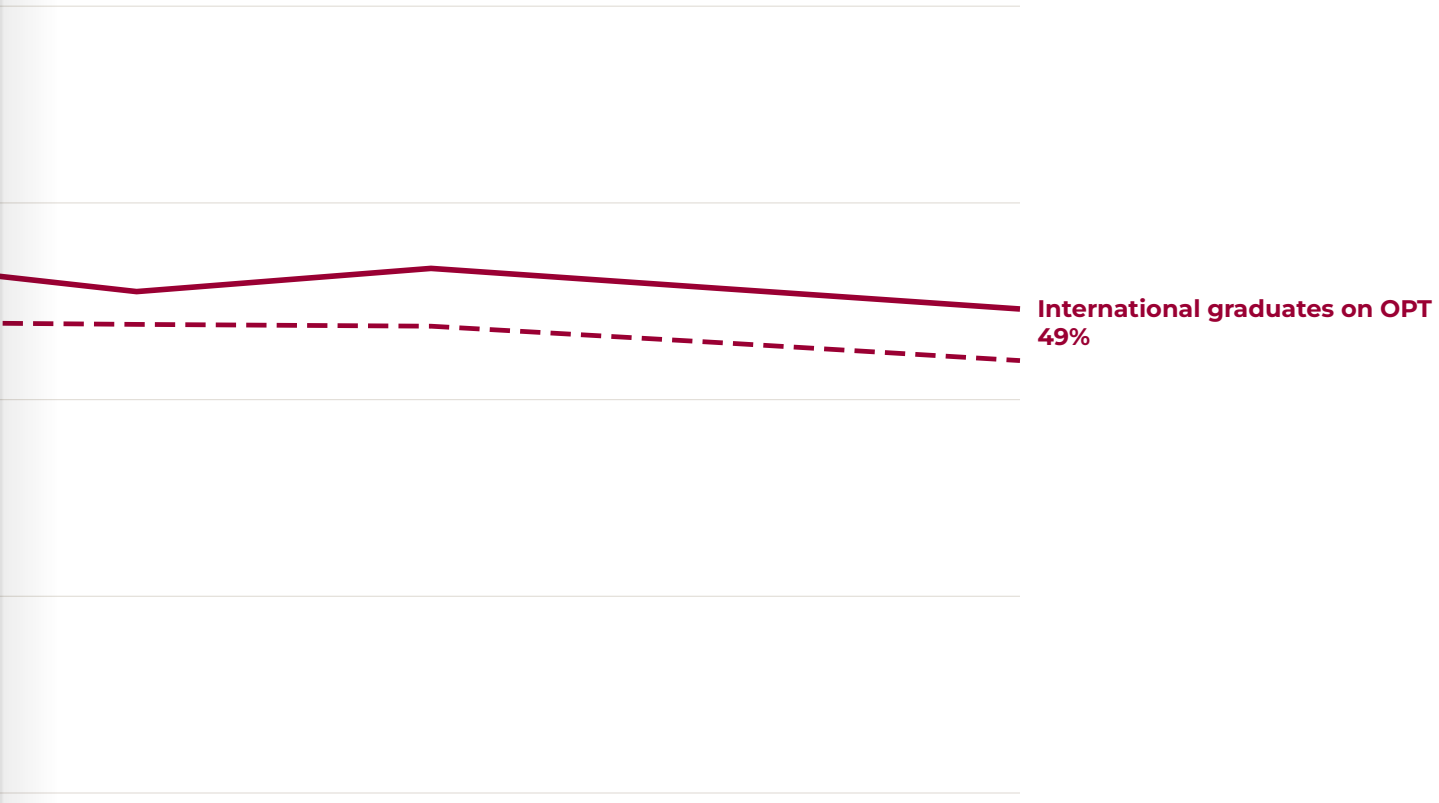
Figure 16 How Many of Florida's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Burea
state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or particip

Florida's institutions do not take part in the Census Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes program, so in-state employment of its graduates is not published.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 49% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state gained 0.7 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).



au, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the
pating states dashed.

49%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **11th** of 51 · −2.1 pp since 2015

+0.7

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

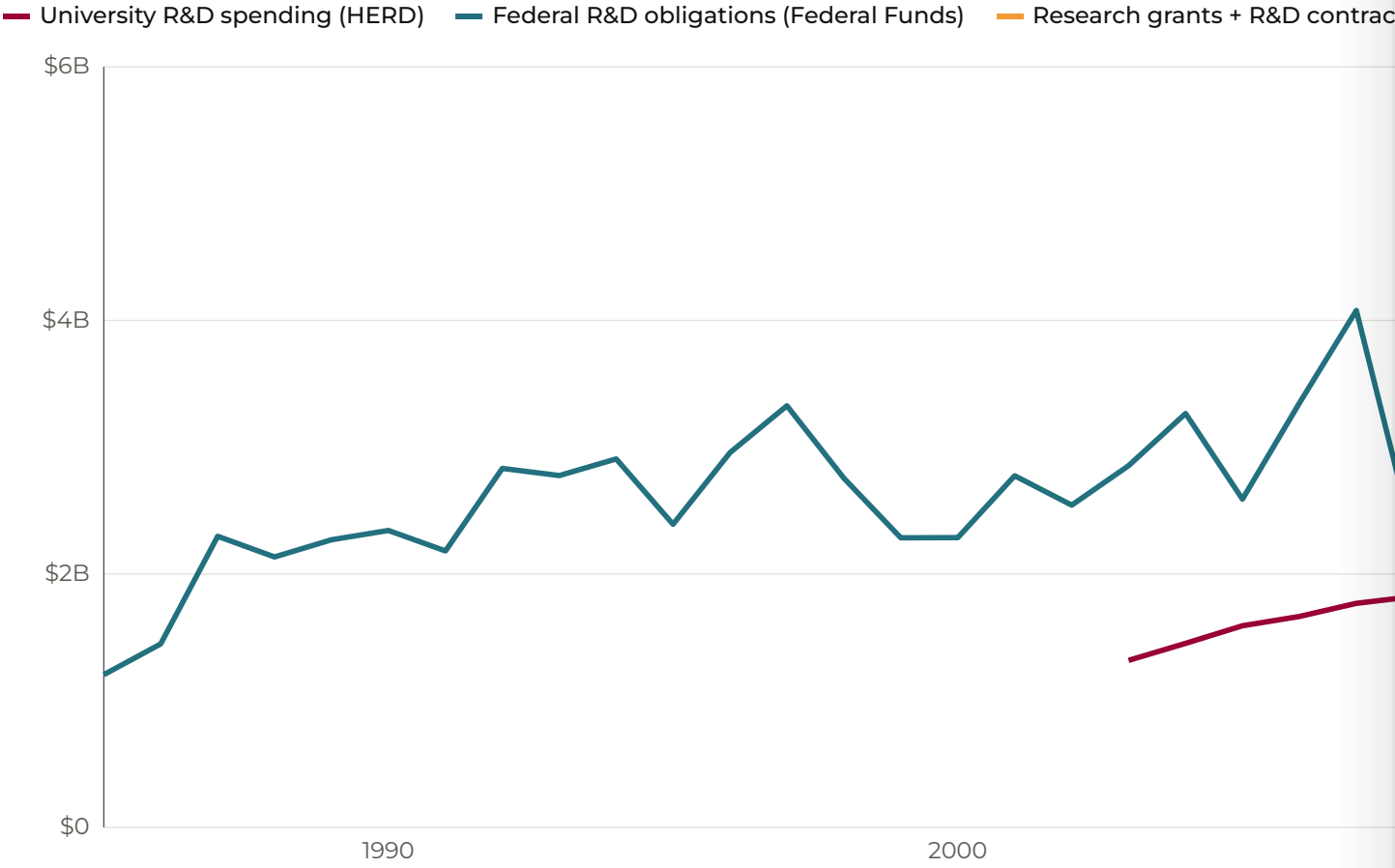
26th of 51 · −11.0 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Florida ranks 10th of 51 on university R&D spending, at $3.79B in 2024 against $118B for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Florida?

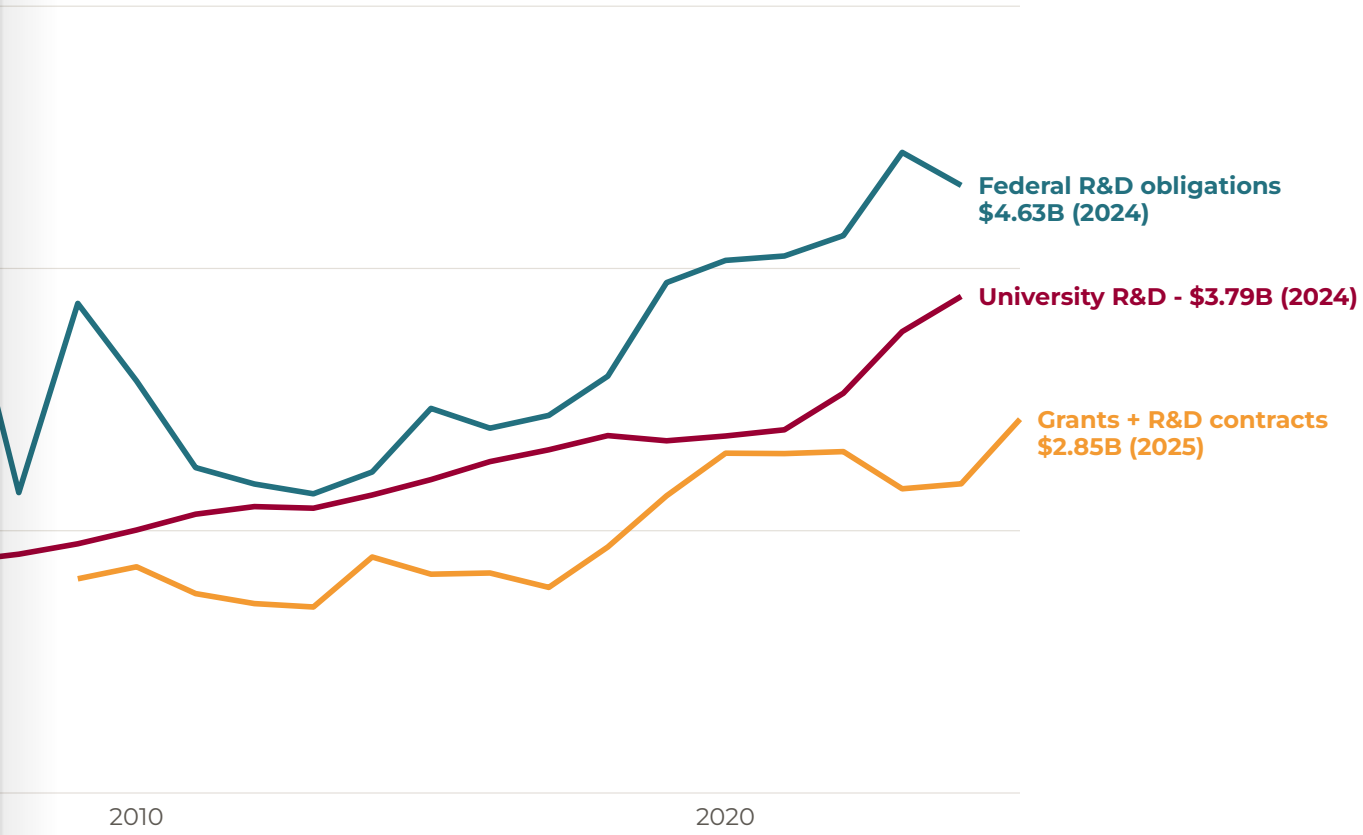


Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. Univers
Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage wide

Florida's universities spent $3.79B on research and development in FY2024, 10th of 51 among the states; 49% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $4.63B for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

ts (USAspending)



sity R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey).
ens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

$3.79B

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **10th** of 51 · +58% since 2015

49%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **34th** of 51 · +2.3 pp since 2015

$4.63B

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

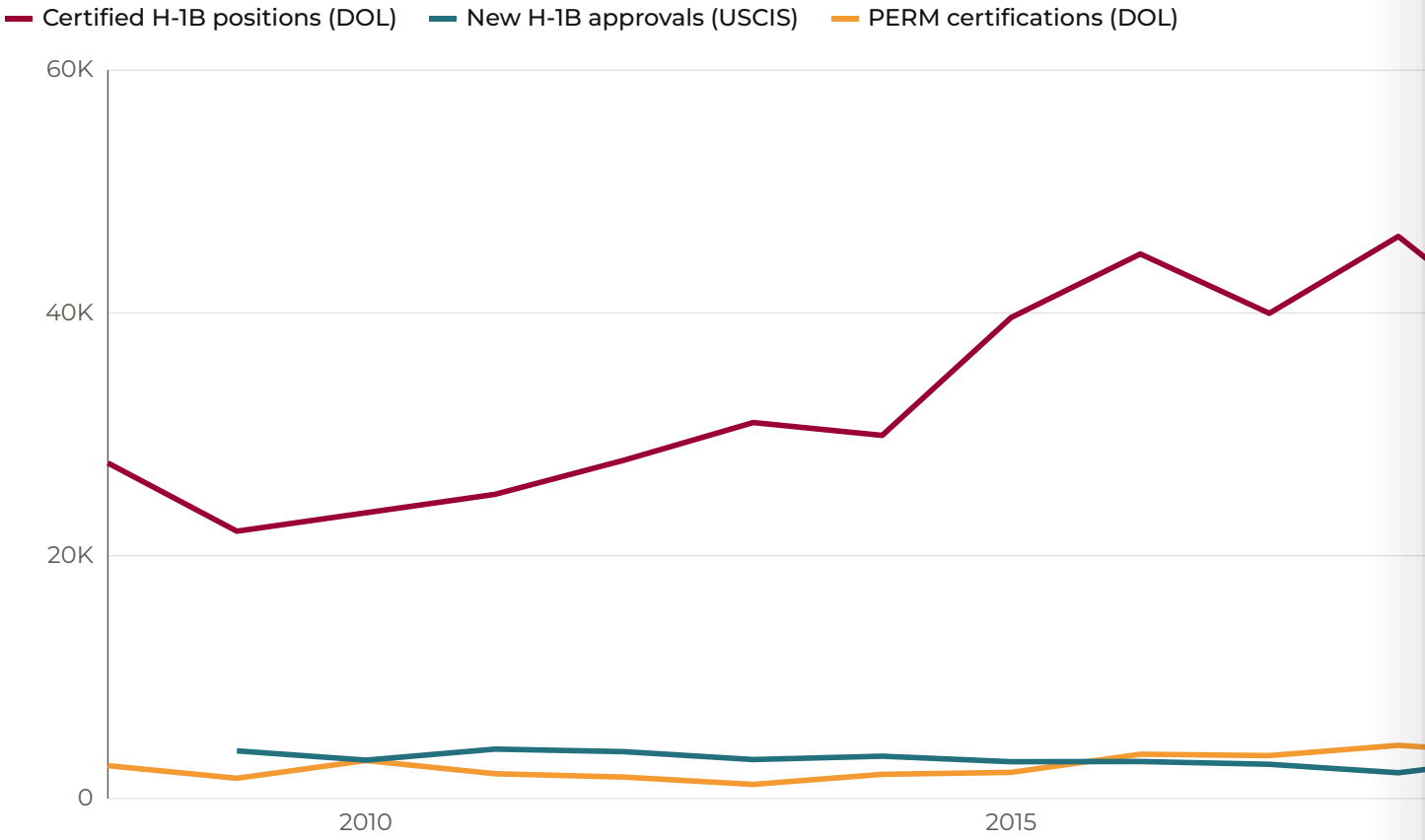
U.S. **$193B** · **13th** of 51 · +58% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Florida ranks 6th of 51 on green-card labor certifications, at 6.37K in 2025 against 138K for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Florida Gene

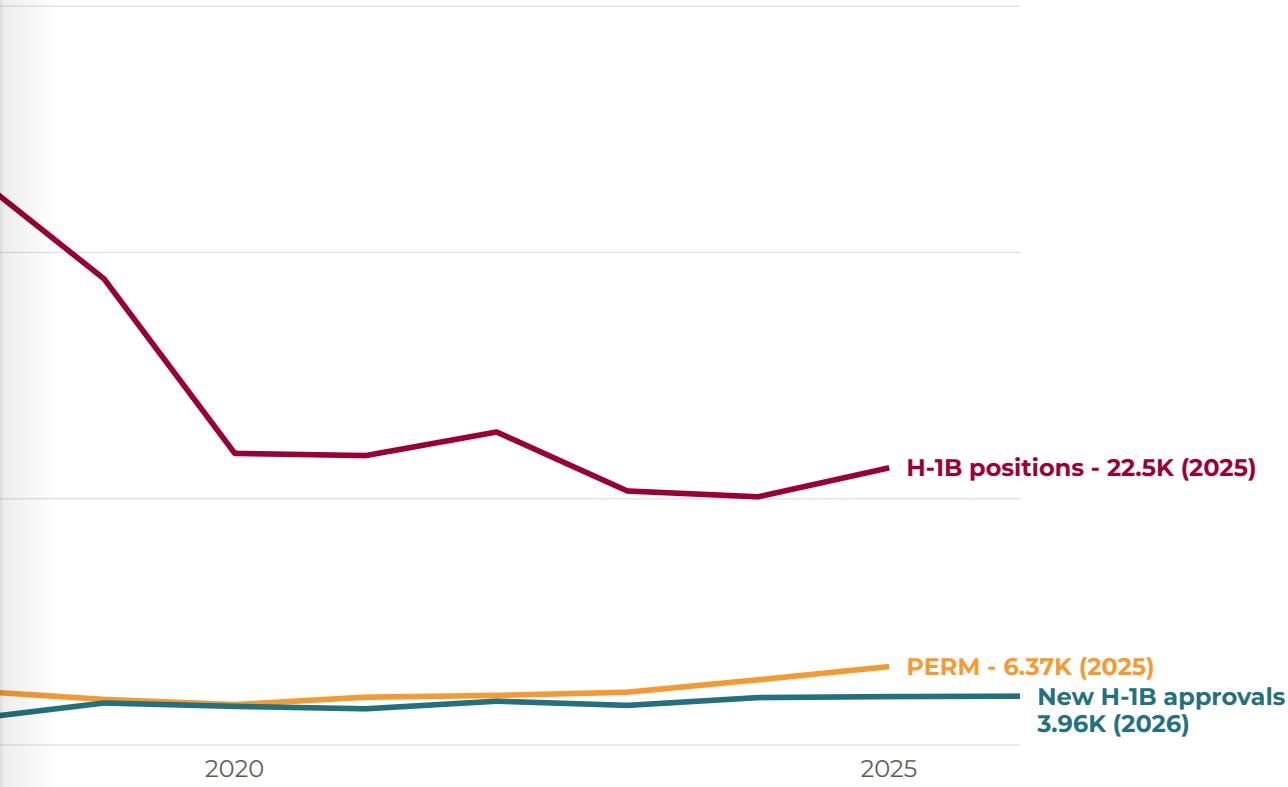


Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal
from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 22.5K H-1B positions at Florida worksites in FY2025, 10th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 3.96K new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 6.62K continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 6.37K PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 14% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

erate?



year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data

22.5K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **10th** of 51 · −43% since 2015

6.37K

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

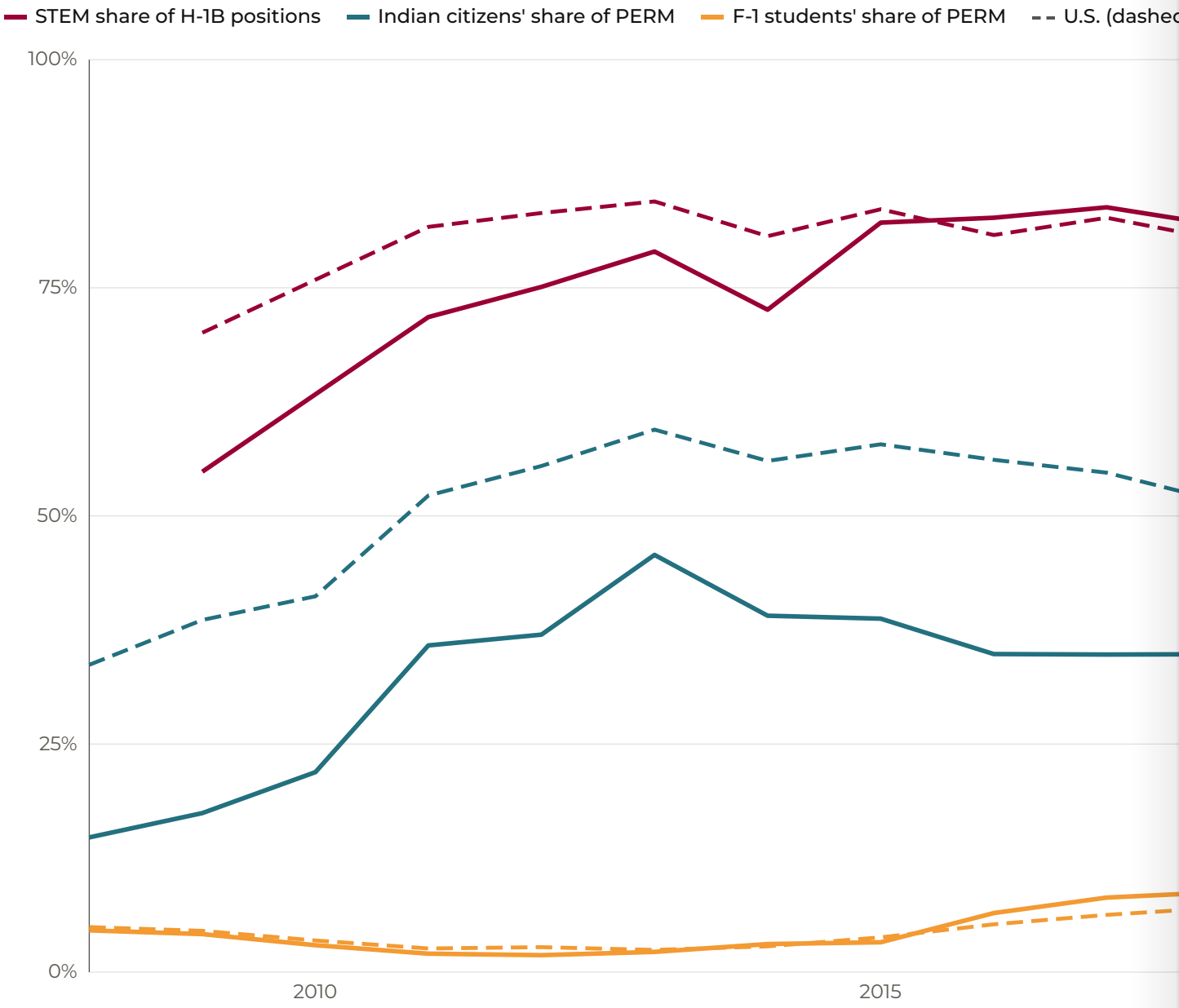
U.S. **138K** · **6th** of 51 · 2.95× since 2015

14%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **9th** of 51 · +11.2 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds Florida's Skilled-Visa Jobs?

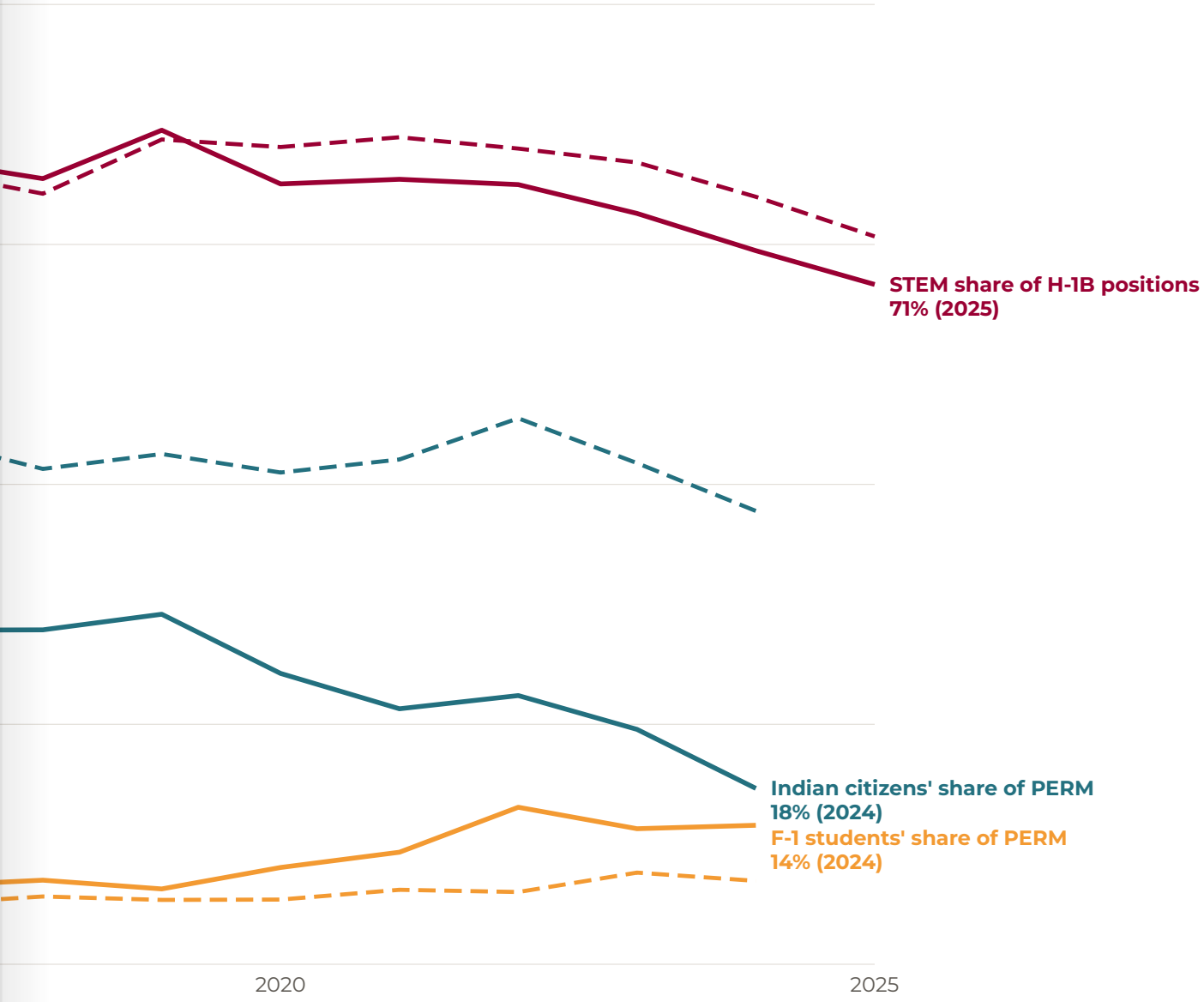


State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from D

71% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 18% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

d)



OL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

71%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **22nd** of 51 · −11.3 pp since 2015

18%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **41st** of 51 · −20.4 pp since 2015

$101K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

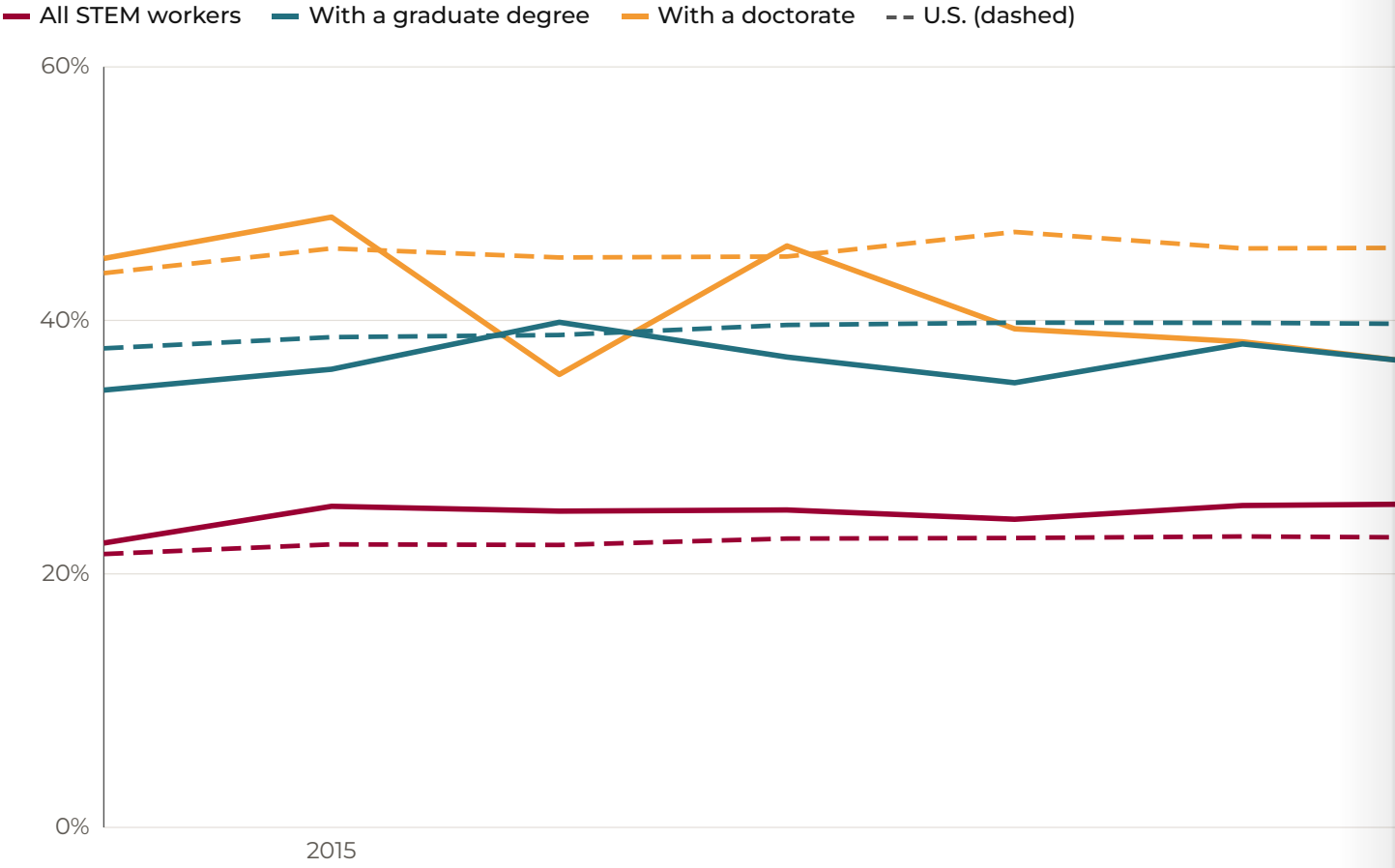
U.S. **$119K** · **28th** of 51 · +53% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Florida ranks 7th of 51 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers, at 27% in 2024 against 24% for the U.S.

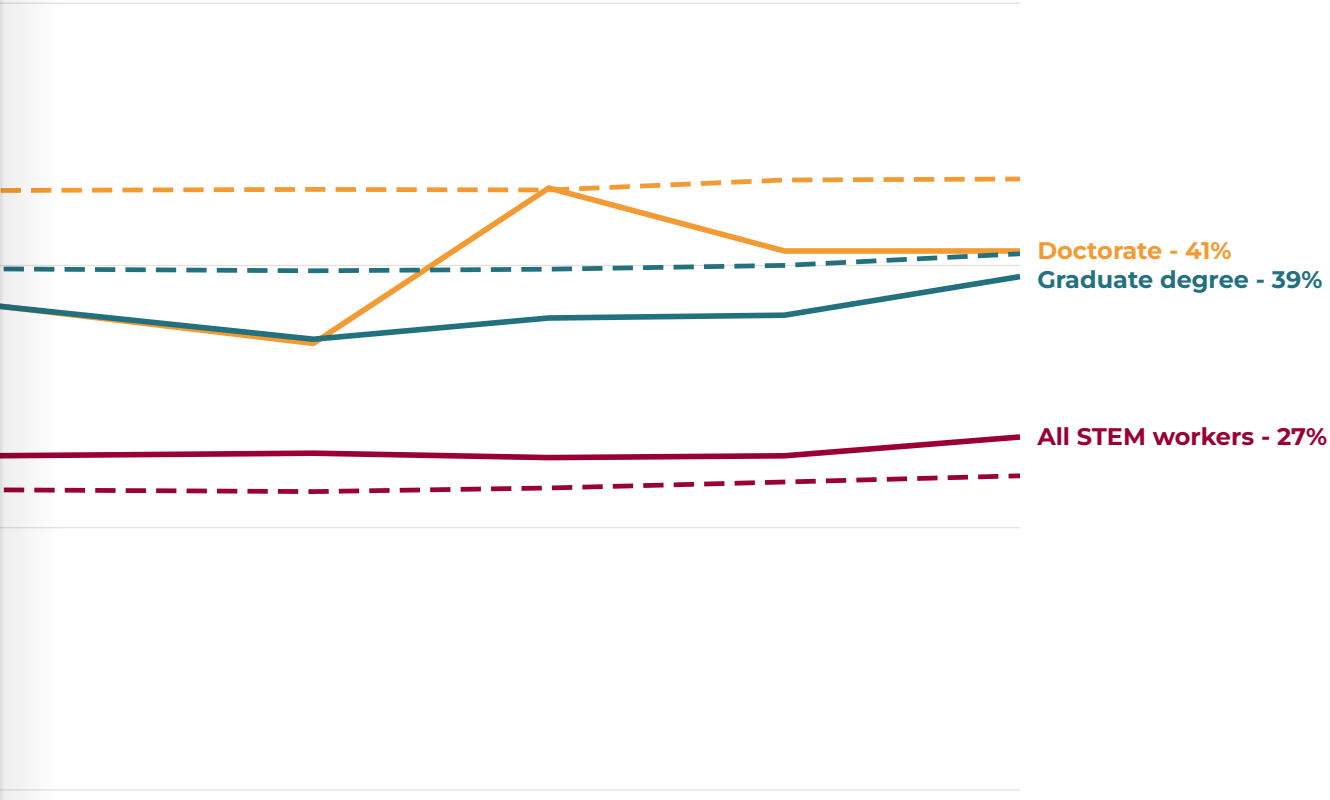
Figure 20 How Much of Florida's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resti
Community Survey.

In 2024, 27% of the people working in STEM occupations in Florida were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 7th of 51).

The share rises with education: 39% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%), and 41% of those with a doctorate (U.S. 47%; 13th of 20). 9.2% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.



ng on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American

27%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **7th** of 51 · +1.6 pp since 2015

39%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **10th** of 44 · +3.0 pp since 2015

9.2%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

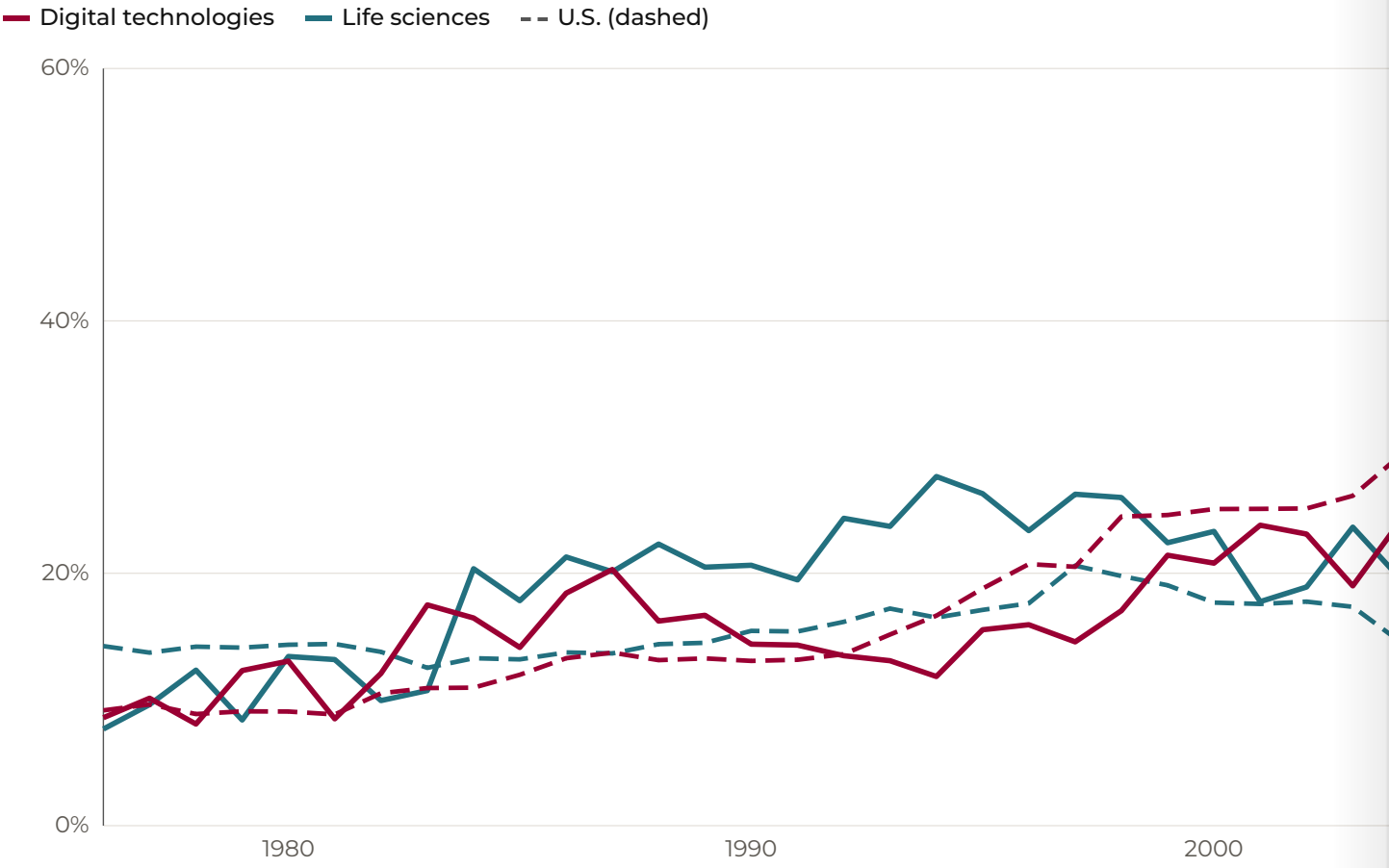
U.S. **11%** · **16th** of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Florida ranks 12th of 51 on the share of the state's patents in life sciences, at 26% in 2025 against 17% for the U.S.

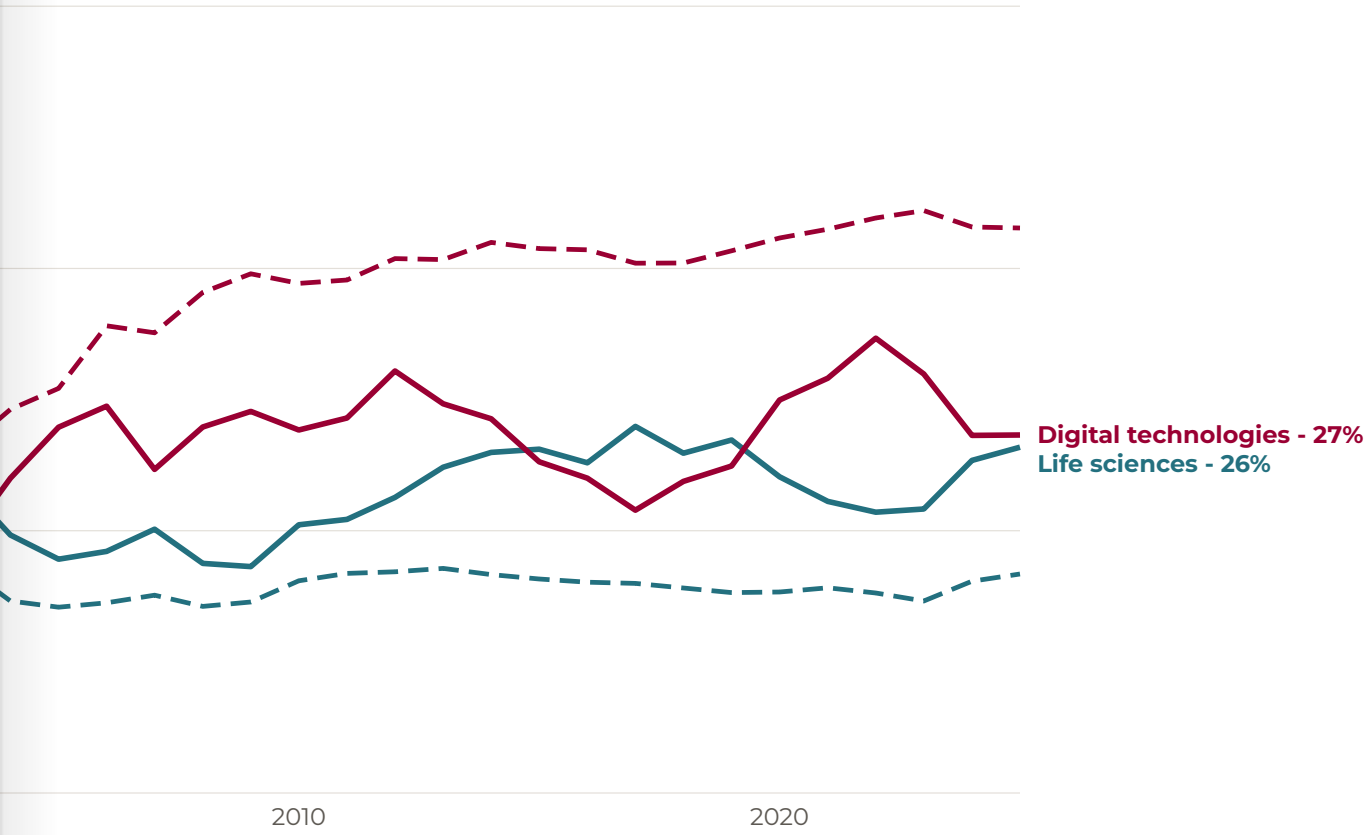
Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Florida Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed

Organizations and people in Florida were granted 3.12K U.S. patents in 2025, 2.3% of all patents with a U.S. owner (13th of 51).

27% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 26% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).



d. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

3.12K

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **13th** of 51 · +33% since 2015

27%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **19th** of 51 · +2.0 pp since 2015

26%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

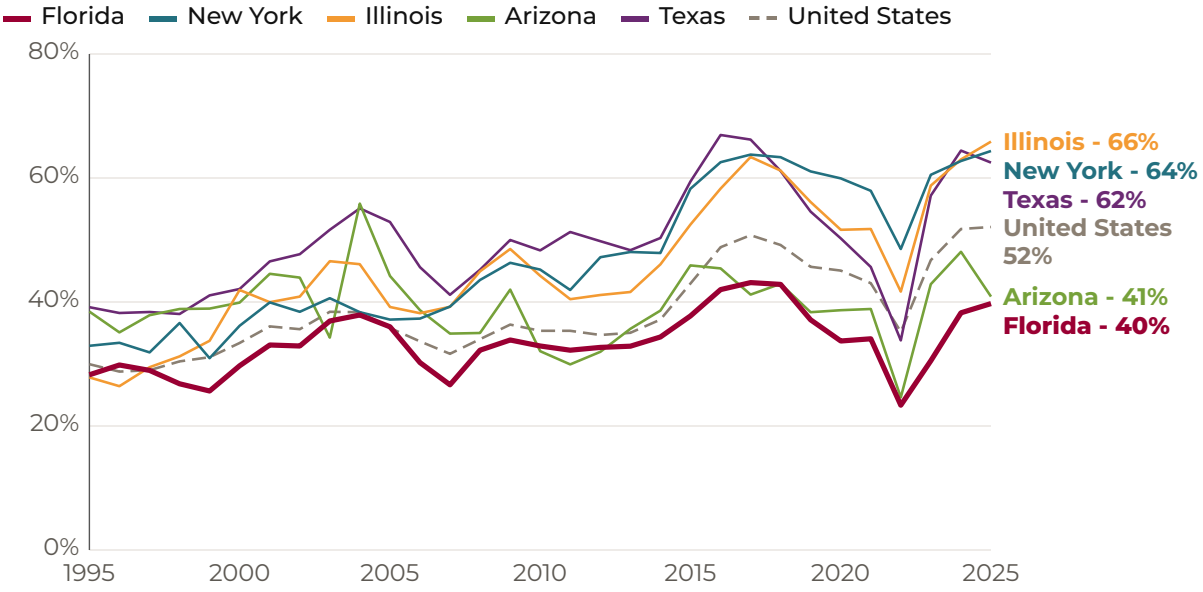
U.S. **17%** · **12th** of 51 · +0.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

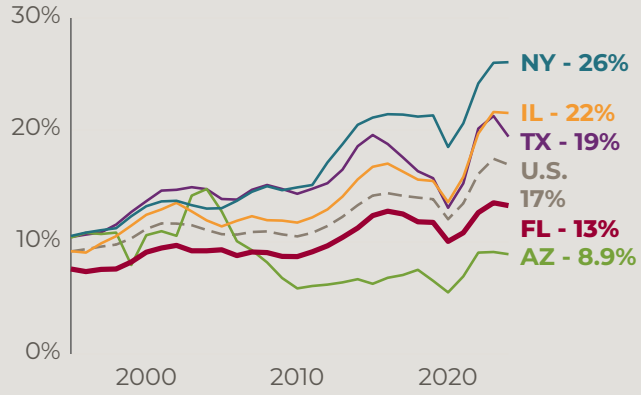
The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are New York, Illinois, Arizona, and Texas. Florida ranks 5th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Illinois is the most dependent at 66%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Florida and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



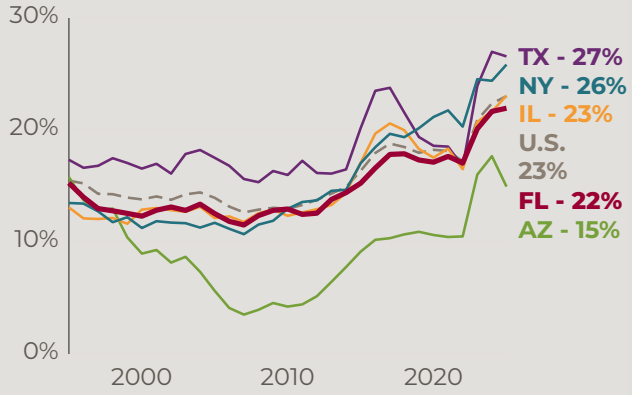
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



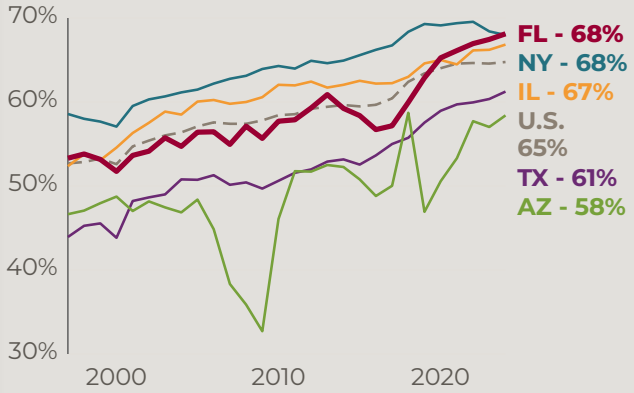
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Table 4 How Does Florida Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	FL	NY	IL	AZ	TX	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**1.05M**	1.15M	723K	684K	1.67M	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**13%**	22%	22%	18%	13%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**22%**	24%	23%	17%	24%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**22%**	26%	23%	15%	27%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**3.53K**	13.7K	7.39K	2.58K	10.5K	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**3.0%**	12%	6.3%	2.2%	9.0%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**40%**	64%	66%	41%	62%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**47%**	46%	54%	42%	50%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**13%**	26%	22%	8.9%	19%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**4.4%**	5.6%	3.8%	1.8%	2.5%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**68%**	68%	67%	58%	61%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$4.39K**	$8.67K	$15K	$10K	$8.52K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$12K**	$15.9K	$10.3K	$9.12K	$11.8K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$97.4K**	$117K	$112K	$102K	$96.8K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**81%**	73%	80%	61%	92%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**+1**	−4	−19	+37	−10	–

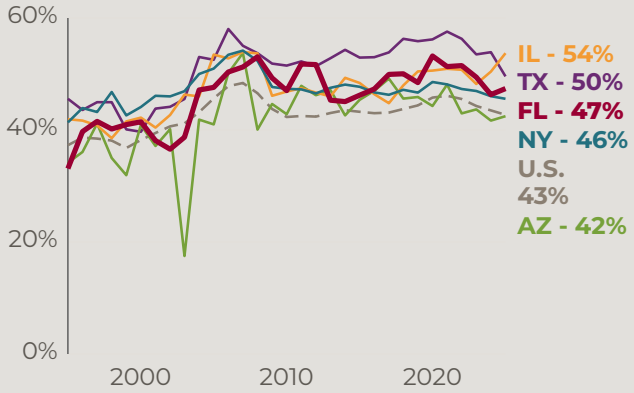
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM doctorates

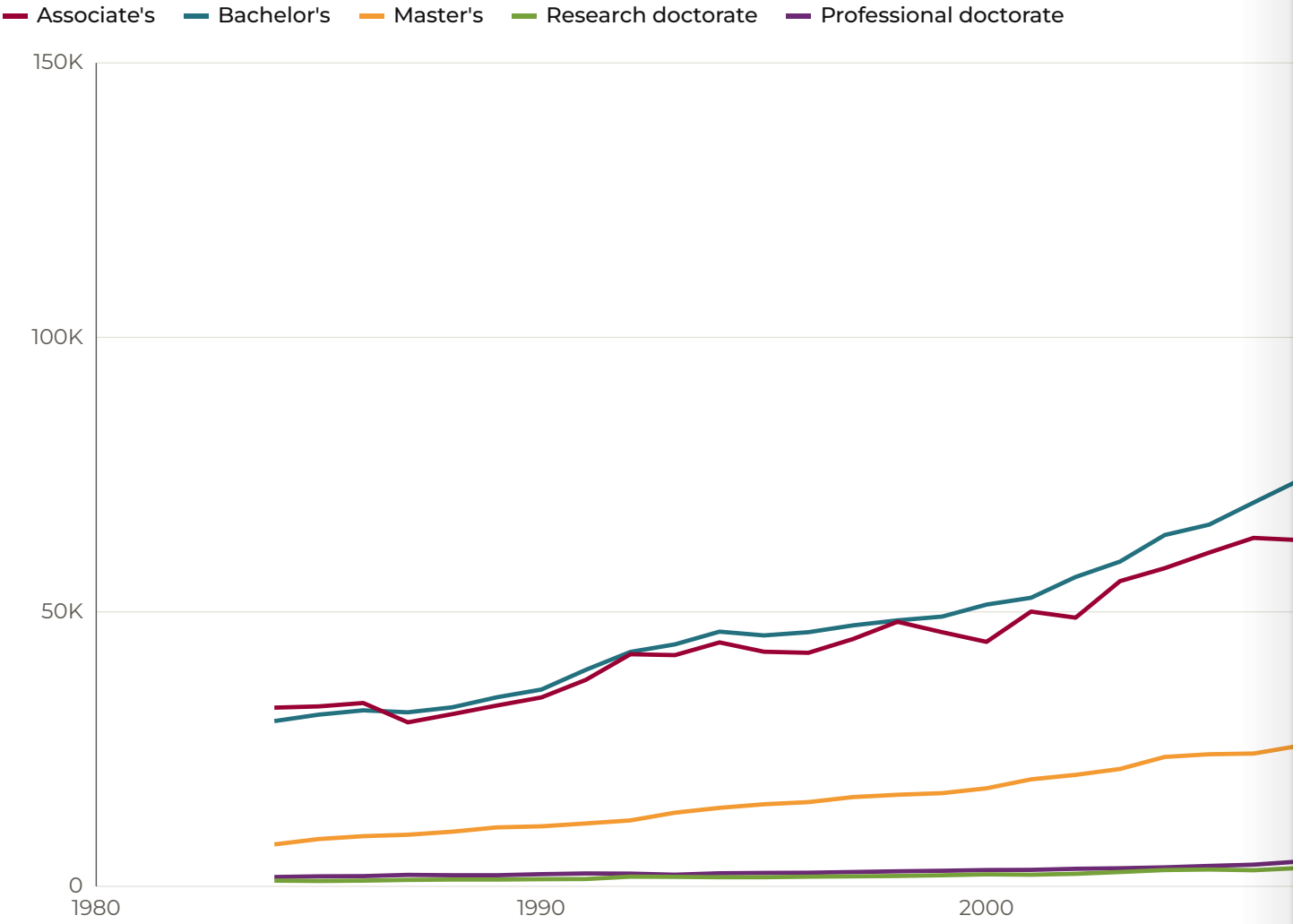


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

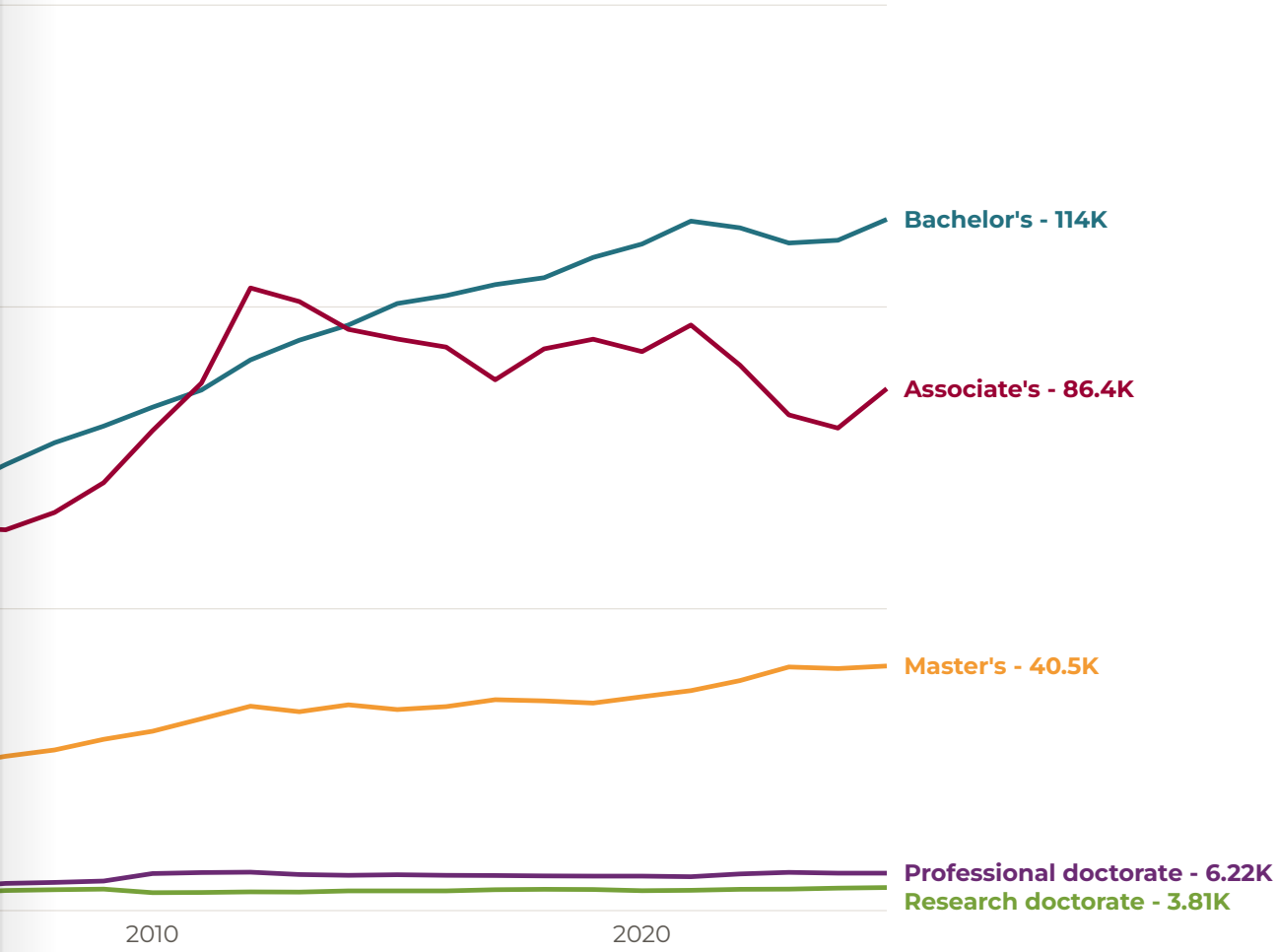
Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Florida Award?



Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Florida's institutions awarded 86.4K associate's degrees, 114K bachelor's degrees, 40.5K master's degrees, 3.81K research doctorate degrees, 6.22K professional doctorate degrees.



Since 2015: associate's down 9%; bachelor's up 14%; master's up 22%; research doctorate up 17%; professional doctorate up 5%. The state awards 12.6 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

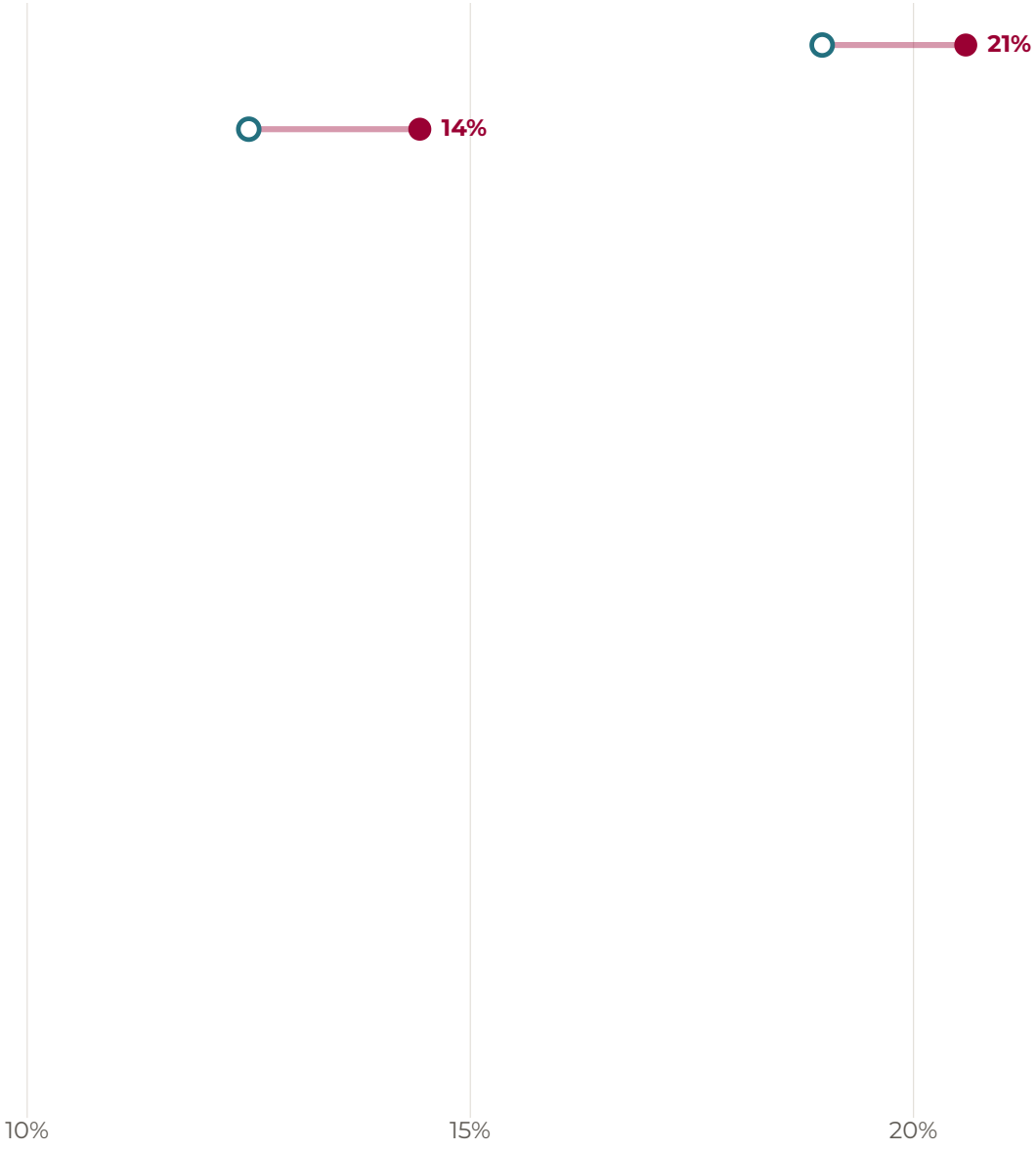
Figure 28 What Do Florida's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Florida's largest bachelor's fields are business (21%; U.S. 19%), health professions (14%; U.S. 13%), psychology (7.8%; U.S. 6.9%).

Relative to the nation, Florida's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in mechanic & repair (10.08× the U.S. share), transportation (4.61× the U.S. share), communications tech (3.06× the U.S. share).



6.2%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **22nd** of 51 · +3.0 pp since 2015

5.9%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

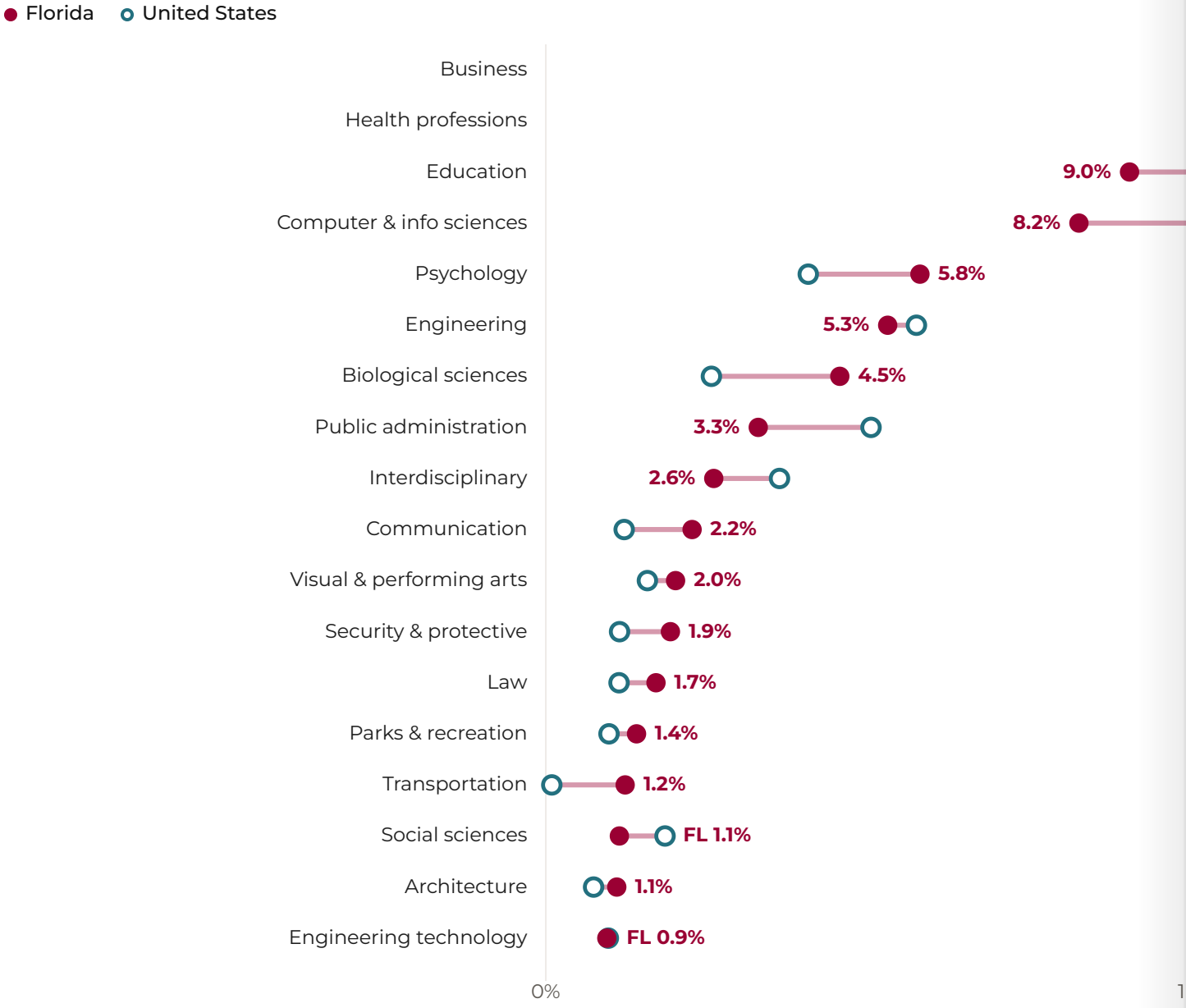
U.S. **6.8%** · **32nd** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

21%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **17th** of 51 · –1.6 pp since 2015

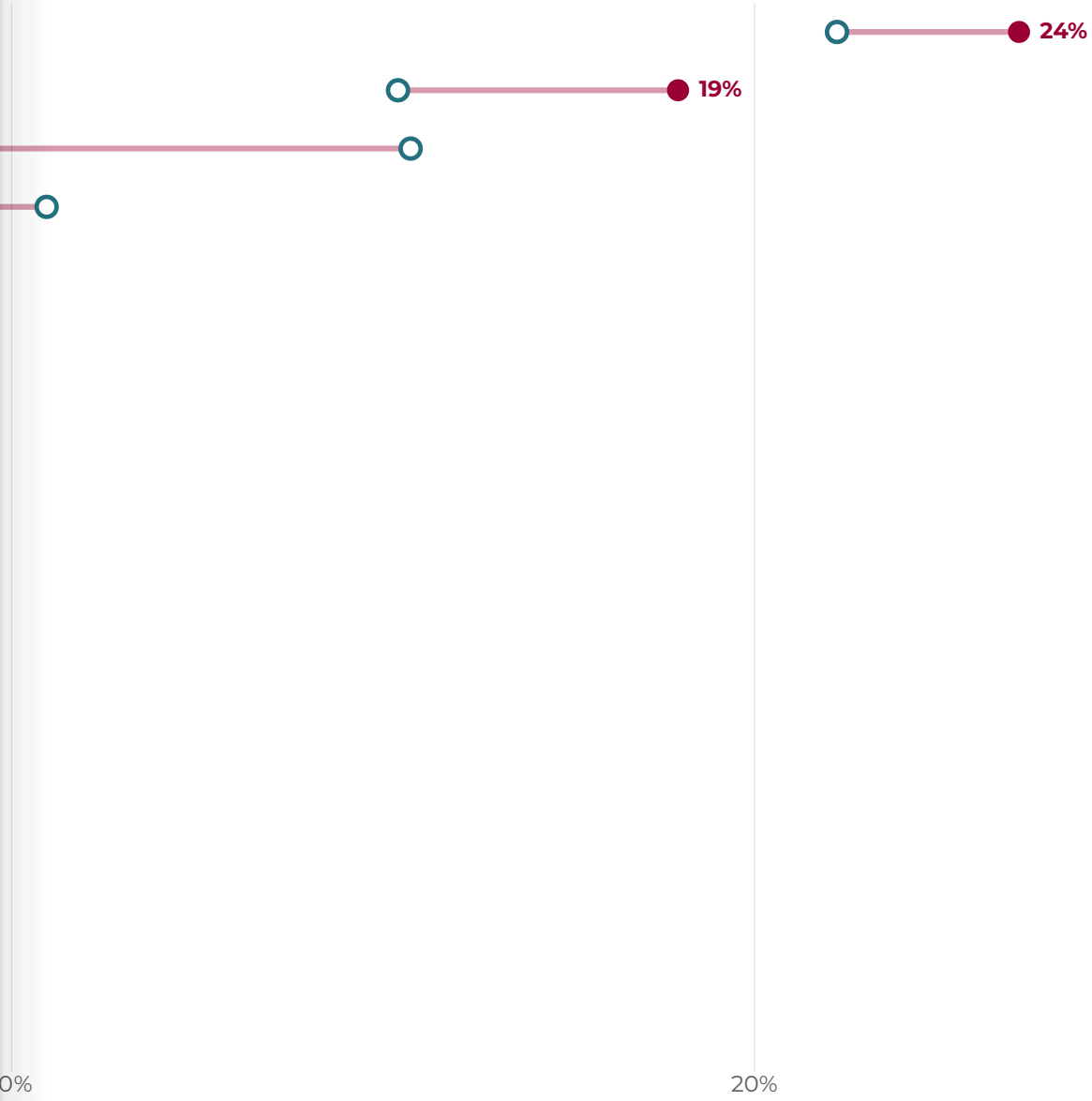
Figure 29 What Do Florida's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Florida's largest master's fields are business (24%; U.S. 21%), health professions (19%; U.S. 15%), education (9.0%; U.S. 15%).

International students earn 15% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 22% of them.



22%

STEM share of master's, 2025

U.S. **23%** · **22nd** of 51 · +6.7 pp since 2015

15%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

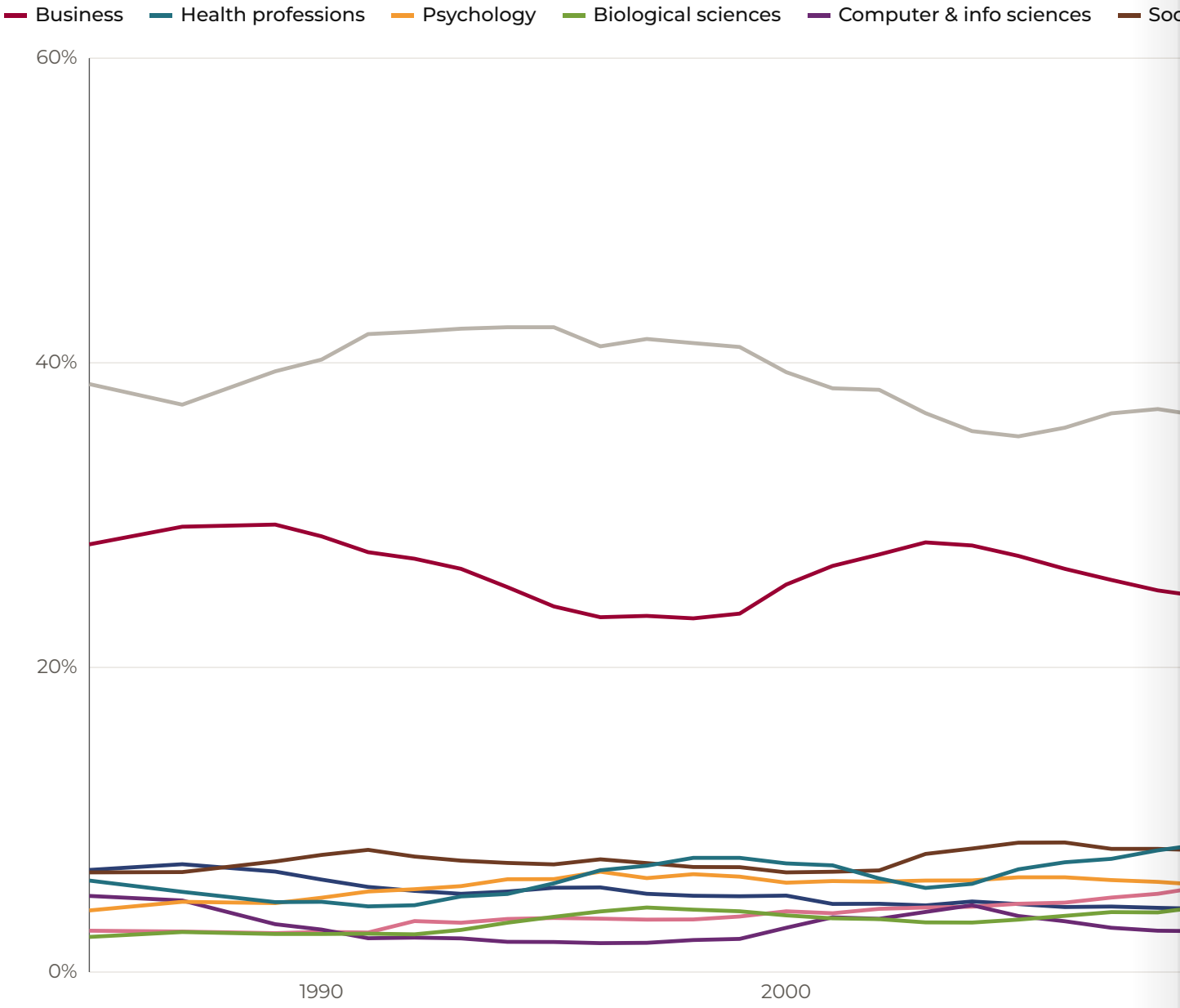
U.S. **22%** · **26th** of 51 · +3.2 pp since 2015

66%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

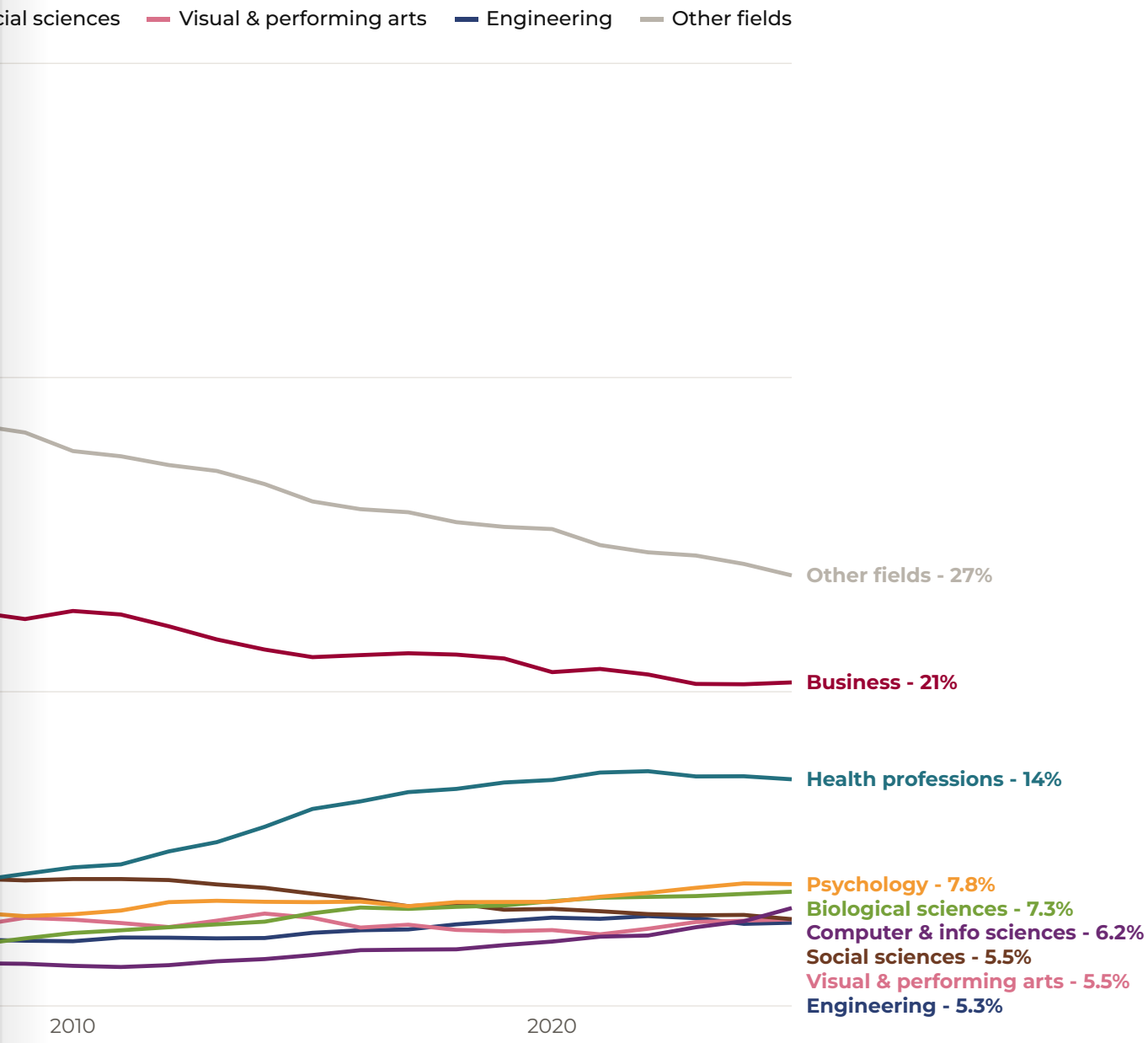
U.S. **65%** · **22nd** of 47 · +14.3 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has Florida's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, computer & info sciences has gained the most ground, 3.0 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while social sciences lost the most (1.6 points).



The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is Florida Specialized, and What Do Its Doctoral Graduates Study?

The location quotient divides a field's share of Florida's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Mechanic & repair (10.08, with 0.1% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.0% for the U.S.), transportation (4.61, with 1.7% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.4% for the U.S.), and communications tech (3.06, with 0.8% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.3% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is Florida Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Mechanic & repair	**10.08**	0.1%	0.0%	132
Transportation	**4.61**	1.7%	0.4%	1.92K
Communications tech	**3.06**	0.8%	0.3%	932
Law	**1.81**	0.4%	0.2%	485
Theology	**1.27**	0.4%	0.3%	415
Security & protective	**1.22**	3.1%	2.6%	3.56K
Visual & performing arts	**1.21**	5.5%	4.6%	6.31K
Health professions	**1.15**	14%	13%	16.5K
Interdisciplinary	**1.15**	3.3%	2.9%	3.77K
Communication	**1.13**	4.3%	3.9%	4.98K

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

22%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **29th** of 51

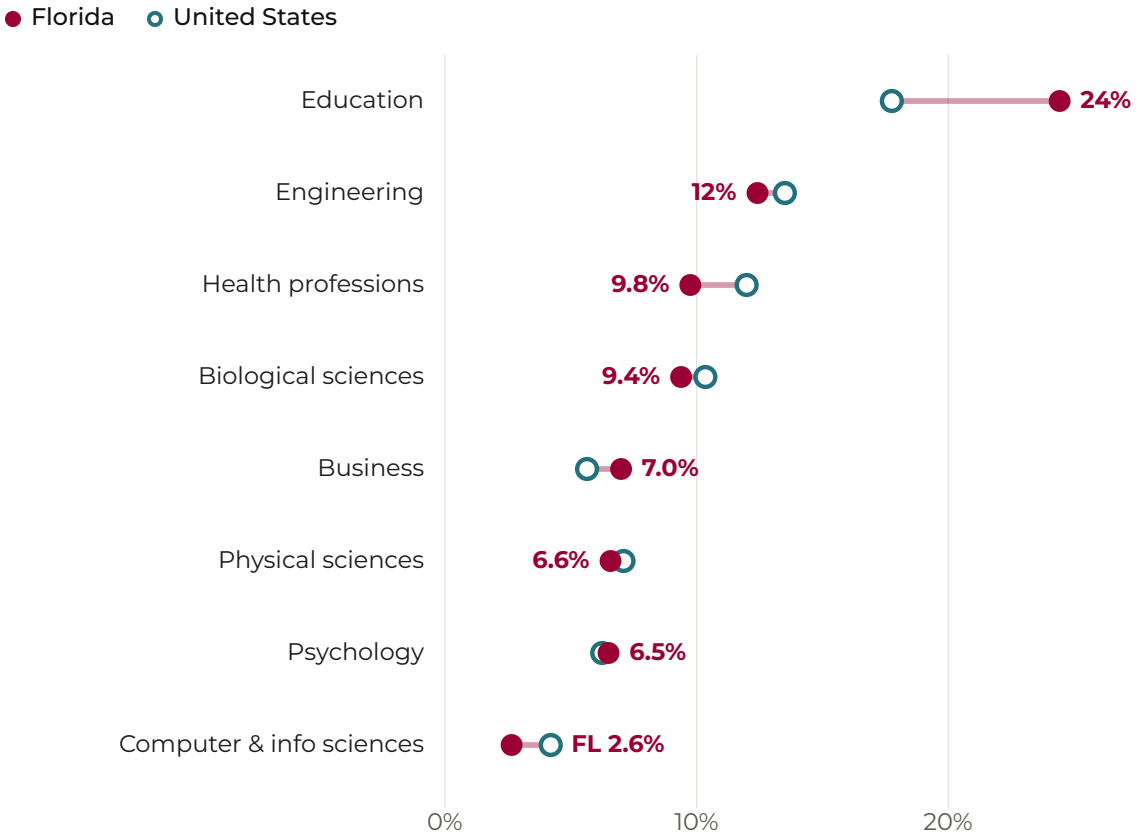
6.2%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **22nd** of 51

5.9%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **32nd** of 51

Each row is a field's share of the research doctorates awarded in Florida in 2025 (filled dot), against its share nationally (open dot), for the ten largest fields with at least 20 doctorates. Research doctorates exclude professional doctorates such as the M.D. and J.D.

Largest doctoral fields. The state's largest doctoral fields were education (24% of research doctorates, against 18% for the U.S.), engineering (12% of research doctorates, against 14% for the U.S.), and health professions (9.8% of research doctorates, against 12% for the U.S.).

Figure 31 What Do Florida's Doctoral Graduates Study?



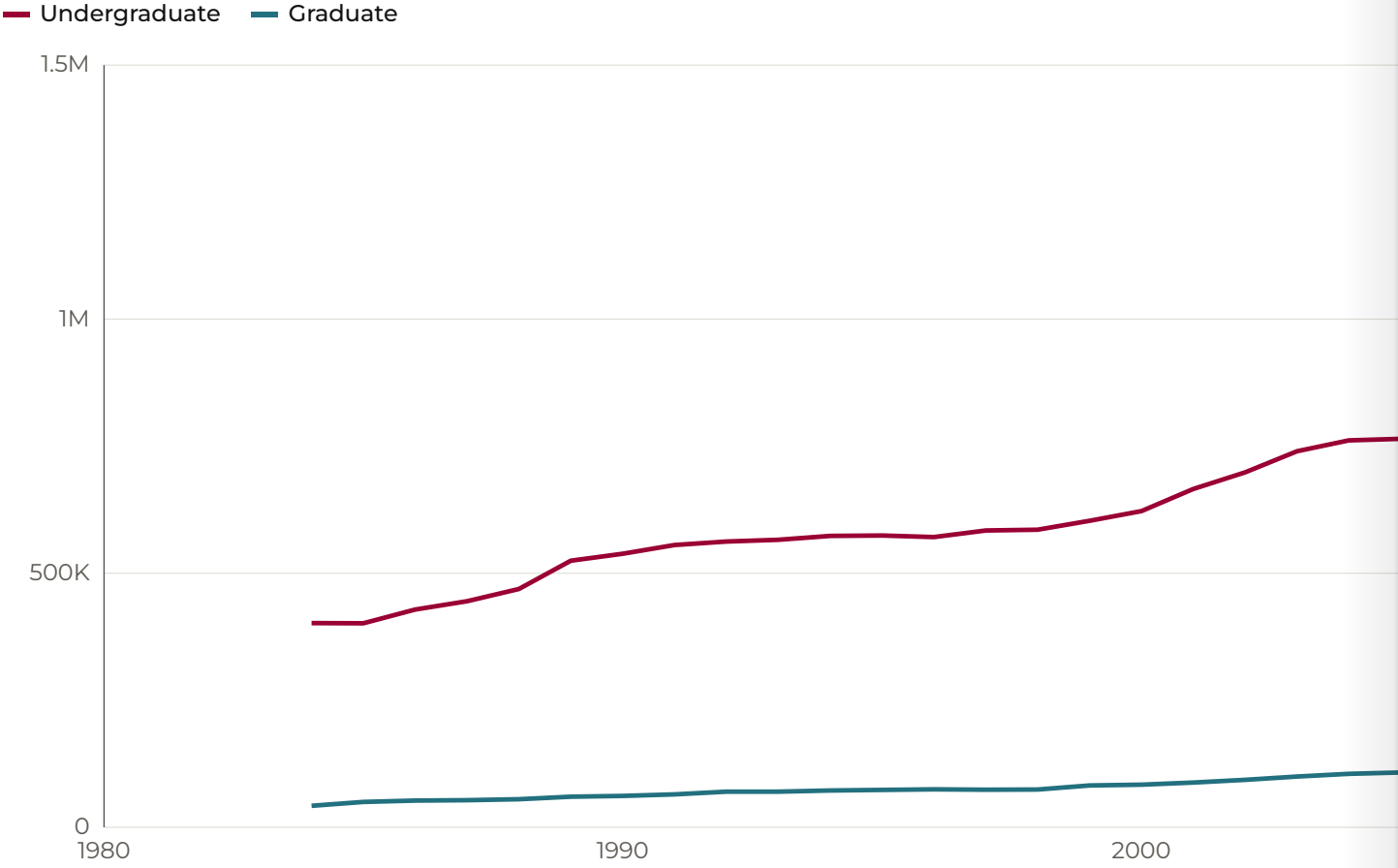
Share of research doctorates by field, 2025; fields with 20+ doctorates. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Florida ranks 4th of 51 on fall enrollment, at 1.05M in 2024 against 19.7M for the U.S.

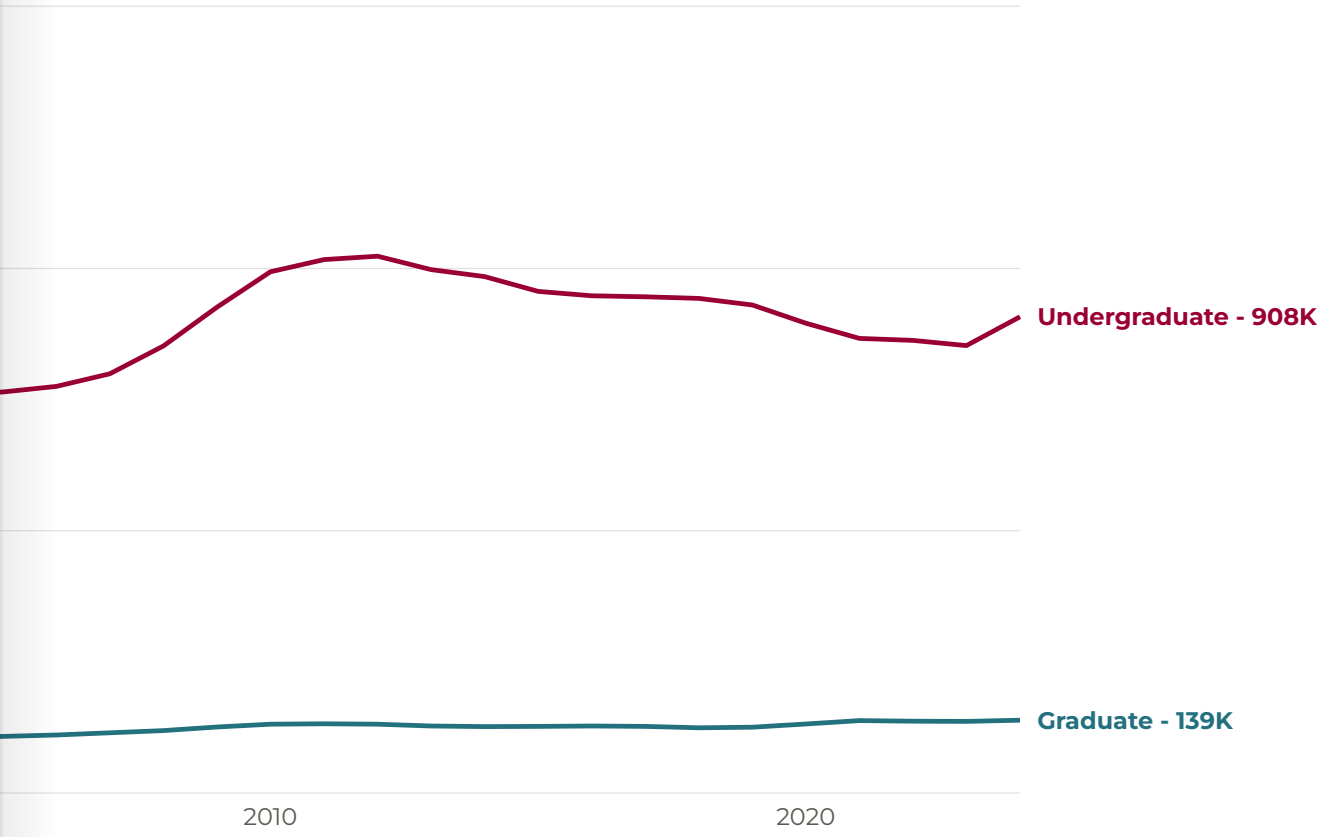
Figure 32 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Florida enrolled 908K undergraduates and 139K graduate students, 1.05M in all (4th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 5% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 9% since 2015. Graduate students are 13% of all students (U.S. 17%).



1.05M

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **4th** of 51 · −3.4% since 2015

13%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **38th** of 51 · +1.5 pp since 2015

40%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **24th** of 51 · −3.3 pp since 2015

SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

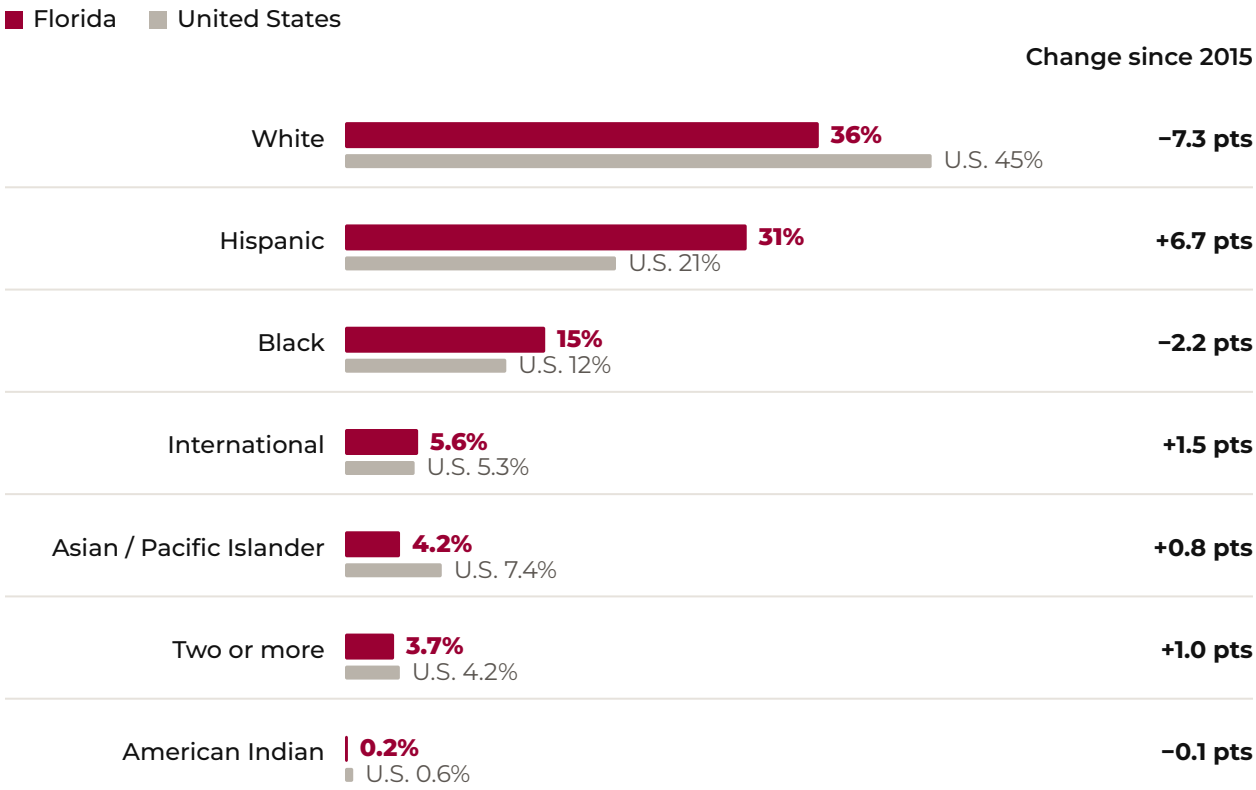
Who Enrolls in Florida, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at Florida's degree-granting institutions, **36%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 7.3 points since 2015.

Hispanic students were **31%** (U.S. 21%), up 6.7 points since 2015, and Black students were **15%** (U.S. 12%), down 2.2 points since 2015.

International students were **5.6%** (U.S. 5.3%), up 1.5 points since 2015, and Asian and Pacific Islander students were **4.2%** (U.S. 7.4%), up 0.8 points since 2015. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race.

Figure 33 Who Enrolls in Florida?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

36%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −7.3 pp since 2015

31%
Hispanic students
U.S. **21%** · +6.7 pp since 2015

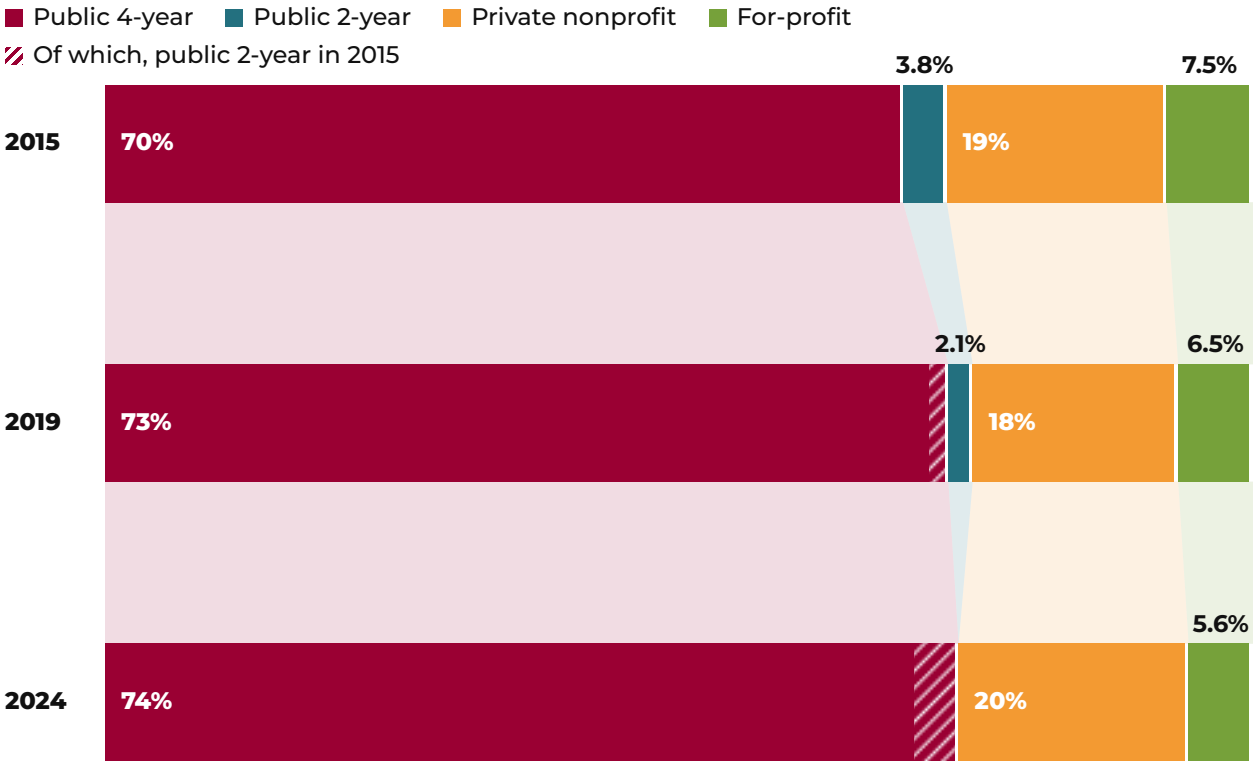
74%
At public 4-year institutions
+4.8 pp since 2015

20%
At private nonprofit institutions
+0.9 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **74%** of students, up 4.8 points from 70% in 2015. Private nonprofit institutions enrolled **20%** of students, up 0.9 points from 19% in 2015.

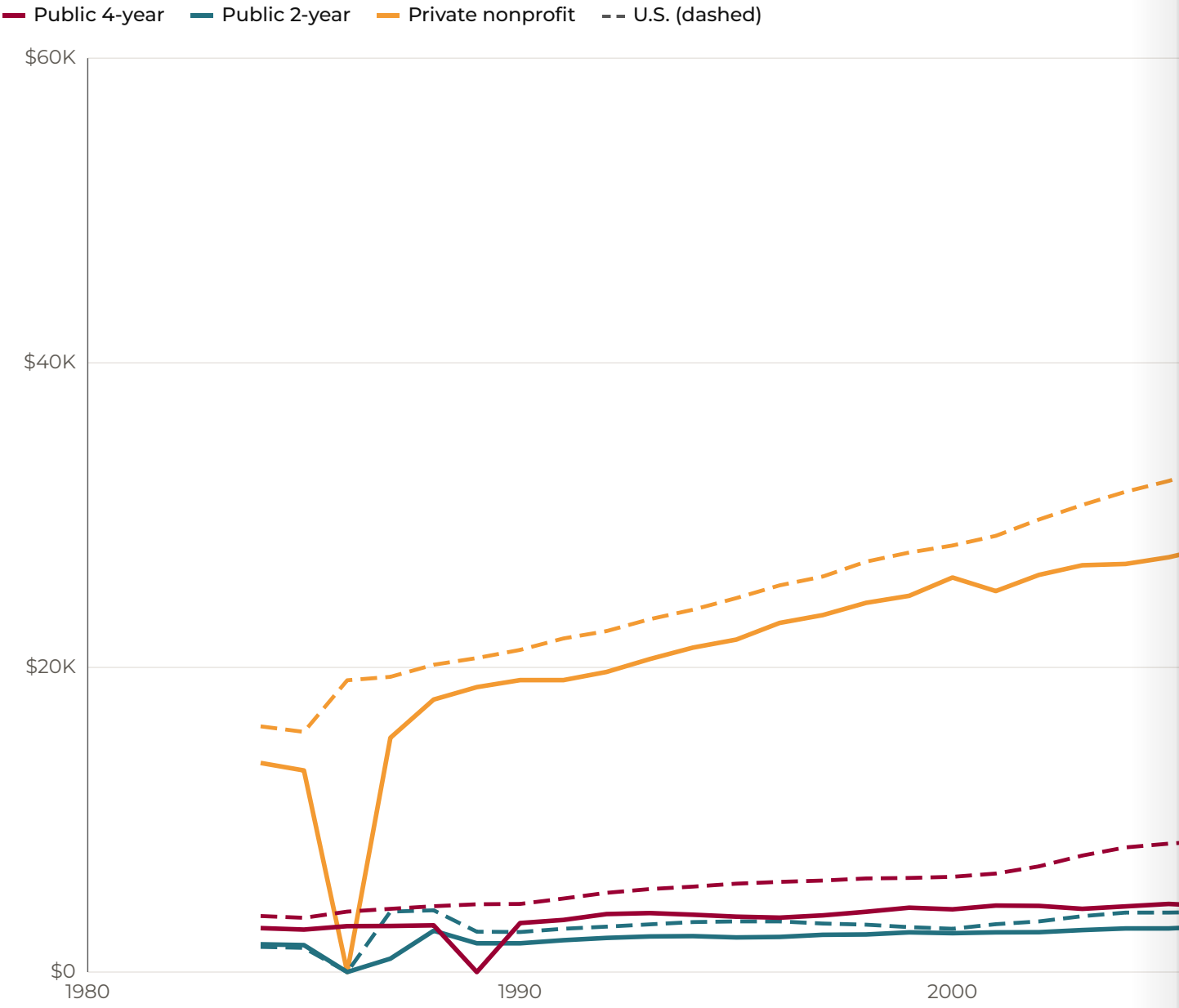
Part of the shift between public sectors is a change of label: 4 community colleges that IPEDS counted as public 2-year in 2015 are counted as public 4-year in 2024 because they began awarding bachelor's degrees. They enrolled **36.2K** students, 3.5% of the state's total, the largest being Hillsborough Community College, Tallahassee State College, and North Florida College.

Figure 34 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year; 4 colleges that were public 2-year in 2015 (hatched; 3.5% of 2024 enrollment) count as public 4-year after they began awarding bachelor's degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

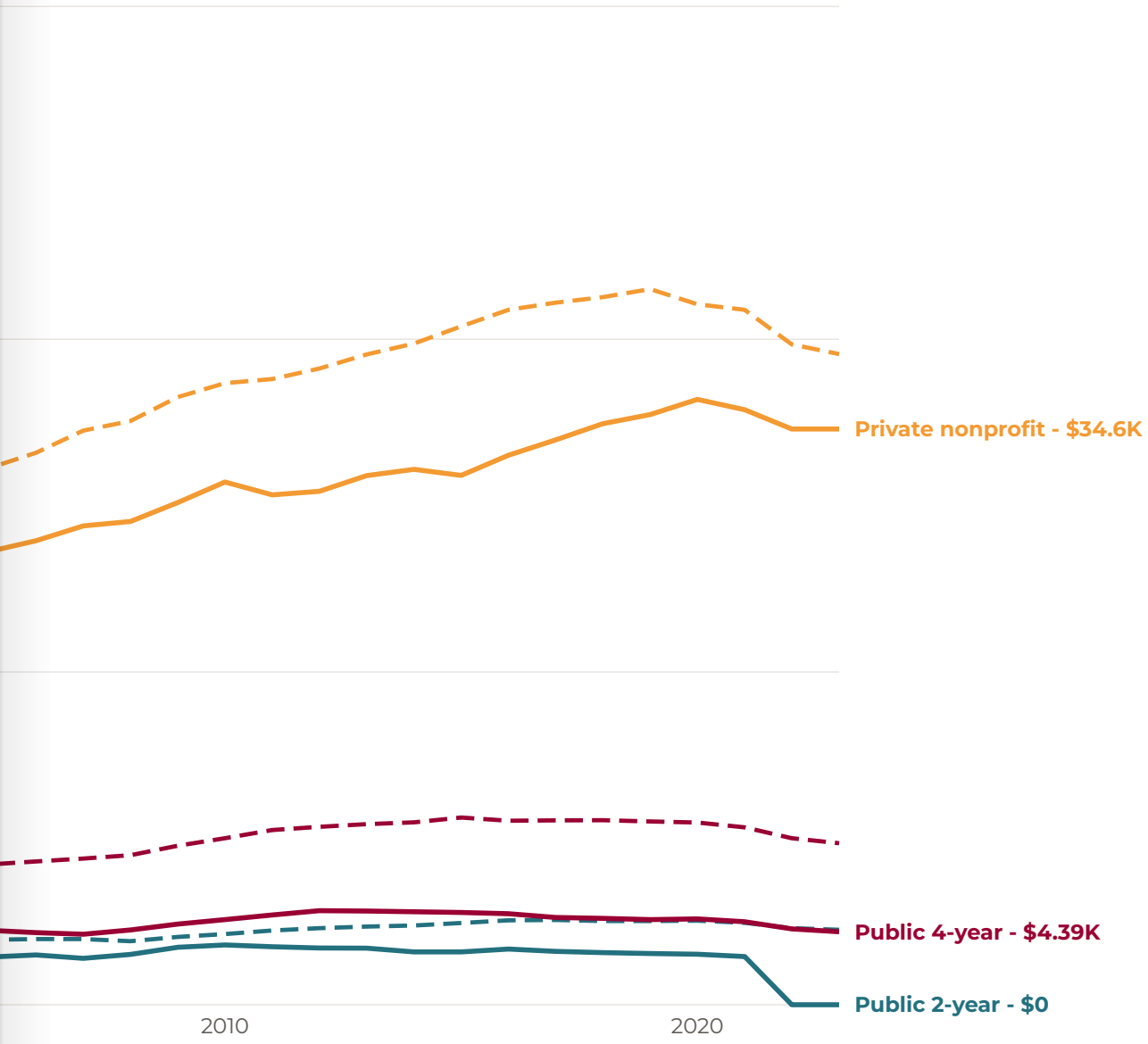
Figure 35 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Florida's public four-year institutions are $4.39K (2023, 2024 dollars), 55% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 51st of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $12K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (15th of 51), and net tuition makes up 30% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).



$4.39K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **51st** of 51 · −21% since 2015

$12K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **15th** of 51 · +34% since 2015

30%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **45th** of 51 · −10.3 pp since 2015

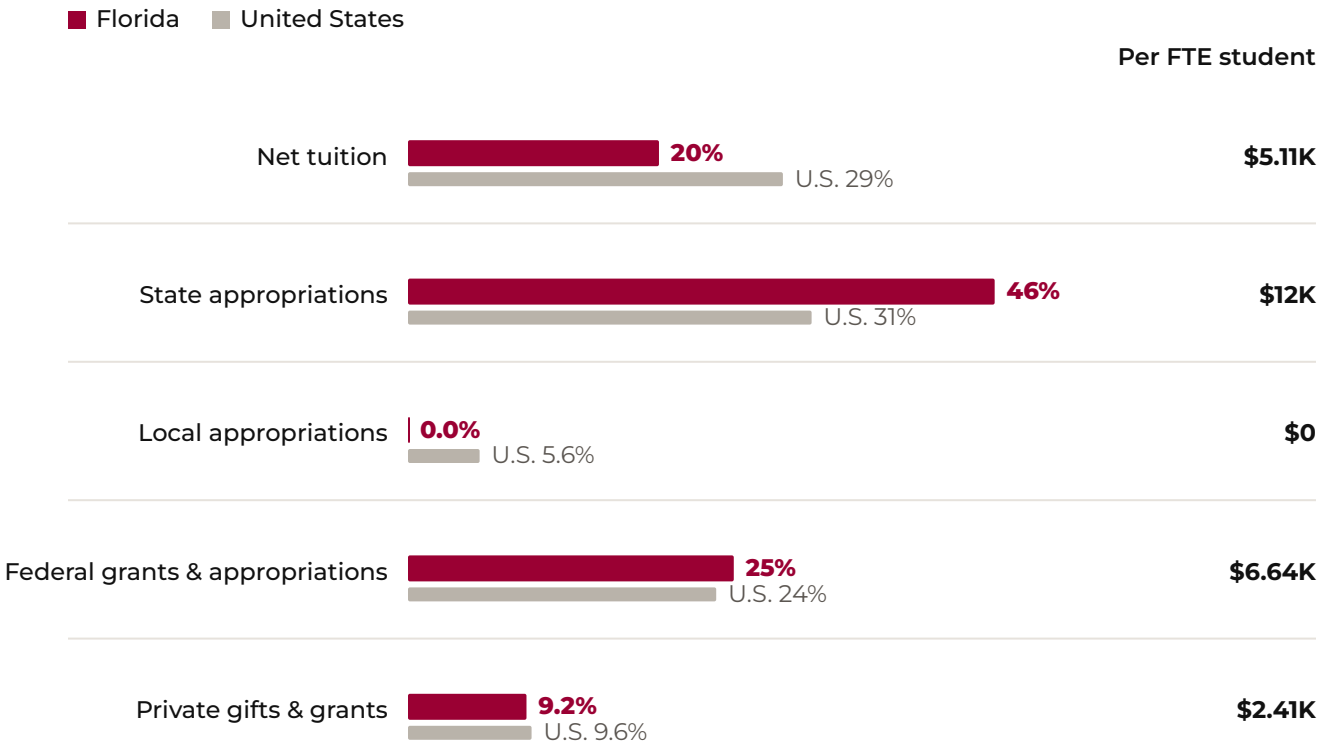
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are Florida's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of Florida's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $5.11K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 1.4% from $5.19K in FY2023 and down 15% since FY2015, when it was $6.04K.

Figure 36 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$4.39K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **51st** of 51

$12K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **15th** of 51

30%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **45th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Florida: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $4.39K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 51st among the states, down 3.7% from $4.56K in 2022 and down 21% since 2015, when it was $5.55K.

Table 6 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Florida	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$4.39K**	$9.71K	51st of 51	−21%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$12K**	$11.4K	15th of 51	+34%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**30%**	43%	45th of 51	−10.3 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**68%**	65%	12th of 51	+9.7 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$97.4K**	$106K	22nd of 51	−5.8%

Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Florida ranks 7th of 50 on the share of completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions, at 60% in 2024 against 41% for the U.S.

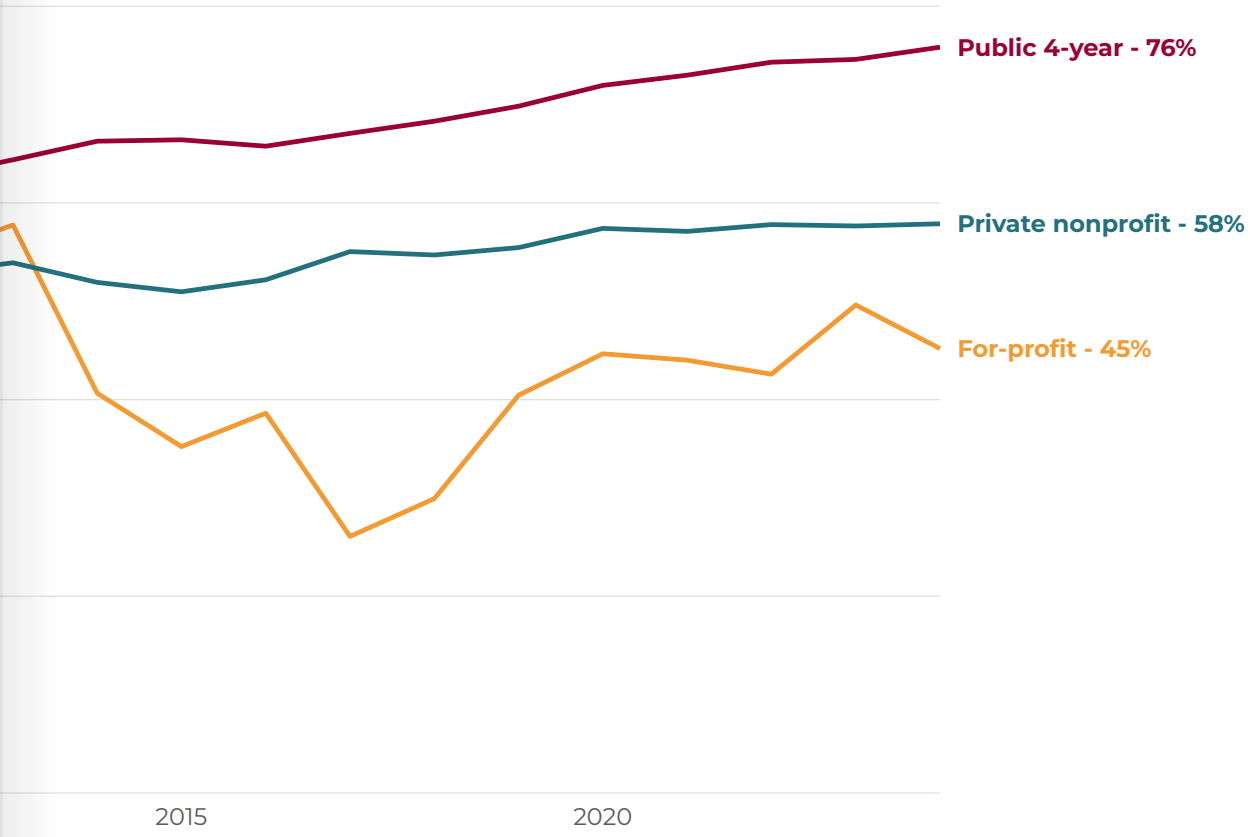
Figure 37 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

68% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Florida graduated within six years (2024), 3.4 points above the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 12th of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 76%, private nonprofit 58%, for-profit 45%. At two-year institutions, 60% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).



68%

Six-year graduation rate, 2024

U.S. **65%** · **12th** of 51 · +9.7 pp since 2015

60%

Two-year completion rate, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **7th** of 50 · +6.3 pp since 2015

12.6

Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025

U.S. **12.3** · **25th** of 51 · +2.4 since 2015

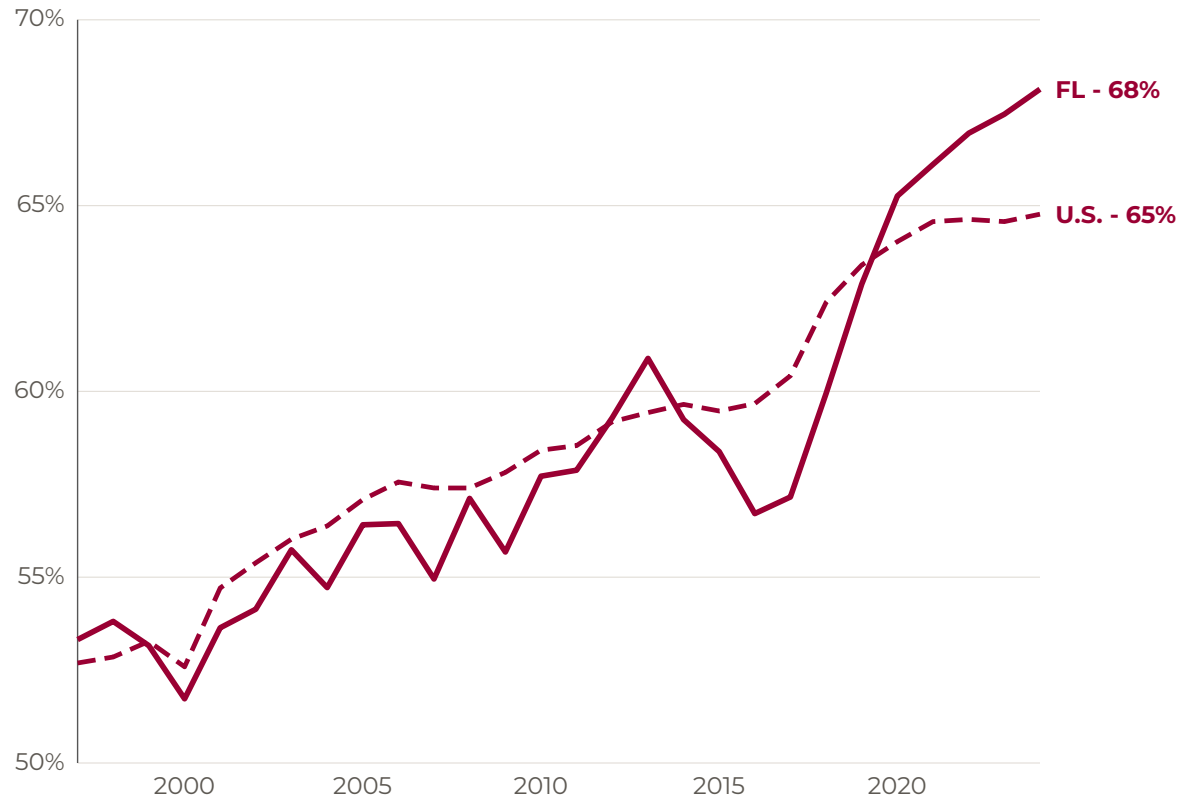
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of Florida's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Florida's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (40% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 68% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., up 0.7 points from 67% in 2023 and up 9.7 points since 2015, when it was 58%.

Figure 38 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

68%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **12th** of 51

60%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **7th** of 50

12.6
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **25th** of 51

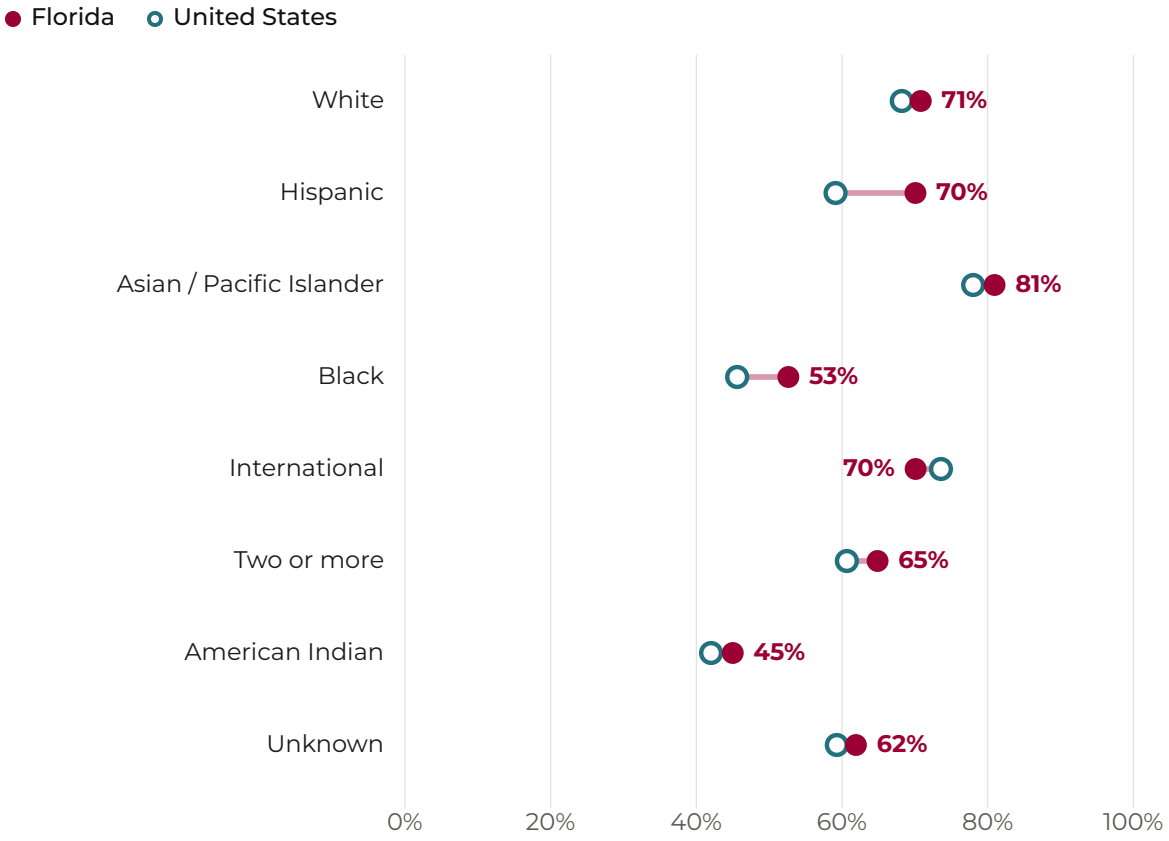
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Florida's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 71% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 70% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 81% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 39 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



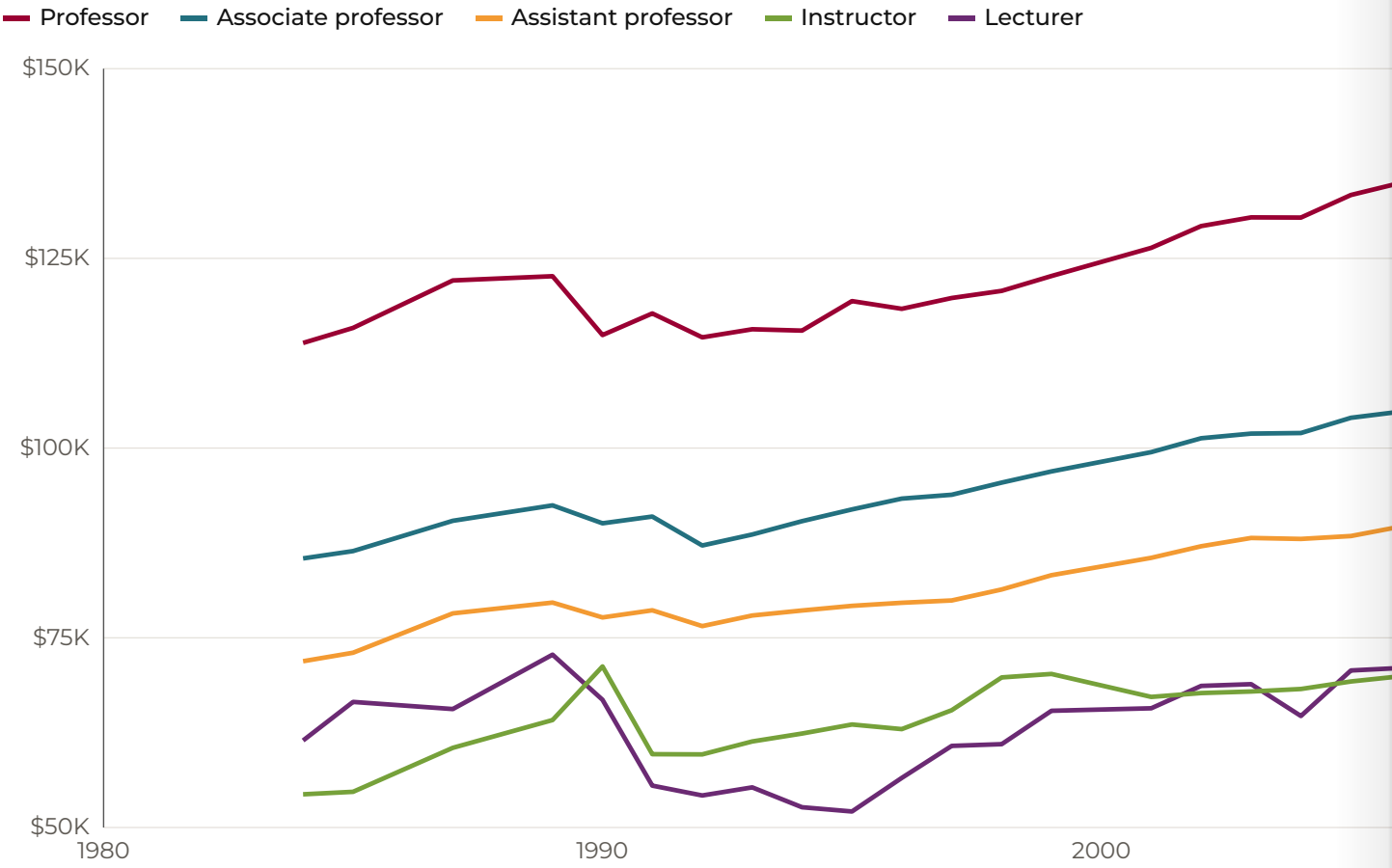
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

Florida ranks 22nd of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $97.4K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

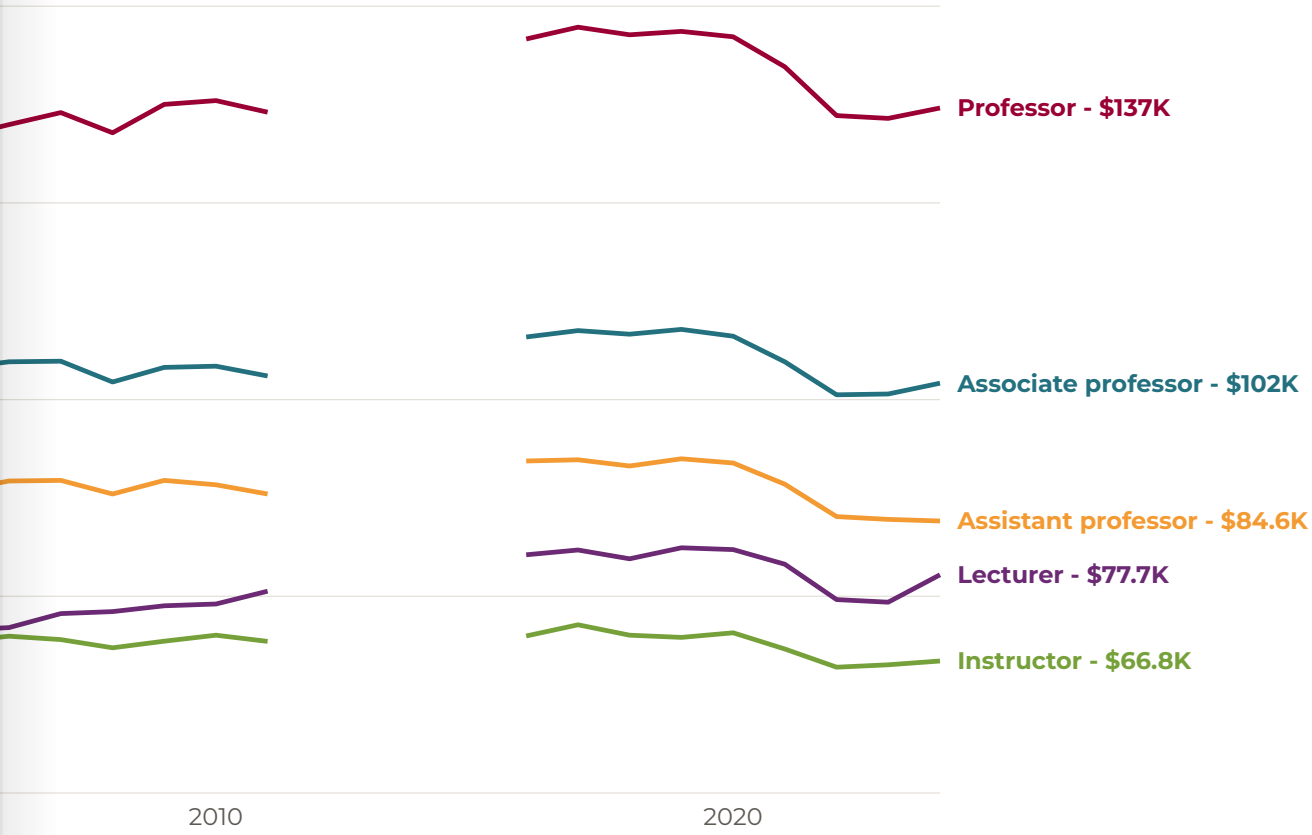
Figure 40 What Do Florida's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data fro

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Florida's institutions earned an average of $97.4K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 8% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 22nd of 51. By rank (2024): professors $137K, associate professors $102K, assistant professors $84.6K, instructors $66.8K, lecturers $77.7K.

Florida's institutions had 29.6K full-time instructional staff in 2024, up 7% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 6% since 2016.



m NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

15

$97.4K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **22nd** of 51 · −5.8% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

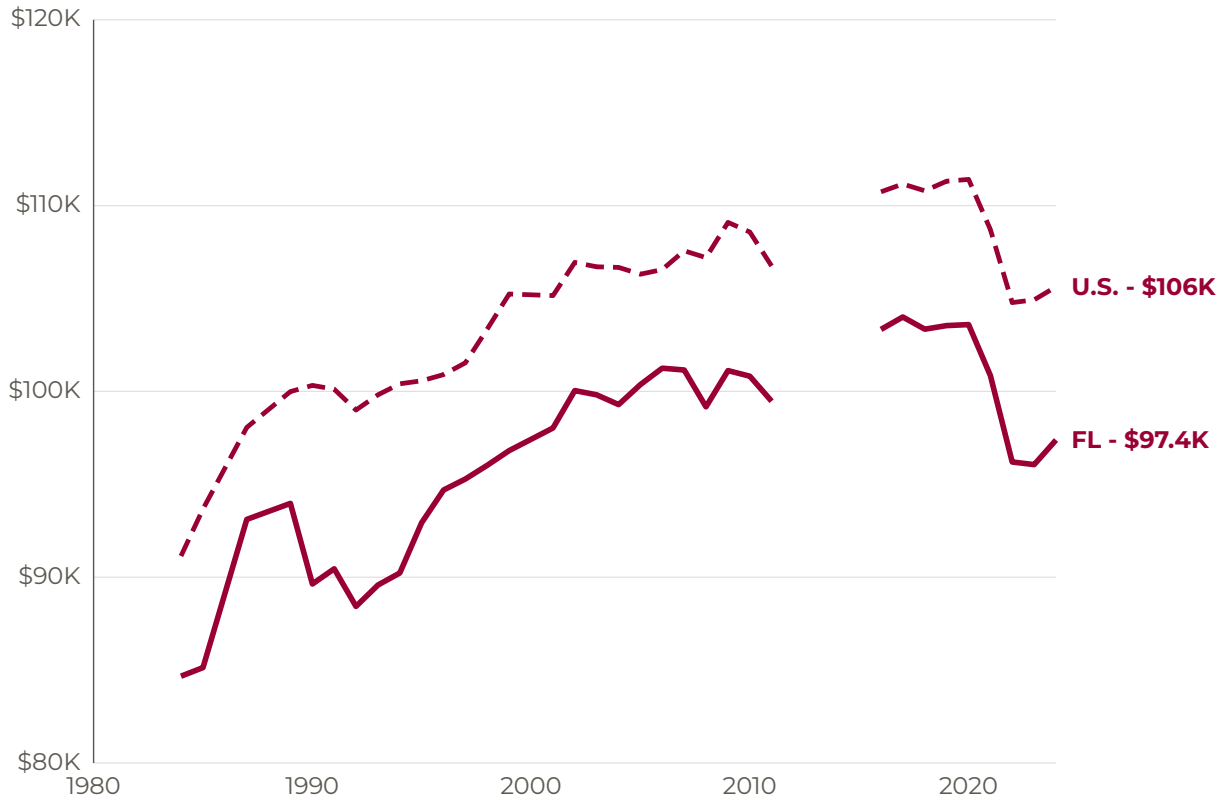
What Do Florida's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Florida's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $97.4K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 22nd among the states, up 1.4% from $96.1K in 2023 and down 5.8% since 2016, when it was $103K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 29.6K in 2024, up 1.6% from 29.1K in 2023 and up 7.4% since 2015, when it was 27.6K.

Figure 41 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$97.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **22nd** of 51

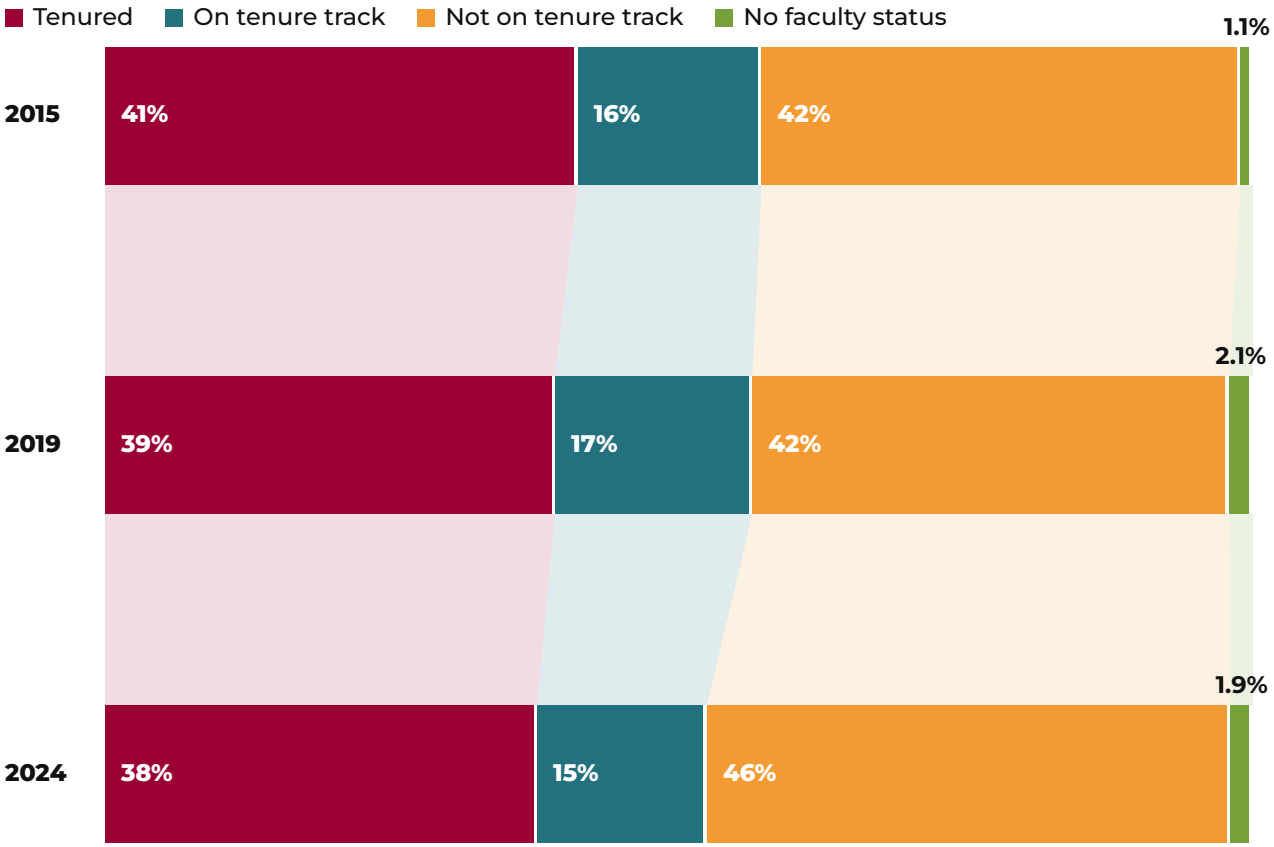
29.6K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

38%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide Florida's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 38% in 2024, down 1.1 points from 39% in 2023 and down 3.6 points since 2015, when it was 41%.

Figure 42 Tenure Status



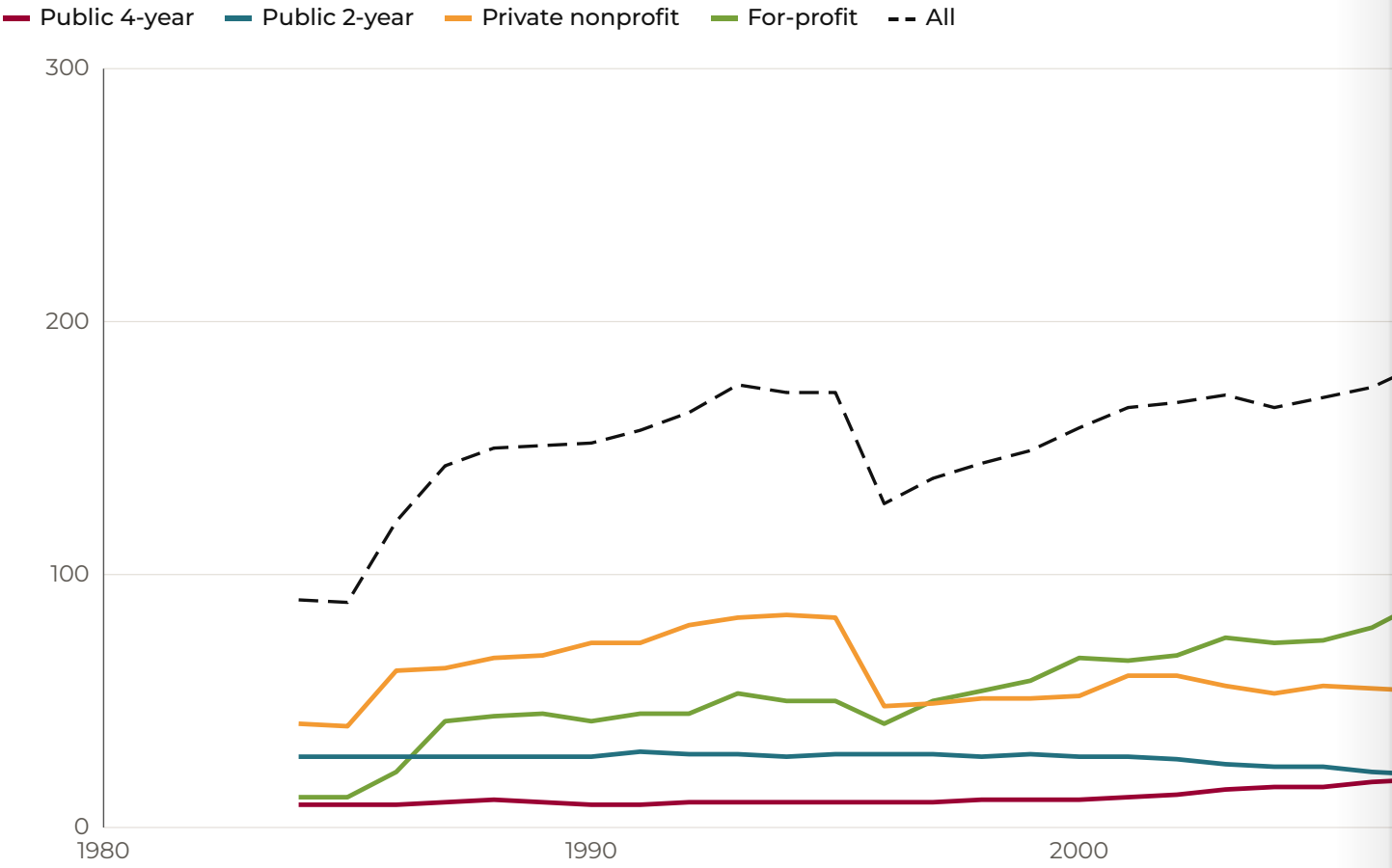
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

Florida ranks 13th of 51 on the share of enrollment at for-profit institutions, at 5.6% in 2024 against 5.5% for the U.S.

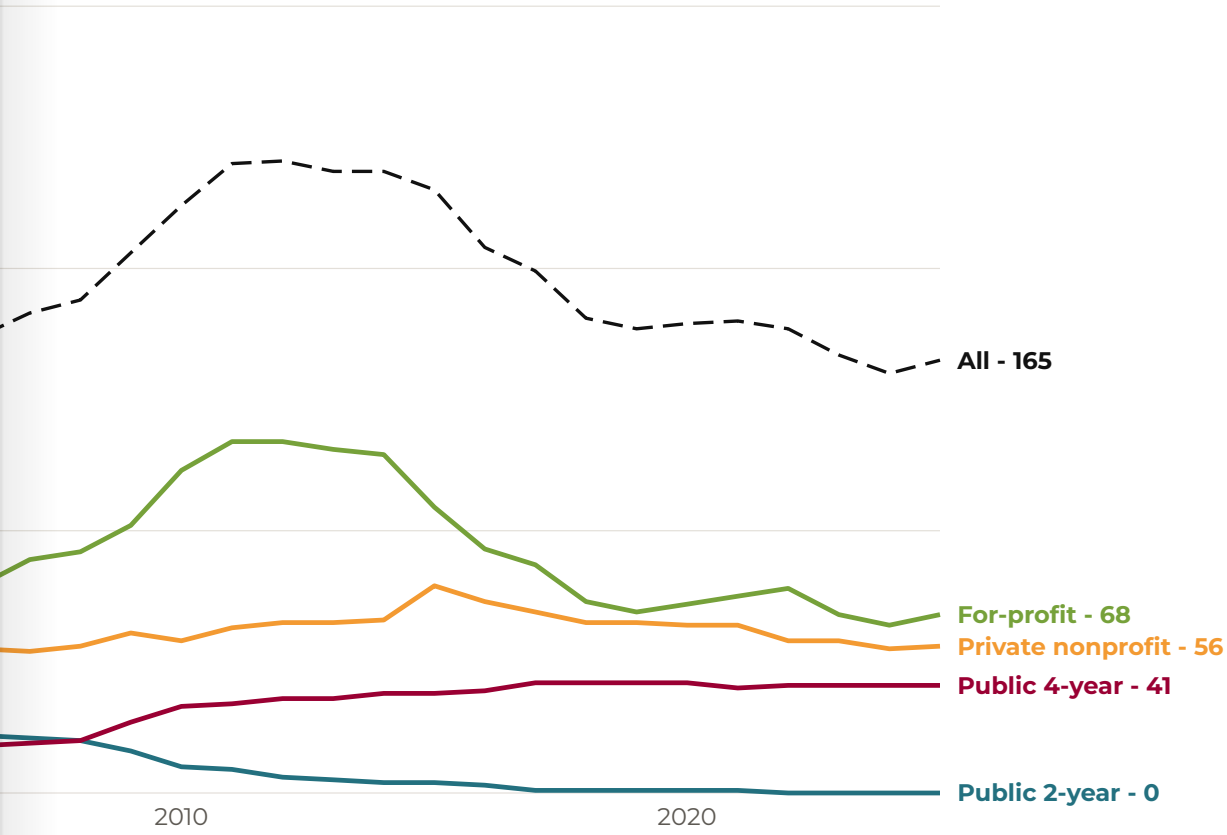
Figure 43 How Many Institutions Does Florida Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Florida has 165 degree-granting institutions:41 public 4-year, 0 public 2-year, 56 private nonprofit, 68 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 28% since 2015. 74% of students attend public institutions and 5.6% attend for-profit ones.



74%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **31st** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

5.6%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **13th** of 51 · −1.9 pp since 2015

30%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **15th** of 51 · +12.9 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in Florida?

The table ranks institutions in Florida by the STEM master's degrees and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025, the two counted together. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

Largest. University of Florida (728 international STEM master's degrees and 197 doctorates), University of South Florida (724 international STEM master's degrees and 73 doctorates), and Florida Atlantic University (467 international STEM master's degrees and 27 doctorates) awarded the most.

Table 7 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM total	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
University of Florida Gainesville · Public 4-year	**925**	728	33%	197	42%
University of South Florida Tampa · Public 4-year	**797**	724	64%	73	54%
Florida Atlantic University Boca Raton · Public 4-year	**494**	467	72%	27	59%
Florida State University Tallahassee · Public 4-year	**366**	260	37%	106	60%
University of Central Florida Orlando · Public 4-year	**331**	252	35%	79	48%
Florida International University Miami · Public 4-year	**291**	228	31%	63	57%
Florida Institute of Technology Melbourne · Private nonprofit	**272**	247	65%	25	54%
University of Miami Coral Gables · Private nonprofit	**177**	133	25%	44	36%

Ranked by the total (shaded) of international STEM master's degrees and research doctorates. Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

165
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

74%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **31st** of 51

5.6%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **13th** of 51

30%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **15th** of 51

The table lists Florida's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were University of Central Florida (69.7K students), Miami Dade College (58.9K students), and University of Florida (56.3K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 165 in 2025, and 155 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 8 What Are Florida's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of Central Florida	**69.7K**	12%	3.44K	78%	40%
Miami Dade College	**58.9K**	–	222	–	–
University of Florida	**56.3K**	20%	3.76K	91%	24%
Florida International University	**54.7K**	15%	2.8K	74%	55%
University of South Florida	**49.6K**	21%	2.95K	77%	43%
Valencia College	**47.4K**	–	147	–	–
Florida State University	**43.9K**	15%	2.14K	86%	24%
Florida Atlantic University	**31.6K**	25%	1.02K	63%	66%
Broward College	**30.7K**	–	180	–	–
Full Sail University	**27.2K**	0.1%	515	45%	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. In Florida, 4 institutions counted as public 2-year in 2015 are counted as public 4-year in 2024; they enrolled 36.2K students (3.5% of the state's total, 4.7% of its public 4-year enrollment). Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

Florida – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	275	**267**[2024]	−8.1 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#41	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	26%	**21%**[2024]	−5.0 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#42	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	243	**243**[2024]	+0.7 ▲	237	−2.5 ▼	#2	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	42%	**45%**[2024]	+2.8 pp ▲	39%	0.0 pp	#4	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	263	**253**[2024]	−10.5 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#43	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	30%	**25%**[2024]	−5.0 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#38	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	227	**218**[2024]	−9.0 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#10	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**153**[2015]	–	153	–	#29	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$11.9K	**$12.7K**[2021]	+6.8% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#42	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	78%	**87%**[2022]	+9.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#19	[3]
Public high school graduates	167K	**203K**[2024]	+22% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#3	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$64.1K	**$56.2K**[2022]	−12% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#48	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	15.3	**18.3**[2022]	+3.0 ▲	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#6	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	2.79M	**2.86M**[2024]	+2.4% ▲	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#3	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	58%	**52%**[2023]	−6.2 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#20	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	9.2%	**9.5%**[2022]	+0.3 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#16	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	9.1%	**13%**[2023]	+4.2 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#5	[3]
High schools offering calculus	61%[2016]	**63%**[2024]	+2.4 pp ▲	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#14	[14]
High schools offering physics	51%[2016]	**48%**[2024]	−3.2 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#43	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	74%[2016]	**74%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#41	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	91%[2016]	**92%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#17	[14]
High schools offering computer science	26%[2021]	**28%**[2024]	+1.6 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#50	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	58%[2016]	**63%**[2024]	+5.2 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#22	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	35%[2021]	**36%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#13	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	62%[2016]	**70%[2024]**	+8.5 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#38	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	22.2[2016]	**20.7[2024]**	−1.5 ▼	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#14	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	8.0[2016]	**4.5[2024]**	−3.5 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#7	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	5.1[2016]	**3.6[2024]**	−1.5 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#43	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	27.3[2016]	**31.0[2024]**	+3.7 ▲	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#5	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	6.1[2016]	**5.7[2024]**	−0.4 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#21	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	44%	**39%[2025]**	−5.1 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#10	[15]
Fall enrollment	1.08M	**1.05M[2024]**	−3.4% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#4	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	73%	**74%[2024]**	+1.0 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#31	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	7.5%	**5.6%[2024]**	−1.9 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#13	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	43%	**40%[2024]**	−3.3 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#24	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	12%	**13%[2024]**	+1.5 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#38	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	17%	**30%[2024]**	+12.9 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#15	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	2.36K	**2.5K[2025]**	+5.7% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#7	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	1.61K	**1.72K[2025]**	+6.8% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#7	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	4.3%	**4.2%[2025]**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#7	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	386	**428[2025]**	+11% ▲	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#8	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	165	**172[2025]**	+4.2% ▲	5.07K	+33% ▲	#9	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	4.3	**6.7[2025]**	+2.4 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#16	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	17%	**22%[2025]**	+5.7 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#29	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	3.2%	**6.2%[2025]**	+3.0 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#22	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	5.0%	**5.9%[2025]**	+0.9 pp ▲	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#32	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.6%	**0.6%[2025]**	0.0 pp	1.2%	0.0 pp	#42	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	5.9%	**7.3%**[2025]	+1.4 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#14	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	0.9%	**0.9%**[2025]	0.0 pp	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#45	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	13%	**14%**[2025]	+1.9 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	22%	**21%**[2025]	−1.6 pp ▼	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#17	[4]
STEM share of master's	15%	**22%**[2025]	+6.7 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#22	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	3.3%	**8.2%**[2025]	+4.9 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#25	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	6.2%	**6.2%**[2025]	0.0 pp	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#22	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**0.8%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#32	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	2.8%	**4.5%**[2025]	+1.7 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#7	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	0.7%	**0.5%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#37	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	16%	**19%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#6	[4]
Share of master's in business	31%	**24%**[2025]	−7.1 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#14	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	36%	**35%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#39	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	3.1%	**2.6%**[2025]	−0.5 pp ▼	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#32	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	13%	**12%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#28	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	1.7%	**2.0%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#29	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	8.7%	**9.4%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#32	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	8.1%	**6.6%**[2025]	−1.5 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#35	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	8.0%	**9.8%**[2025]	+1.8 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#26	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	3.3%	**7.0%**[2025]	+3.7 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#13	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	10.2	**12.6**[2025]	+2.4 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#25	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	2.6%[2016]	**2.3%**[2024]	−0.2 pp ▼	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#31	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	1.92K	**3.53K**[2025]	+84% ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#12	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	3.6%	**3.0%**[2025]	−0.5 pp ▼	–	–	#12	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	2.9%	**4.4%**[2024]	+1.5 pp ▲	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#6	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	12%	**13%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#25	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	3.2%	**3.9%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#16	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	4.3%	**5.3%**[2025]	+0.9 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#21	[4]
International share of all master's	12%	**15%**[2025]	+3.2 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#26	[4]
International share of STEM master's	38%	**40%**[2025]	+2.0 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#28	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	52%	**66%**[2025]	+14.3 pp ▲	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#22	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	48%	**36%**[2025]	−12.4 pp ▼	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#32	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	40%	**38%**[2025]	−1.7 pp ▼	55%	+6.1 pp ▲	#21	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	12%	**9.9%**[2025]	−1.6 pp ▼	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#43	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	38%	**30%**[2025]	−8.0 pp ▼	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#22	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	23%	**25%**[2025]	+1.6 pp ▲	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#26	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	46%	**47%**[2025]	+1.2 pp ▲	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#12	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences research doctorates	31%	**57%**[2025]	+26.1 pp ▲	56%	+2.0 pp ▲	#15	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	57%	**58%**[2025]	+1.3 pp ▲	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#19	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics research doctorates	60%	**73%**[2025]	+13.1 pp ▲	53%	+2.9 pp ▲	#1	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	35%	**29%**[2025]	−6.5 pp ▼	23%	−4.3 pp ▼	#11	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	45%	**44%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	38%	−1.1 pp ▼	#12	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	56K	**66.5K**[2026]	+19% ▲	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#5	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	4.7%	**5.6%**[2026]	+0.9 pp ▲	–	–	#5	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	10%	**15%**[2026]	+4.8 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#34	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	17%	**5.5%**[2026]	−11.6 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#39	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	**32%**[2026]	+4.7 pp ▲	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#35	[20]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Countries of citizenship represented	200	**193**[2026]	−3.5% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#3	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	16.9K	**29.9K**[2026]	+77% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#8	[20]
Active STEM master's students	6.3K	**13.7K**[2026]	2.18× ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#8	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	4.25K	**6.29K**[2026]	+48% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#7	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	55%	**57%**[2026]	+1.6 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#27	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	12.7K[2017]	**15K**[2024]	+18% ▲	–	–	#6	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$1.6B[2018]	**$1.5B**[2024]	−6.3% ▼	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#7	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	16.5K[2018]	**11.6K**[2024]	−29% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#7	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	4.6%	**5.5%**[2024]	+1.0 pp ▲	–	–	#5	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	4.3%	**5.0%**[2024]	+0.7 pp ▲	–	–	#6	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	4.1%	**5.2%**[2024]	+1.1 pp ▲	–	–	#4	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	14.3K	**13K**[2025]	−9.1% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#5	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	24.2K	**24.1K**[2016]	−0.6% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#7	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	8.24K	**8.67K**[2016]	+5.3% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#9	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	34%	**36%**[2016]	+2.0 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#20	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	56%	**59%**[2016]	+2.9 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#14	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	1.16K	**1.23K**[2016]	+6.4% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#11	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	52%	**44%**[2016]	−8.2 pp ▼	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#42	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$2.39B	**$3.79B**[2024]	+58% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#10	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	3.5%	**3.2%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	–	–	#10	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	47%	**49%**[2024]	+2.3 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#34	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	5.1%	**3.1%**[2024]	−2.0 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#33	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	8.0%	**9.5%**[2024]	+1.6 pp ▲	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#11	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$72.4M	**$171M**[2024]	2.37× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#9	[6]

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FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$292M	**$507M[2024]**	+74% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#14	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	33.1K	**43.7K[2024]**	+32% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#7	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$2.93B	**$4.63B[2024]**	+58% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#13	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$697M	**$1.25B[2024]**	+79% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#10	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$1.83B	**$2.97B[2024]**	+62% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#11	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$522M	**$867M[2024]**	+66% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#13	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$776M	**$1.21B[2025]**	+56% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#11	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$893M	**$1.4B[2026]**	+510.0 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#13	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$42.5K[2020]	**$46.5K[2022]**	+9.2% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#33	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$45.4K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#39	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$15.6K	**$14.9K[2024]**	−4.4% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#47	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$63.6K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#37	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$52.6K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#22	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$66.7K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#27	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$83K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#38	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	58%	**68%[2024]**	+9.7 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	53%	**60%[2024]**	+6.3 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#7	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$5.55K	**$4.39K[2023]**	−21% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#51	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$8.94K	**$12K[2024]**	+34% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#15	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	40%	**30%[2024]**	−10.3 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#45	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$103K[2016]	**$97.4K[2024]**	−5.8% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#22	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							

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FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	51%	**49%**[2016]	−2.1 pp ▼	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#11	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	71%	**69%**[2016]	−2.0 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#8	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	43%	**41%**[2016]	−1.5 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#19	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	38%	**36%**[2016]	−1.5 pp ▼	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#19	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.97	**0.92**[2016]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#20	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	957	**1.26K**[2016]	+32% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#11	[21]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	+11.7	**+0.7**[2025]	−11.0 ▼	–	–	#26	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	+22.3K	**+6.22K**[2025]	−16,094.0 ▼	–	–	#5	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	3.7%	**2.6%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	–	–	#29	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	2.6%	**2.5%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#32	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	53.6K	**60.6K**[2025]	+13% ▲	–	–	#3	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	80%[2016]	**81%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	–	–	#9	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+1[2016]	**+1**[2024]	−0.4 ▼	–	–	#33	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	14%[2016]	**14%**[2022]	+0.4 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#40	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	39.6K	**22.5K**[2025]	−43% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#10	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	3.3%	**2.5%**[2025]	−0.8 pp ▼	–	–	#10	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	82%	**71%**[2025]	−11.3 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#22	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$66K	**$101K**[2025]	+53% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#28	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	45%	**25%**[2025]	−20.6 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#15	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	2.16K	**6.37K**[2025]	2.95× ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#6	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	39%	**18%**[2024]	−20.4 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#41	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	3.3%	**14%**[2024]	+11.2 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#9	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	41%	**21%**[2024]	−19.8 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#40	[17]

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FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
STEM share of PERM certifications	59%	**29%**^{2025}	−30.0 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#33	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$83.4K	**$60.5K**^{2025}	−27% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#33	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	119K	**219K**^{2024}	+85% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#1	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	11%	**16%**^{2024}	+4.8 pp ▲	–	–	#1	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	82K	**93.2K**^{2024}	+14% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#2	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	11%	**11%**^{2024}	+0.2 pp ▲	–	–	#2	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	5.3%	**4.3%**^{2024}	−1.0 pp ▼	–	–	#7	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	4.3%	**2.8%**^{2024}	−1.5 pp ▼	–	–	#9	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	6.5%	**6.0%**^{2024}	−0.5 pp ▼	–	–	#5	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	7.8%	**9.9%**^{2024}	+2.1 pp ▲	–	–	#3	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	3.04K	**3.96K**^{2026}	+30% ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#8	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	4.55K	**6.62K**^{2026}	+46% ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#13	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	2.7%	**3.1%**^{2026}	+0.4 pp ▲	–	–	#8	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	9.1%	**4.5%**^{2026}	−4.6 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#11	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	12%	**10%**^{2026}	−1.9 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#38	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	55%	**42%**^{2026}	−12.4 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#14	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	31%	**14%**^{2026}	−17.0 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#49	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	400K	**713K**^{2024}	+78% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#4	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	4.4%	**6.3%**^{2024}	+1.9 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#36	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	25%	**27%**^{2024}	+1.6 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#7	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	36%	**39%**^{2024}	+3.0 pp ▲	41%	+2.2 pp ▲	#10	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a doctorate	48%	**41%**^{2024}	−7.0 pp ▼	47%	+0.9 pp ▲	#13	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	9.7%	**9.2%**^{2024}	−0.5 pp ▼	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#16	[12]

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FLORIDA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	7.3%	**8.0%**[2024]	+0.7 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#8	[12]
Share of foreign-born STEM workers born in India	13%	**14%**[2024]	+0.3 pp ▲	28%	+0.7 pp ▲	#28	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	20%	**23%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#4	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	24%	**28%**[2025]	+3.6 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#4	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	337K	**532K**[2025]	+58% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#4	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.72	**0.80**[2025]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#36	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$75K	**$108K**[2025]	+45% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#23	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$95.9K[2019]	**$131K**[2025]	+37% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#19	[10]
Software developer jobs	44.8K	**87.9K**[2025]	+96% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#6	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$42.9K	**$64.7K**[2025]	+51% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#27	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	2.34K	**3.12K**[2025]	+33% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#13	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	1.7%	**2.3%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	–	–	#13	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	25%	**27%**[2025]	+2.0 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#19	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	26%	**26%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#12	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	2.2%	**0.5%**[2025]	−1.7 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#32	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	9.6%	**10%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#38	[22]

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